

Statesman

ΠΟΛΙΤΙΚΟΣ

Plato

translated by David Horan

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S: Well, Theodorus, I owe you a great debt of gratitude for the acquaintance of Theaetetus, and of the stranger too.

ΣΩ. ἡ πολλὴν χάριν ὀφείλω σοι τῆς Θεαιτήτου γνωρίσεως, ὦ Θεόδωρε, ἅμα καὶ τῆς τοῦ ξένου. ΘΕΟ. τάχα δέ γε, ὦ Σώκρατες, ὀφειλήσεις ταύτης τριπλασίαν· ἐπειδὴν τόν τε πολιτικὸν ἀπεργάσωνταί σοι καὶ τὸν φιλόσοφον. ΣΩ. εἶεν· οὕτω τοῦτο, ὦ φίλε Θεόδωρε, φήσομεν ἀκηκοότες εἶναι τοῦ περὶ λογισμοὺς καὶ τὰ γεωμετρικὰ κρατίστου;

TD: And yet, Socrates, you will soon be three times more grateful once they have completed the statesman for you, and the philosopher too.

S: What is this, Theodorus? Are we to say that we have heard our supreme reasoner and geometrician expressing the matter in this way?

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TD: In what way, Socrates?

ΘΕΟ. πῶς, ὦ Σώκρατες; ΣΩ. τῶν ἀνδρῶν ἕκαστον θέντος τῆς ἴσης ἀξίας, οἱ τῇ τιμῇ πλέον ἀλλήλων ἀφεστᾶσιν ἢ κατὰ τὴν ἀναλογίαν τὴν τῆς ὑμετέρας τέχνης. ΘΕΟ. εὖ γε νῆ τὸν ἡμέτερον θεόν, ὦ Σώκρατες, τὸν Ἄμμωνα, καὶ δικαίως, καὶ πάνυ μὲν οὖν μνημονικῶς ἐπέπληξάς μοι τὸ περὶ τοὺς λογισμοὺς ἀμάρτημα. καὶ σὲ μὲν ἀντὶ τούτων εἰς αὐθις μέτειμι· σὺ δ' ἡμῖν, ὦ ξένε, μηδαμῶς ἀποκάμης χαριζόμενος, ἀλλ' ἐξῆς, εἴτε τὸν πολιτικὸν ἄνδρα

S: By assigning equal worth to each of the men when they stand so far apart in value that they are completely out of the proportion that your skill deals with.

TD: By our god Ammon,¹ Socrates, you have rebuked me nicely, and with justification, for the error in the calculations, and you demonstrated your excellent memory in the process. I'll get back to you on these issues some other time. As for you, stranger, you should never tire of gratifying us, and whether you prefer to take the man who is a statesman or the one who is a philosopher first, make your selection and go through it in detail.

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ST: That's what we should do, Theodorus, since once we have taken them on we should not give up until we have brought them to a conclusion. However, what should I do about Theaetetus here?

πρότερον εἴτε τὸν φιλόσοφον προαιρῇ, προελόμενος διέξελθε. ΞΕ. ταῦτ', ὧ Θεόδωρε, ποιητέον· ἐπεὶ περ ἅπαξ γε ἐγκεχειρήκαμεν, καὶ οὐκ ἀποστατέον πρὶν ἂν αὐτῶν πρὸς τὸ τέλος ἔλθωμεν. ἀλλὰ γὰρ περὶ Θεαιτήτου τοῦδε τί χρή δρᾶν με; ΘΕΟ. τοῦ πέρι; ΞΕ. διαναπαύσωμεν αὐτὸν μεταλαμβάνοντας αὐτοῦ τὸν συγγυμναστήν τόνδε Σωκράτη; ἢ πῶς συμβουλεύεις; ΘΕΟ. καθάπερ εἶπες, μεταλαμβάναν· νέω γὰρ ὄντε ῥᾶον οἴσετον πάντα πόνον ἀναπαυομένω.

TD: In what sense?

ST: Should we rest him for a while and substitute his training companion, this young Socrates? What would you advise?

TD: Make the change you just suggested, for they are both young and will bear all the exertion more readily if they are rested.

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S: And, indeed, stranger, they would both seem to have a certain kinship with me. In one case you claim that he looks similar to me based on the nature of his face, while in the other case the fact that he is addressed by the same name provides some relationship. Of course, we should always be eager to get to know our kindred through discourse. So, I myself had dealings with Theaetetus in discussion yesterday, and I have now heard him answering questions too.² However, in the case of Socrates, I have done neither. This fellow should be tested too, so let him respond to you now, and to me on some other occasion.

ΣΩ. καὶ μὴν κινδυνεύετον, ὧ ξέने, ἄμφω ποθὲν ἐμοὶ συγγένειαν ἔχειν τινά. ΣΩ. τὸν μὲν γε οὖν ὑμεῖς κατὰ τὴν τοῦ προσώπου φύσιν ὁμοῖον ἐμοὶ φαίνεσθαι φατε, τοῦ δ' ἡμῖν ἡ

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ST: So be it. Well, Socrates, are you listening to Socrates?

κλήσις ὁμώνυμος οὔσα καὶ ἡ πρόσρησις παρέχεται τινα οἰκειότητα. δεῖ δὴ τοὺς γε συγγενεῖς ἡμᾶς ἀεὶ προθύμως διὰ λόγων ἀναγνωρίζειν. Θεαιτήτῳ μὲν οὖν αὐτός τε συνέμειξα χθὲς διὰ λόγων καὶ νῦν ἀκήκοα ἀποκρινομένου, Σωκράτους δὲ οὐδέτερον· δεῖ δὲ σκέψασθαι καὶ τοῦτον. ἐμοὶ μὲν οὖν εἰς αὐθις, σοὶ δὲ νῦν ἀποκρινέσθω. ΞΕ. ταῦτ' ἔσται. ὦ Σώκρατες, ἀκούεις δὴ Σωκράτους; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ναί. ΞΕ. συγχωρεῖς οὖν οἷς λέγει; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν.

YS: Yes.

ST: And do you agree with what he is proposing?

YS: Very much so.

ST: It appears there is no impediment on your side, and there should probably be even less on my side. Anyway, after the sophist, it is necessary in my view that the two of us seek out the man who is a statesman. So tell me, should we place him in the rank of those who are knowledgeable, or not?

YS: As you suggest.

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ST: In that case, should we divide knowledge just as we did when we investigated the previous personage?³

ΞΕ. οὐ τὰ σὰ κωλύειν φαίνεται, δεῖ δὲ ἴσως ἔτι ἦττον τὰμὰ διακωλύειν. ἀλλὰ δὴ μετὰ τὸν σοφιστὴν ἀναγκαῖον, ὥς ἐμοὶ φαίνεται, πολιτικὸν τὸν ἄνδρα διαζητεῖν νῶν· καὶ μοι λέγε πότερον τῶν ἐπιστημόνων τιν' ἡμῖν καὶ τοῦτον θετέον, ἢ πῶς; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. οὕτως. ΞΕ. τὰς ἐπιστήμας ἄρα διαληπτέον, ὥσπερ ἡνίκα τὸν πρότερον ἐσκοποῦμεν; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. τάχ' ἄν. ΞΕ. οὐ μὲν δὴ κατὰ ταυτόν γε, ὦ Σώκρατες, φαίνεται μοι τμημα. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. τί μὴν;

YS: Perhaps so.

ST: So be it. Well, Socrates, I think I see a division, although it is not on the same basis.

YS: What then?

ST: It is on a different basis.

YS: Quite likely.

ST: So, where may one discover the statesman-like path? For it is necessary to discover it and, having set it apart from the others, to impose one character upon it, and by assigning one distinctive form to the other branches, make this soul of ours regard all knowledge as being of two forms.

YS: This is now turning out to be a task for you, stranger, rather than for me.

ST: And yet it should be yours too, Socrates, once it has become plain to us.

YS: Well expressed.

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ST: Now, aren't arithmetic, and certain other skills akin to it, devoid of activity, as they simply provide knowing?

ΞΕ. κατ' ἄλλο. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ἔοικέν γε. ΞΕ. τὴν οὖν πολιτικὴν ἀτραπὸν πῇ τις ἀνευρήσει; δεῖ γὰρ αὐτὴν ἀνευρεῖν, καὶ χωρὶς ἀφελόντας ἀπὸ τῶν ἄλλων ιδέαν αὐτῇ μίαν ἐπισφραγίσασθαι, καὶ ταῖς ἄλλαις ἐκτροπαῖς ἐν ἄλλο εἶδος ἐπισημηναμένους πάσας τὰς ἐπιστήμας ὡς οὕσας δύο εἶδη διανοηθῆναι τὴν ψυχὴν ἡμῶν ποιῆσαι. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. τοῦτ' ἤδη σὸν οἶμαι τὸ ἔργον, ὃ ξένε, ἀλλ' οὐκ ἐμὸν γίγνεται.

YS: This is the case.

ST: However, those concerned with carpentry and all sorts of manual labour have acquired their knowledge as if it were naturally inherent in the actions, and they use it to bring to completion the objects they generate, things that did not previously exist.

YS: What of it?

ST: Well, all knowledge may be subdivided in this way, by designating one part as involving action, and the other as only cognitive.

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YS: I grant that these two kinds belong to a single whole – knowledge.

ΞΕ. δεῖ γε μήν, ὦ Σώκρατες, αὐτὸ εἶναι καὶ σόν, ὅταν ἐμφανὲς ἡμῖν γένηται. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. καλῶς εἶπες. ΞΕ. ἄρ' οὖν οὐκ ἀριθμητικὴ μὲν καὶ τινες ἕτεραι ταύτῃ συγγενεῖς τέχναι ψιλὰι τῶν πράξεων εἰσι, τὸ δὲ γινῶναι παρέσχοντο μόνον; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ἔστιν οὕτως. ΞΕ. αἱ δέ γε περὶ τεκτονικὴν αὖ καὶ σύμπασαν χειρουργίαν ὥσπερ ἐν ταῖς πράξεσιν ἐνοῦσαν σύμφυτον τὴν ἐπιστήμην κέκτηνται, καὶ συναποτελοῦσι τὰ γιγνόμενα ὑπ' αὐτῶν σώματα πρότερον οὐκ ὄντα. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. τί μήν; ΞΕ. ταύτῃ τοίνυν συμπάσας ἐπιστήμας διαίρει, τὴν μὲν πρακτικὴν προσειπών, τὴν δὲ μόνον γνωστικὴν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ἔστω σοι ταῦθ' ὥς μιᾶς ἐπιστήμης τῆς ὅλης εἶδη δύο. ΞΕ. πότερον οὖν τὸν πολιτικὸν καὶ βασιλέα καὶ δεσπότην καὶ ἔτ' οἰκονόμον θήσομεν ὥς ἐν πάντα ταῦτα προσαγορεύοντες, ἢ τοσαύτας τέχνας αὐτὰς εἶναι φῶμεν ὅσαπερ ὀνόματα ἐρρήθη; μᾶλλον δέ μοι δεῦρο ἔπου. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. πῃ;

ST: Now, shall we designate the statesman, the king, the master, and even the estate manager, as one, when we are referring to them all, or should we declare that the skills are just as many as the names that are spoken? But it is better for you to follow my lead here.

YS: In what way?

ST: As follows. If someone is competent to advise one of our public physicians, he himself being a private citizen, wouldn't it be necessary to refer to him by the name of the same skill as the person he is advising?

YS: Yes.

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ST: What about this? Shouldn't we say that a person who is a skilled adviser to a man who is exercising kingship over a country, being

himself a private citizen, possesses the knowledge that the ruler himself should have acquired?

ΞΕ. τῇδε. εἴ τώ τις τῶν δημοσιευόντων ἱατρῶν ἱκανὸς συμβουλευεῖν ἰδιωτεύων αὐτός, ἅρ' οὐκ ἀναγκαῖον αὐτῷ προσαγορεύεσθαι τοῦνομα τῆς τέχνης ταῦτόν ὅπερ ᾧ συμβουλευεῖ; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ναί. ΞΕ. τί δ'; ὅστις βασιλεύοντι χώρας ἀνδρὶ παραινεῖν δεινὸς ἰδιώτης ὢν αὐτός, ἅρ' οὐ φήσομεν ἔχειν αὐτὸν τὴν ἐπιστήμην ἣν ἔδει τὸν ἄρχοντα αὐτὸν κεκτῆσθαι; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. φήσομεν.

YS: We should say so.

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ST: But, of course, the skill of a true king is kingship.

ΞΕ. ἀλλὰ μὴν ἥ γε ἀληθινοῦ βασιλέως βασιλική; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ναί. ΞΕ. ταύτην δὲ ὁ κεκτημένος οὐκ, ἄντε ἄρχων ἄντε ἰδιώτης ὢν τυγχάνῃ, πάντως κατὰ γε τὴν τέχνην αὐτὴν βασιλικὸς ὀρθῶς προσρηθήσεται; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. δίκαιον γοῦν. ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν οἰκονόμος γε καὶ δεσπότης ταῦτόν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. τί μὴν; ΞΕ. τί δέ; μεγάλης σχῆμα οἰκίσεως ἢ μικρᾶς αὖ πόλεως ὄγκος μῶν τι πρὸς ἀρχὴν διοίσετον; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. οὐδέν.

YS: Yes.

ST: And won't someone who has acquired this skill, whether he happens to be a ruler or a private citizen, be correctly referred to as kingly, in any case, on the basis of the skill itself?

YS: And it is right to do so.

ST: Therefore, should we put all these things together as one and the same, statesmanship and the statesman and kingship and the king?

YS: We clearly should.

ST: And, indeed, estate manager and a master are the same?

YS: Of course.

ST: What about this? Surely there isn't any difference between an impressively large household and a substantial but a small city when it

comes to rulership.

YS: None.

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ST: And so, on the matter we were considering, it is evident that one knowledge applies to them all. And whether someone designates it as kingship or statesmanship or estate management, we should not argue with him.

ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν, ὃ νυνδὴ διεσκοπούμεθα, φανερόν ὡς ἐπιστήμη μία περὶ πάντ' ἐστὶ ταῦτα· ταύτην δὲ εἴτε βασιλικὴν εἴτε πολιτικὴν εἴτε οἰκονομικὴν τις ὀνομάζει, μηδὲν αὐτῷ διαφερώμεθα. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. τί γάρ; ΞΕ. ἀλλὰ μὴν τόδε γε δῆλον, ὡς βασιλεὺς ἅπας χερσὶ καὶ σύμπαντι τῷ σώματι σμίκρ' ἄττα εἰς τὸ κατέχειν τὴν ἀρχὴν δύναται πρὸς τὴν τῆς ψυχῆς σύνεσιν καὶ ῥώμην. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. δῆλον. ΞΕ. τῆς δὴ γνωστικῆς μᾶλλον ἢ τῆς χειροτεχνικῆς καὶ

YS: No, why would we?

ST: But this much is obvious anyway, that in order to hold power, any king is able to do very little by means of his hands, or his body as a whole, in comparison with the intelligence and force of his soul.

YS: Obviously.

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ST: Well, do you want us to assert that a king has more affinity with cognitive knowledge rather than with knowledge that involves manual skill, and is on the whole active?

ὅλως πρακτικῆς βούλει τὸν βασιλέα φῶμεν οἰκειότερον εἶναι; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. τί μὴν; ΞΕ. τὴν ἄρα πολιτικὴν καὶ πολιτικὸν καὶ βασιλικὴν καὶ βασιλικὸν εἰς ταῦτόν ὡς ἔν πάντα ταῦτα συνθήσομεν; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. δῆλον. ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν πορευοίμεθ' ἂν ἐξῆς, εἰ μετὰ ταῦτα τὴν γνωστικὴν διορίζοιμεθα; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. πάνυ γε. ΞΕ. πρόσεχε δὴ τὸν νοῦν ἂν ἄρα ἐν αὐτῇ τινα διαφυγὴν κατανοήσωμεν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. φράζε ποίαν.

YS: Of course.

ST: In that case, shall we place all these together into the same, as one – statesmanship and the statesman, kingship and the kingly person?

YS: Obviously.

ST: Wouldn't we be proceeding in an orderly manner if we were to make a division in the cognitive knowledge next?

YS: Very much so.

ST: Then apply your mind, in case we can discern some natural division in it.

YS: What sort is it? Tell me.

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ST: As follows. We agree, I presume, that there is a skill of calculation?

ΞΕ. τοιάνδε. λογιστική πού τις ἡμῖν ἦν τέχνη. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ναί. ΞΕ. τῶν γνωστικῶν γε οἶμαι παντάπασι τεχνῶν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. πῶς δ' οὐ; ΞΕ. γνούση δὴ λογιστικὴ τὴν ἐν τοῖς ἀριθμοῖς διαφορὰν μῶν τι πλέον ἔργον δώσομεν ἢ τὰ γνωσθέντα κρῖναι; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. τί μήν; ΞΕ. καὶ γὰρ ἀρχιτέκτων γε πᾶς οὐκ αὐτὸς ἐργατικὸς ἀλλ' ἐργατῶν ἄρχων. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ναί. ΞΕ. παρεχόμενός γέ που γνῶσιν ἀλλ' οὐ χειρουργίαν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. οὕτως.

YS: Yes.

ST: In my view, it belongs entirely among the cognitive skills.

YS: How could it not?

ST: Now, once calculation has cognised the difference between the numbers, surely we would not assign it any other function over and above judging what it has cognised?

YS: No, why would we?

ST: And, indeed, any architect supervises workers but does not himself behave as a worker.

YS: Yes.

ST: Providing, I presume, the cognitive aspect but not the manual labour.

YS: Quite so.

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ST: Then he may rightly be said to partake of the cognitive knowledge.

ΞΕ. δικαίως δὴ μετέχειν ἂν λέγοιτο τῆς γνωστικῆς ἐπιστήμης. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. πάνυ γε. ΞΕ. τούτῳ δέ γε οἶμαι προσήκει κρίναντι μὴ τέλος ἔχειν μηδ' ἀπηλλάχθαι, καθάπερ ὁ λογιστὴς ἀπήλλακτο, προστάττειν δὲ ἐκάστοις τῶν ἐργατῶν τό γε πρόσφορον ἕως ἂν ἀπεργάσωνται τὸ προσταχθέν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ὀρθῶς. ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν γνωστικά μὲν αἱ τε τοιαῦται σύμπασαι καὶ ὅποσαι συνέπονται τῇ λογιστικῇ, κρίσει δὲ καὶ ἐπιτάζει

YS: Entirely so.

ST: Yes, but in my view it belongs to this man, once he has made a judgement, neither to conclude the matter nor take his leave, in the way that the man who calculated took his leave, but to assign what's appropriate to each of the workers until such time as they have completed the assigned task.

YS: And rightly so.

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ST: Therefore, all such branches of knowledge are cognitive, and so are any that accompany calculation, yet these two kinds differ from one another when it comes to judging and directing.

διαφέρετον ἀλλήλοιν τούτῳ τῷ γένει; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. φαίνεσθον. ΞΕ. ἄρ' οὖν συμπάσης τῆς γνωστικῆς εἰ τὸ μὲν ἐπιτακτικὸν μέρος, τὸ δὲ κριτικὸν διαιρούμενοι προσείποιμεν, ἐμμελῶς ἂν φαῖμεν διηρῆσθαι; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. κατὰ γε τὴν ἐμὴν δόξαν. ΞΕ. ἀλλὰ μὴν τοῖς γε κοινῇ τι πράττουσιν ἀγαπητὸν ὁμονοεῖν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. πῶς δ' οὐ; ΞΕ. τούτου τοίνυν μέχριπερ ἂν αὐτοὶ κοινωνῶμεν, ἐατέον τά γε τῶν ἄλλων δοξάσματα χαίρειν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. τί μὴν;

YS: Apparently.

ST: Now, if we were to divide cognitive knowledge, referring to one part as directive and the other as judgemental, would we say it had been divided appropriately?

YS: Yes, in my view anyway.

ST: Now those who are engaged in a common task should be content if they themselves are like-minded.

YS: They should.

ST: Then as long as we are sharing a task, we should bid farewell to the viewpoints of anyone else.

YS: Of course.

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ST: Come on then, among which of these two skills should we include the kingly person? Is it among the judgemental, just like a spectator, or does he belong more to the directive skill insofar as he is exercising mastery? Shall we place him there?

ΞΕ. φέρε δὴ, τούτοις τοῖς τέχναις ἡμῖν τὸν βασιλικὸν ἐν ποτέρῳ θετέον; ἄρ' ἐν τῇ κριτικῇ, καθάπερ τινὰ θεατὴν, ἢ μᾶλλον τῆς ἐπιτακτικῆς ὡς ὄντα αὐτὸν τέχνης θήσομεν, δεσπόζοντά γε; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ μᾶλλον; ΞΕ. τὴν ἐπιτακτικὴν δὴ τέχνην πάλιν ἂν εἴη θεατέον εἴ πῃ διέστηκεν. καὶ μοι δοκεῖ τῇδε πῃ, καθάπερ ἡ τῶν καπήλων τέχνη τῆς τῶν αὐτοπωλῶν διώρισταί τε τέχνης, καὶ

YS: More in the second, of course.

ST: Then we should see once more whether the directive skill divides in any way. Indeed, it seems to me that it does so as follows. Just as the skill of retailers is distinguished from the skill of those who sell their own produce, so too is the kingly class, seemingly, set apart from the class of public messengers.

YS: How so?

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ST: The retailers first receive products that are not their own, and then sell once more what had previously been sold to them.

τὸ βασιλικὸν γένος ἔοικεν ἀπὸ τοῦ τῶν κηρύκων γένους ἀφωρίσθαι. NE. ΣΩ. πῶς; ΞΕ. πωληθέντα που πρότερον ἔργα ἀλλότρια παραδεχόμενοι δεύτερον πωλοῦσι πάλιν οἱ κάπηλοι. NE. ΣΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὔν. ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν καὶ τὸ κηρυκικὸν φῦλον ἐπιταχθέντ' ἀλλότρια νοήματα παραδεχόμενον αὐτὸ δεύτερον ἐπιτάττει πάλιν ἑτέροις. NE. ΣΩ. ἀληθέστατα. ΞΕ. τί οὔν; εἰς ταῦτόν μείζομεν βασιλικὴν ἑρμηνευτικῇ,

YS: They certainly do.

ST: So too, messengers take other people's ideas as directions, and then direct others once more with the directions imparted to them.

YS: Very true.

ST: What now? Shall we mix together kingship, interpretation, instructing rowers, prophecy, imparting messages, and various other skills related to these, as if they were the same, because they all involve giving directions? Or, since we devised a likeness just now, would you like to devise a name, in an analogous manner, since the class of those who are 'own-directing' is effectively devoid of a name? We could then distinguish these activities in this way, placing the class of the kings with the 'own-directing' skill, paying no regard to all the rest, and allowing someone else to assign them a name, since our method is concerned with the ruler and not with his opposite.

YS: Entirely so.

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ST: Therefore, since this has been set apart from the rest in a measured way, defined by the contrast between otherness and kingship, it is necessary to go on and divide this once more, if we find that it still yields us a cut.

κελευστικῇ, μαντικῇ, κηρυκικῇ, καὶ πολλαῖς ἑτέραις τούτων τέχναις συγγενέσιν, αἱ σύμπασαι τό γ' ἐπιτάττειν ἔχουσιν; ἢ βούλει, καθάπερ ῥηκάζομεν νυνδὴ, καὶ τοῦνομα παρεικάσωμεν, ἐπειδὴ καὶ σχεδὸν

ἀνώνυμον ὃν τυγχάνει τὸ τῶν αὐτεπιτακτῶν γένος, καὶ ταύτη ταῦτα διελώμεθα, τὸ μὲν τῶν βασιλέων γένος εἰς τὴν αὐτεπιτακτικὴν θέντες, τοῦ δὲ ἄλλου παντὸς ἀμελήσαντες, ὄνομα ἕτερον αὐτοῖς παραχωρήσαντες θέσθαι τινά; τοῦ γὰρ ἄρχοντος ἕνεκα ἡμῖν ἢ μέθοδος ἦν

YS: Entirely so.

ST: And indeed we appear to have one. Just follow along and make the cut with me.

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YS: In what way?

ἀλλ' οὐχὶ τοῦ ἐναντίου. NE. ΣΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν ἐπειδὴ τοῦτο μετρίως ἀφέστηκεν ἀπ' ἐκείνων, ἀλλοτριότητι διορισθὲν πρὸς οἰκειότητα, τοῦτο αὐτὸ πάλιν αὖ διαιρεῖν ἀναγκαῖον, εἴ τινα τομὴν ἔτι ἔχομεν ὑπέικουσιν ἐν τούτῳ; NE. ΣΩ. πάνυ γε. ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν φαινόμεθα ἔχειν· ἀλλ' ἐπακολουθῶν σύντεμνε. NE. ΣΩ. πῆ; ΞΕ. πάντας ὅποσους ἂν ἄρχοντας διανοηθῶμεν ἐπιτάξει

ST: In the case of all those we may recognise as ruling by issuing direction, we shall find, won't we, that they are issuing commands for the sake of the generation of something?

YS: Of course.

ST: And, indeed, it is not enormously difficult to divide all that is generated into two.

YS: In what way?

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ST: Considering them all together, some, I presume, are soulless, while others are ensouled.

προσχωμένους ἄρ' οὐχ εὐρήσομεν γενέσεώς τινος ἕνεκα προστάττοντας; NE. ΣΩ. πῶς δ' οὐ; ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν τά γε γιγνόμενα πάντα δίχα διαλαβεῖν οὐ παντάπασι χαλεπόν. NE. ΣΩ. πῆ; ΞΕ. τὰ μὲν ἄψυχα αὐτῶν ἐστὶ που συμπάντων, τὰ δ' ἔμψυχα. NE. ΣΩ. ναί. ΞΕ. τούτοις δέ γε

αὐτοῖς τὸ τοῦ γνωστικοῦ μέρος ἐπιτακτικὸν ὄν, εἴπερ βουλόμεθα τέμνειν, τεμοῦμεν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. κατὰ τί; ΞΕ. τὸ μὲν ἐπὶ ταῖς τῶν ἀψύχων γενέσεσιν αὐτοῦ τάττοντες,

YS: Yes.

ST: And it is just on the basis of these that we shall make a cut in the directing part of purely cognitive knowledge, if we do actually wish to cut it.

YS: Based on what?

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ST: By aligning one part of it with the generation that relates to the soulless, and the other with the generation that relates to the ensouled. And in this way the entire, at that stage, can be separated into two.

τὸ δ' ἐπὶ ταῖς τῶν ἐμψύχων καὶ πᾶν οὕτως ἤδη διαιρήσεται δίχα. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. παντάπασί γε. ΞΕ. τὸ μὲν τοίνυν αὐτῶν παραλίπωμεν, τὸ δ' ἀναλάβωμεν, ἀναλαβόντες δὲ μερισώμεθα εἰς δύο τὸ σύμπαν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. λέγεις δ' αὐτοῖν ἀναληπτέον εἶναι πότερον; ΞΕ. πάντως που τὸ περὶ τὰ ζῶα ἐπιτακτικόν. οὐ γὰρ δὴ τό γε τῆς βασιλικῆς ἐπιστήμης ἐστὶ ποτε τῶν ἀψύχων ἐπιστατοῦν, οἷον ἀρχιτεκτονικόν, ἀλλὰ γενναιότερον, ἐν τοῖς

YS: Absolutely.

ST: Then let us leave one of these parts aside and take up the other one. But having taken it up, we should make a twofold division of all of it.

YS: Which of the two parts are you saying should be taken up?

ST: Presumably the one that issues directions relating to living creatures since the kingly knowledge, unlike architectural knowledge, is of course never the supervisor of the soulless. No, it is nobler, and always has its power over living creatures, and is concerned just with these.

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YS: Correct.

ζώοις καὶ περὶ αὐτὰ ταῦτα τὴν δύναμιν αἰεὶ κεκτημένον. NE. ΣΩ. ὀρθῶς. ΞΕ. τὴν γε μὴν τῶν ζώων γένεσιν καὶ τροφήν τὴν μὲν τις ἂν ἴδοι μονοτροφίαν οὖσαν, τὴν δὲ κοινήν τῶν ἐν ταῖς ἀγέλαις θρεμμάτων ἐπιμέλειαν. NE. ΣΩ. ὀρθῶς. ΞΕ. ἀλλ' οὐ μὴν τόν γε πολιτικὸν εὐρήσομεν ἰδιοτρόφον, ὥσπερ βοηλάτην ἢ τινα ἵπποκόμον, ἀλλ' ἵπποφορβῶ τε καὶ βουφορβῶ μᾶλλον προσεοικότα. NE. ΣΩ. φαίνεται γὰρ δὴ ῥηθὲν νῦν.

ST: However, in the case of living creatures, their coming into being and their nurture may be seen in some cases to be nurture of one animal, while in other cases it is the care, in common, of beasts in herds.

YS: Correct.

ST: But we shall not find the statesman engaging in individual nurture, like an ox driver or a horse trainer. Rather, he bears more resemblance to a horse rancher or a cattle farmer.

YS: So it appears anyway, when you put it like that.

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ST: Now in the case of the nurture of living creatures, should we call common nurture of many of them together either herd nurture or nurture in common?

ΞΕ. πότερον οὖν τῆς ζωοτροφίας τὴν τῶν συμπόλλων κοινήν τροφήν ἀγελαιοτροφίαν ἢ κοινοτροφικὴν τινα ὀνομάζομεν; NE. ΣΩ. ὁπότερον ἂν ἐν τῷ λόγῳ συμβαίνει. ΞΕ. καλῶς γε, ὦ Σώκρατες· κἂν διαφυλάξης τὸ μὴ σπουδάζειν ἐπὶ τοῖς ὀνόμασιν, πλουσιώτερος εἰς τὸ γῆρας ἀναφανήσῃ φρονήσεως. νῦν δὲ τοῦτο μὲν, καθάπερ διακελεύῃ, ποιητέον· τὴν δὲ ἀγελαιοτροφικὴν ἄρ' ἐννοεῖς πῇ

YS: Whichever occurs to us in the course of the argument.

ST: Well said, Socrates! And if you preserve this lack of seriousness towards names, you will prove to be wealthier in wisdom as you approach old age. And we should do exactly as you have directed us.

But with regard to herd nurture, can you think of some way that we could show that it is twofold so that what we are now searching for among the pair may be sought thereafter in one of the halves?

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YS: I am eager to do so, and it seems to me that there is a particular sort of nurture concerned with human beings, and a different one concerned with beasts.

τις δίδυμον ἀποφήνας τὸ ζητούμενον ἐν διπλασίοισι τὰ νῦν ἐν τοῖς ἡμίσεσιν εἰς τότε ποιήσει ζητεῖσθαι; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. προθυμήσομαι. καὶ μοι δοκεῖ τῶν μὲν ἀνθρώπων ἑτέρα τις εἶναι, τῶν δ' αὖ θηρίων ἄλλη τροφή. ΞΕ. παντάπασί γε προθυμότατα καὶ ἀνδρειότατα διήρησαι· μὴ μέντοι τοῦτο γε εἰς αὖθις κατὰ δύναμιν πάσχωμεν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. τὸ ποῖον; ΞΕ. μὴ σμικρὸν μόριον ἐν πρὸς μεγάλα καὶ πολλὰ

ST: You made that distinction with enormous eagerness and the utmost courage. However, as best we can, let's not allow this to happen to us again.

YS: What are you referring to?

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ST: Let's not separate off one small part relative to many large ones, or proceed without forms. Rather, let the part simultaneously possess form. Indeed, it is all very well to separate immediately what is being sought from the rest, provided it is done properly, just as you thought that you had the division a moment ago when you rushed the argument once you saw that it was moving in the direction of human beings. However, my friend, it is not safe to work with fine divisions. Rather, it is safer to proceed by cutting through the mid-points, for then you would be more likely to encounter forms. This makes all the difference to such enquiries.

ἀφαιρῶμεν, μηδὲ εἶδους χωρίς· ἀλλὰ τὸ μέρος ἅμα εἶδος ἐχέτω. κάλλιστον μὲν γὰρ ἀπὸ τῶν ἄλλων εὐθὺς διαχωρίζειν τὸ ζητούμενον, ἂν ὀρθῶς ἔχη, καθάπερ ὀλίγον σὺ πρότερον οἰηθεὶς ἔχειν τὴν διαίρεσιν ἐπέσπευσας τὸν λόγον, ἰδὼν ἐπ' ἀνθρώπους πορευόμενον· ἀλλὰ γάρ, ὦ

φίλε, λεπτοργεῖν οὐκ ἀσφαλές, διὰ μέσων δὲ ἀσφαλέστερον ἵεναι τέμνοντας, καὶ μᾶλλον ιδέαις ἂν τις προστυγχάνοι. τοῦτο δὲ διαφέρει τὸ

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YS: What do you mean by this, stranger?

πᾶν πρὸς τὰς ζητήσεις. NE. ΣΩ. πῶς, ὦ ξένε, λέγεις τοῦτο; ΞΕ. πειρατέον ἔτι σαφέστερον φράζειν εὐνοίᾳ τῆς σῆς φύσεως, ὦ Σώκρατες. ἐν τῷ μὲν οὖν παρεστηκότι τὰ νῦν δηλῶσαι μηδὲν ἐνδεῶς ἀδύνατον· ἐπιχειρητέον δέ τι καὶ σμικρῷ πλέον αὐτὸ προαγαγεῖν εἰς τὸ πρόσθεν σαφηνείας ἕνεκα. NE. ΣΩ. ποῖον οὖν δὴ φράζεις διαιρουμένους ἡμᾶς οὐκ ὀρθῶς ἄρτι δρᾶν; ΞΕ. τοιόνδε, οἷον εἴ τις τάνθρώπινον ἐπιχειρήσας δίχα διελέσθαι γένος διαιροῖ καθάπερ οἱ πολλοὶ τῶν ἐνθάδε διανέμουσι, τὸ μὲν Ἑλληνικὸν ὡς ἐν ἀπὸ πάντων ἀφαιροῦντες χωρὶς, σύμπασιν δὲ τοῖς ἄλλοις γένεσιν, ἀπείροις οὔσι καὶ ἀμείκτοις καὶ ἀσυμφώνοις πρὸς ἄλληλα, βάρβαρον μιᾷ κλήσει προσειπόντες αὐτὸ διὰ ταύτην τὴν μίαν κλήσιν καὶ γένος ἐν αὐτὸ εἶναι προσδοκῶσιν· ἢ τὸν ἀριθμὸν τις αὖ νομίζει κατ' εἶδη δύο διαιρεῖν μυριάδα ἀποτεμνόμενος ἀπὸ πάντων,

ST: We should attempt to express this even more clearly, Socrates, out of respect for your nature. Now, under the present circumstances it is impossible to present comprehensively, yet I should endeavour to advance the issue a little further for the sake of clarity.

YS: Well then, what are you saying we did incorrectly just now, when we were making our divisions?

ST: It is as if someone, attempting to divide the human race in two, were to make the division, just as most people in our part of the world make the distribution, separating the Greek race, as one, separate from them the rest, while referring to all the other races together by one name, non-Greek, even though they are unlimited in number, do not mix, and do not share a common language. And on account of this one name, they also presume it to be one race. Or, it's as if someone were to believe he was dividing number on the basis of two forms by cutting

off the number ten thousand from all the others, separating it off as one form, and assigning one name to all the remainder. And then, because of the name, went on to presume that this class, a different one from the other one, had come into being. But presumably he would make better divisions, more on the basis of forms, and into two, if he were to cut number into odd and even, and the human race in turn into male and female. He would only split off Lydians or Phrygians,⁴ or any others, from everything else in situations where he was at a loss to discover a part that is, at the same time, also a class for each of the two parts that had been split off.

262e

YS: Absolutely correct. But just explain this, stranger. How might one recognise more plainly a class and a part as not the same, but as different from one another?

ὥς ἐν εἶδος ἀποχωρίζων, καὶ τῷ λοιπῷ δὴ παντὶ θέμενος ἐν ὄνομα διὰ τὴν κλησιν αὐτὸ καὶ τοῦτ' ἀξιοῖ γένος ἐκείνου χωρὶς ἕτερον ἐν γίγνεσθαι. κάλλιον δέ που καὶ μᾶλλον κατ' εἶδη καὶ δίχα διαιροῖτ' ἄν, εἰ τὸν μὲν ἀριθμὸν ἀρτίῳ καὶ περιττῷ τις τέμνοι, τὸ δὲ αὐτῶν ἀνθρώπων γένος ἄρρενι καὶ θήλει, Λυδοὺς δὲ ἢ Φρύγας ἢ τινὰς ἑτέρους πρὸς ἅπαντας τάττων ἀποσχίζει τότε, ἡνίκά ἀποροῖ γένος ἅμα καὶ μέρος εὐρίσκειν

ST: Oh, most excellent of men! The task you are assigning me is no ordinary one, Socrates. And although we have now wandered further than necessary from the argument before us, you are asking us to stray even further. Well, we should now do what is reasonable and resume the argument once more, and come back to these other issues at our leisure, just as trackers do. However, you must be completely on your guard against ever presuming that you have heard me make this distinction plainly.

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YS: What distinction?

ἐκάτερον τῶν σχισθέντων. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ὀρθότατα· ἀλλὰ γὰρ τοῦτο αὐτό, ὃ ξένη, πῶς ἂν τις γένος καὶ μέρος ἐναργέστερον γνοίῃ, ὥς οὐ ταυτόν

ἔστων ἀλλ' ἕτερον ἀλλήλοιν; ΞΕ. ὦ βέλτιστε ἀνδρῶν, οὐ φαῦλον προστάτεις, Σώκρατες. ἡμεῖς μὲν καὶ νῦν μακροτέραν τοῦ δέοντος ἀπὸ τοῦ προτεθέντος λόγου πεπλανήμεθα, σὺ δὲ ἔτι πλέον ἡμᾶς κελεύεις πλανηθῆναι. νῦν μὲν οὖν, ὥσπερ εἰκός, ἐπανίωμεν

ST: That form and part are different from one another.

YS: What should I presume instead?

ST: That whenever there is a form of something, then this is also, of necessity, a part of the subject of which it is said to be a form, but there is no necessity whatsoever that a part be a form. You should always say that I formulate it like this rather than the other way.

YS: That's what I'll do.

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ST: Well, tell me what comes next.

πάλιν· ταῦτα δὲ εἰς αὐθις κατὰ σχολὴν καθάπερ ἰχνεύοντες μέτιμεν. οὐ μὴν ἀλλὰ τοῦτό γε αὖ παντάπασιν φύλαξαι, μή ποτε παρ' ἐμοῦ δόξης αὐτὸ ἐναργῶς διωρισμένον ἀκηκοέναι. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. τὸ ποῖον; ΞΕ. εἶδος τε καὶ μέρος ἕτερον ἀλλήλων εἶναι. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. τί μὴν; ΞΕ. ὥς εἶδος μὲν ὅταν ᾗ του, καὶ μέρος αὐτὸ ἀναγκαῖον εἶναι τοῦ πράγματος ὅτουπερ ἂν εἶδος λέγηται· μέρος δὲ εἶδος οὐδεμία ἀνάγκη. ταύτη με ἢ 'κείνη μᾶλλον, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἀεὶ φάθι λέγειν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ταῦτ' ἔσται.

YS: What is it?

ST: The point of departure of the digression that has led us here. Indeed, I have in mind, in particular, the point where you were asked how 'herd nurture' should be divided, and you replied very eagerly that there are two classes of living creatures, one human and another one consisting of all the rest of the beasts put together.

YS: True.

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ST: Well, you seemed to me anyway to believe that having taken away a part, you had left behind a remainder, which, in turn, was one class

belonging to all of them, because you were able to assign the same name to them all and call them beasts.

ΞΕ. φράσον δὴ μοι τὸ μετὰ τοῦτο. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ποῖον; ΞΕ. τὸ τῆς ἀποπλανήσεως ὁπόθεν ἡμᾶς δεῦρ' ἤγαγεν. οἶμαι μὲν γὰρ μάλιστα, ὅθεν ἐρωτηθεὶς σὺ τὴν ἀγγελαιοτροφίαν ὅπη διαιρετέον εἶπες μάλα προθύμως δὺ' εἶναι ζώων γένη, τὸ μὲν ἀνθρώπινον, ἕτερον δὲ τῶν ἄλλων συμπάντων θηρίων ἔν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ἀληθῆ. ΞΕ. καὶ ἔμοιγε δὴ τότε ἐφάνης μέρος ἀφαιρῶν ἡγεῖσθαι καταλιπεῖν τὸ λοιπὸν αὐτῶν πάντων γένος ἔν, ὅτι πᾶσι ταῦτόν

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YS: That is indeed what happened.

ἐπονομάζειν ἔσχες ὄνομα, θηρία καλέσας. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ἦν καὶ ταῦτα οὕτως. ΞΕ. τὸ δέ γε, ὧ πάντων ἀνδρείοτατε, τάχ' ἂν, εἴ που φρόνιμόν ἐστί τι ζῶον ἕτερον, οἷον δοκεῖ τὸ τῶν γεράνων, ἢ τι τοιοῦτον ἄλλο, ὃ κατὰ ταῦτ' ἴσως διονομάζει καθάπερ καὶ σὺ, γεράνους μὲν ἔν γένος ἀντιτιθεὶν τοῖς ἄλλοις ζώοις καὶ σεμνῦνον αὐτὸ ἑαυτό, τὰ δὲ ἄλλα μετὰ τῶν ἀνθρώπων συλλαβὸν εἰς ταῦτόν οὐδὲν ἄλλο πλὴν ἴσως θηρία προσείποι.

ST: And yet, my utterly courageous friend, if there were some other animal that is intelligent, as the crane, for instance, or some other such creature seems to be, perhaps they would also assign names on the very same basis as you did, with cranes as a single class set against all other animals, making itself important. And having gathered all the others, along with human beings, into a single class, they would refer to them as nothing in particular, except perhaps beasts. So we should endeavour to be careful of all processes of this sort.

263e

YS: In what way?

πειραθῶμεν οὖν ἡμεῖς ἐξευλαβεῖσθαι πάνθ' ὅποσα τοιαῦτα. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. πῶς; ΞΕ. μὴ πᾶν τὸ τῶν ζώων γένος διαιρούμενοι, ἵνα ἦττον αὐτὰ πάσχωμεν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. οὐδὲν γὰρ δεῖ. ΞΕ. καὶ γὰρ οὖν καὶ τότε ἡμαρτάνετο ταύτῃ. ΝΕ.

ΣΩ. τί δῆ; ΞΕ. τῆς γνωστικῆς ὅσον ἐπιτακτικὸν ἡμῖν μέρος ἦν που τοῦ ζωοτροφικοῦ γένους, ἀγελαίων μὴν ζώων. ἧ γάρ; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ναί.

ST: By not dividing the entire class of living beings, so that this may be less likely to happen to us.

YS: Indeed, it shouldn't happen at all.

ST: And in fact this is also the way in which we went wrong then.

YS: How exactly?

ST: Belonging to cognitive knowledge that was directive, there was for us, I believe, a part of the animal rearing class, of animals in herds that is. Is this so?

YS: Yes.

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ST: Well, at that stage all living creatures together had already been divided into domesticated and wild, for those whose nature is amenable to domestication are referred to as tame, while those that resist it are called wild.

ΞΕ. διήρητο τοίνυν ἤδη καὶ τότε σύμπαν τὸ ζῶον τῷ τιθασῷ καὶ ἀγρίῳ. τὰ μὲν γὰρ ἔχοντα τιθασιεύεσθαι φύσιν ἡμεῖς προσείρηται, τὰ δὲ μὴ θέλοντα ἄγρια. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. καλῶς. ΞΕ. ἦν δέ γε θηρεύομεν ἐπιστήμην, ἐν τοῖς ἡμέροις ἦν τε καὶ ἔστιν, ἐπὶ τοῖς ἀγελαίοις μὴν ζητητέα θρέμματα. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ναί. ΞΕ. μὴ τοίνυν διαιρώμεθα ὥσπερ τότε πρὸς ἅπαντα ἀποβλέψαντες, μηδὲ σπεύσαντες, ἵνα δὴ ταχὺ γενώμεθα

YS: Good.

ST: And yet, the knowledge we are seeking was, and still is, applicable to the tame ones, and it should indeed be sought among herded beasts.

YS: Yes.

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ST: However, let us not make the division just as we did before when we looked to all of them, nor should we hurry so that we may get

quickly to statesmanship. Yes, that's what put us in the predicament described by the proverb.

πρὸς τῇ πολιτικῇ. πεποίηκε γὰρ ἡμᾶς καὶ νῦν παθεῖν τὸ κατὰ τὴν παροιμίαν πάθος. NE. ΣΩ. ποῖον; ΞΕ. οὐχ ἡσύχους εὖ διαιροῦντας ἡνυκέναι βραδύτερον. NE. ΣΩ. καὶ καλῶς γε, ὦ ξένε, πεποίηκε. ΞΕ. ταῦτ' ἔστω. πάλιν δ' οὖν ἐξ ἀρχῆς τὴν κοινοτροφικὴν πειρώμεθα διαιρεῖν· ἴσως γὰρ καὶ τοῦτο ὃ σὺ προθυμῇ διαπεραινόμενος ὁ λόγος αὐτός σοι κάλλιον μηνύσει. καί μοι φράζε. NE. ΣΩ. ποῖον δὴ; ΞΕ. τόδε, εἴ τινων πολλάκις ἄρα διακήκοας· οὐ γὰρ δὴ

YS: What predicament?

ST: By not being quiet and not making sound divisions, we have reached our destination more slowly.

YS: And our predicament is a good one, stranger.

ST: Be that as it may, let's try to divide common nurture once more from the beginning. For perhaps the detailed conduct of the argument itself will better reveal to you the very thing you are intent upon. Now, tell me something.

YS: What is it?

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ST: I want to know if you have often heard people referring to the fish cultivations on the Nile and in the Royal Ponds.⁵ Now, I know you won't have come across them yourself, although you may perhaps be aware of them in fountain pools.

προστυχῆς γε αὐτὸς οἶδ' ὅτι γέγονας ταῖς ἐν τῷ Νείλῳ τιθασείαις τῶν ἰχθύων καὶ τῶν ἐν ταῖς βασιλικαῖς λίμναις. ἐν μὲν γὰρ κρήναις τάχ' ἂν ἴσως εἴης ἡσθημένος. NE. ΣΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν καὶ ταῦτα τεθέσθαι κάκεῖνα πολλῶν ἀκήκοα. ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν χηνοβωτίας γε καὶ γερανοβωτίας, εἰ καὶ μὴ πεπλάνησαι περὶ τὰ Θετταλικά πεδία, πέψυσαι γοῦν καὶ πιστεύεις εἶναι. NE. ΣΩ. τί μήν;

YS: Yes, indeed, these I have seen, and the others I have heard about from many people.

ST: And even if you have not traversed the plains of Thessaly, you have surely learned of their goose farms and crane farms and believe that these exist.

YS: Of course.

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ST: The reason I am asking you all these questions is this: it's because the nurture of herds is either water-based or land-based.

ΞΕ. τοῦδ' ἔνεκά τοι πάντα ἠρώτησα ταῦτα, διότι τῆς τῶν ἀγελαίων τροφῆς ἔστι μὲν ἔνυδρον, ἔστι δὲ καὶ ξηροβατικόν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ἔστι γὰρ οὖν. ΞΕ. ἄρ' οὖν καὶ σοὶ συνδοκεῖ ταύτῃ δεῖν διχάζειν τὴν κοινοτροφικὴν ἐπιστήμην, ἐφ' ἑκατέρῳ τούτων τὸ μέρος αὐτῆς ἐπινέμοντας ἑκάτερον, τὸ μὲν ἕτερον ὑγροτροφικὸν ὀνομάζοντας, τὸ δ' ἕτερον ξηροτροφικόν; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ἔμοιγε. ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν καὶ τὸ βασιλικὸν οὕτως οὐ ζητήσομεν

YS: It is, indeed.

ST: So, do you also agree that it is necessary to split the knowledge of common nurture in this way, allocating each of the two parts of it to either of these divisions, and referring to one as water-based nurture and the other as land-based nurture?

264e

YS: I think so.

ὁποτέρας ἐστὶ τῆς τέχνης· δῆλον δὲ γὰρ παντί. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. πῶς δ' οὐ; ΞΕ. πᾶς μὲν δὴ τό γε ξηροτροφικὸν τῆς ἀγελαιοτροφίας διέλοιτ' ἂν φύλον. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. πῶς; ΞΕ. τῷ πτηνῷ τε καὶ πεζῷ διορισάμενος. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ἀληθέστατα. ΞΕ. τί δέ; τὸ πολιτικὸν ἢ περὶ τὸ πεζὸν ζητητέον; ἢ οὐκ οἶει καὶ τὸν ἀφρονέστατον ὥς ἔπος εἰπεῖν δοξάζειν οὕτως; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ἔγωγε. ΞΕ. τὴν δὲ πεζονομικὴν, καθάπερ ἄρτι τὸν ἀριθμόν, δεῖ τευνομένην δίχα ἀποφαίνειν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. δῆλον.

ST: And, of course, we shall not enquire which of the two skills belongs to kingship, for that is obvious to everyone.

YS: Of course.

ST: Now, in the case of herd nurture, everyone would presumably further divide the land nurture part.

YS: In what way?

ST: By distinguishing the winged and those that go by foot.

YS: Very true.

ST: What about this? Should the statesman not be sought among the sort that goes by foot? Or don't you believe that even an utterly mindless person, so to speak, would accept this?

YS: I do.

265a

ST: And we should demonstrate the skill in managing those that go by foot being cut in two, just like an even number.

ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν ἐφ' ὃ γε μέρος ὥρμηκεν ἡμῖν ὁ λόγος, ἐπ' ἐκεῖνο δύο τινὲ καθορᾶν ὁδῶ τεταμένα φαίνεται, τὴν μὲν θάττω, πρὸς μέγα μέρος σμικρὸν διαιρουμένην, τὴν δέ, ὅπερ ἐν τῷ πρόσθεν ἐλέγομεν ὅτι δεῖ μεσοτομεῖν ὡς μάλιστα, τοῦτ' ἔχουσιν μᾶλλον, μακροτέραν γε μὴν. ἔξεστιν οὖν ὁποτέραν ἂν βουληθῶμεν, ταύτην πορευθῆναι. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. τί δέ; ἀμφοτέρως ἀδύνατον; ΞΕ. ἅμα γ', ὧ θαυμαστέ· ἐν μέρει γε μὴν δῆλον ὅτι δυνατόν.

YS: Obviously.

ST: And, indeed, it appears that there are two clear approaches towards the part to which our argument is directed. One is quicker since it separates a small part from the large, while the other is longer but adheres more to the principle we stated previously, whereby we should, for the most part, cut in the middle. So, we can proceed by whichever path we wish.

YS: Why? Is it impossible to take both?

265b

ST: At the same time? How extraordinary! But it is possible of course to take each in turn.

NE. ΣΩ. ἐν μέρει τοίνυν ἔγωγε ἀμφοτέρας αἰροῦμαι. ΞΕ. ῥάδιον, ἐπειδὴ τὸ λοιπὸν βραχύ κατ' ἀρχὰς μὴν καὶ μεσοῦσιν ἅμα τῆς πορείας χαλεπὸν ἂν ἦν ἡμῖν τὸ πρόσταγμα. νῦν δ', ἐπειδὴ δοκεῖ ταύτη, τὴν μακροτέραν πρότερον ἴωμεν· νεαλέστεροι γὰρ ὄντες ῥᾶον αὐτὴν πορευσόμεθα. τὴν δὲ δὴ διαίρεσιν ὄρα. NE. ΣΩ. λέγε. ΞΕ. τὰ πεζὰ ἡμῖν τῶν ἡμέρων, ὅσα περ ἀγελαῖα, διηρημένα ἐστὶ φύσει δίχα. NE. ΣΩ. τίνι; ΞΕ. τῷ τῶν μὲν τὴν γένεσιν ἄκερων εἶναι, τῶν δὲ κερασφόρον.

YS: In that case, I choose each in turn.

ST: That is easier, since there is little left for us to do. Yes, at the beginning, or indeed if we were midway through the process, this would be a difficult task for us. But now, since you want to do this, let's go the longer way first, since we shall pursue this more easily when we are fresher. Now, take note of the division.

YS: Tell me.

ST: Our tame creatures that go by foot and live in herds are, by nature, divided in two.

YS: On what basis?

ST: On the basis that some are hornless while the others are horn-bearing.

YS: Apparently.

265c

ST: Now, divide the skill of managing creatures that go on foot, and assign it to each of these parts. But have recourse to a description, for if you ever decide to name them, the issue will get more complicated than necessary.

NE. ΣΩ. φαίνεται. ΞΕ. τὴν δὴ πεζονομικὴν διελὼν ἀπόδος ἑκατέρῳ τῷ μέρει λόγῳ χρώμενος. ἂν γὰρ ὀνομάζειν αὐτὰ βουληθῆς, ἔσται σοι περιπεπλεγμένον μᾶλλον τοῦ δέοντος. NE. ΣΩ. πῶς οὖν χρή λέγειν; ΞΕ. ὧδε· τῆς πεζονομικῆς ἐπιστήμης δίχα διαιρεθείσης τὸ μῦριον θάτερον ἐπὶ τῷ κερασφόρῳ μέρει τῷ τῆς ἀγέλης ἐπιτετάχθαι, τὸ δὲ ἕτερον ἐπὶ τῷ τῆς ἀκεράτου.

YS: So how should it be described?

ST: As follows. Once the knowledge of managing those that go on foot has been divided in two, one part is assigned to the horn-bearing part of the herd, and the other to the hornless part.

YS: Let them be described like this, for the point has been made abundantly clear.

265d

ST: And what's more, it is quite apparent to us that the king is shepherd to some stunted herd of hornless creatures.

NE. ΣΩ. ταῦτ' ἔστω αὕτη λεχθέντα· πάντως γὰρ ἱκανῶς δεδήλωται. ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν ὃ γε βασιλεὺς ἡμῖν αὖ καταφανὴς ὅτι κολοβὸν ἀγέλην τινὰ κεράτων νομεύει. NE. ΣΩ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ δῆλος; ΞΕ. αὐτὴν τοίνυν καταθραύσαντες τὸ γιγνόμενον αὐτῷ πειρώμεθα ἀποδοῦναι. NE. ΣΩ. πάνυ γε. ΞΕ. πότερον οὖν βούλει τῷ σχιστῷ τε καὶ τῷ καλουμένῳ μώνυχι διαιρεῖν αὐτὴν ἢ τῇ κοινογονίᾳ τε καὶ ἰδιογονίᾳ; μανθάνεις γάρ που. NE. ΣΩ. τὸ ποῖον;

YS: Yes, how could it not be obvious?

ST: Then we should break this up and try to grant him the part that belongs to him.

YS: Entirely so.

ST: Now, do you wish to divide it into split-hoofed and the so-called single-hoofed, or into mixed bred and pure bred? You understand, I presume?

YS: Understand what?

265e

ST: That horses and donkeys, by nature, breed from one another.

ΞΕ. ὅτι τὸ μὲν τῶν ἵππων καὶ ὄνων πέφυκεν ἐξ ἀλλήλων γεννᾶν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ναί. ΞΕ. τὸ δέ γε λοιπὸν ἔτι τῆς λείας ἀγέλης τῶν ἡμέρων ἀμιγῆς γένει πρὸς ἄλληλα. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. πῶς δ' οὐ; ΞΕ. τί δ'; ὁ πολιτικὸς ἄρ' ἐπιμέλειαν ἔχειν φαίνεται πότερα κοινογενοῦς φύσεως ἢ τινος ἰδιογενοῦς; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. δῆλον ὅτι τῆς ἀμείκτου. ΞΕ. ταύτην δὴ δεῖ καθάπερ τὰ ἔμπροσθεν, ὡς ἔοικεν, ἡμᾶς δίχα διαστέλλειν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. δεῖ γὰρ οὖν.

YS: Yes.

ST: And yet, the rest of the smooth herd of tame creatures do not interbreed with one another.

YS: Of course not.

ST: Well then, does the statesman appear to have the care of a mixed-bred nature or of something pure bred?

YS: He obviously has care of the unmixed nature.

ST: Then it seems we should break this in two, just as we did in the previous cases.

YS: Yes, we should do that.

266a

ST: And, indeed, the creatures that are tame and live in herds have been almost entirely divided up at this stage, except for two classes. Indeed, the class of dogs does not deserve to be counted among animals living in herds.

ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν τό γε ζῶον, ὅσον ἡμέρον καὶ ἀγελαῖον, σχεδὸν πλὴν γενοῖν δυοῖν πᾶν ἤδη κατακεκερμάτισται. τὸ γὰρ τῶν κυνῶν οὐκ ἐπάξιον καταριθμεῖν γένος ὡς ἐν ἀγελαίοις θρέμμασιν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. οὐ γὰρ οὖν. ἀλλὰ τίτι δὴ τῷ δύο διαιροῦμεν; ΞΕ. ὥπερ καὶ δίκαιόν γε Θεαίτητόν τε καὶ σὲ διανέμειν, ἐπειδὴ καὶ γεωμετρίας ἄπτεσθον. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. τῷ; ΞΕ. τῇ διαμέτρῳ δήπου καὶ πάλιν τῇ τῆς διαμέτρου διαμέτρῳ. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. πῶς εἶπες;

YS: Of course not. But by what are we to separate the two?

ST: The very thing by which yourself and Theaetetus may rightly make the division, since you have both taken to geometry.⁶

YS: By what?

ST: By the diagonal, I presume, and once more by the diagonal of the diagonal.

YS: What do you mean?

266b

ST: The nature which our class of human beings has acquired is surely adapted for motion, just like the diagonal which has the power of two feet?

ΞΕ. ἡ φύσις, ἣν τὸ γένος ἡμῶν τῶν ἀνθρώπων κέκτῃται, μὴν ἄλλως πως εἰς τὴν πορείαν πέφυκεν ἢ καθάπερ ἡ διάμετρος ἡ δυνάμει δίπους; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. οὐκ ἄλλως. ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν ἢ γε τοῦ λοιποῦ γένους πάλιν ἐστὶ κατὰ δυνάμιν αὖ τῆς ἡμετέρας δυνάμεως διάμετρος, εἴπερ δυοῖν γέ ἐστι ποδοῖν δις πεφυκυῖα. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. πῶς δ' οὐκ ἔστι; καὶ δὴ καὶ σχεδὸν ὁ βούλει δηλοῦν μανθάνω. ΞΕ. πρὸς δὴ τούτοις ἕτερον αὖ τι τῶν πρὸς γέλωτα

YS: Just so.

ST: Then again, the nature of the remaining class, on the basis of power, is in turn the diagonal of our power, if by nature it is twice two feet.⁷

YS: How could it not be? And, indeed, I almost understand what you wish to demonstrate.

266c

ST: What's more, Socrates, do we see that something has happened to us in the course of these divisions which could be a theme for the greatest comedy?

εὐδοκιμησάντων ἄν, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἄρα καθορώμεν ἡμῖν γεγονὸς ἐν τοῖς διηρημένοις; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. τὸ ποῖον; ΞΕ. τὰνθρώπινον ἡμῶν ἅμα γένος

συνειληχὸς καὶ συνδεδραμικὸς γένει τῷ τῶν ὄντων γενναιοτάτῳ καὶ ἅμα εὐχερεστάτῳ. NE. ΣΩ. καθορῶ καὶ μάλ' ἀτόπως συμβαῖνον. ΞΕ. τί δ'; οὐκ εἰκὸς ὕστατα ἀφικνεῖσθαι τὰ βραδύτατα; NE. ΣΩ. ναί, τοῦτό γε. ΞΕ. τότε δὲ οὐκ ἐννοοῦμεν, ὥς ἔτι γελοιότερος ὁ βασιλεὺς φαίνεται μετὰ τῆς ἀγέλης συνδιαθέων καὶ σύνδρομα

YS: In what way?

ST: This human race of ours has shared the lot and run the course with the noblest, and at the same time, most easy-going class of creatures.⁸

YS: I see. And it is unfolding in a most unusual manner.

ST: What about this? Aren't the slowest likely to arrive last?⁹

YS: Yes, I'll grant you that anyway.

266d

ST: And don't we observe that the king appears even more comical as he runs along with the herd, and proceeds down a shared course, as the man who for his part is better trained than anyone for an easygoing life.¹⁰

πεπορευμένος τῷ τῶν ἀνδρῶν αὖ πρὸς τὸν εὐχερῇ βίον ἄριστα γεγυμνασμένῳ; NE. ΣΩ. παντάπασι μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. νῦν γάρ, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἐκεῖνό ἐστι καταφανὲς μᾶλλον τὸ ῥηθὲν τότε ἐν τῇ περὶ τὸν σοφιστὴν ζητήσει. NE. ΣΩ. τὸ ποῖον; ΞΕ. ὅτι τῇ τοιαύτῃ μεθόδῳ τῶν λόγων οὔτε σεμνοτέρου μᾶλλον ἐμέλησεν ἢ μή, τὸν τε σμικρότερον οὐδὲν ἡτίμακε πρὸ τοῦ μείζονος, αἰὲ δὲ καθ' αὐτὴν περαίνει ἀληθέστατον. NE. ΣΩ. ἔοικεν. ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν μετὰ τοῦτο, ἵνα μή με φθῆς ἐρωτήσας τὴν

YS: Entirely so.

ST: And now, Socrates, the point that was made before, during our investigation into the sophist, is more obvious.¹¹

YS: What point?

ST: That in such a method of argument as this, there is no more concern for what is serious than what is not, and the trivial is given no

less respect than the important. Rather, it always reaches the very truest by itself.

YS: So it seems.

266e

ST: After this, shall I proceed down the shorter path we mentioned before, the one that leads to the definition of the king, so that you don't have to ask me?

βραχυτέραν ὁδὸν ἥτις τότε ἦν ἐπὶ τὸν τοῦ βασιλέως ὅρον, αὐτός σοι πρότερον ἔλθω; NE. ΣΩ. σφόδρα γε. ΞΕ. λέγω δὴ δεῖν τότε εὐθὺς τὸ πεζὸν τῷ δίποδι πρὸς τὸ τετράπουον γένος διανεῖμαι, κατιδόντα δὲ τάνθρωπινον ἔτι μόνῳ τῷ πτηνῷ συνειληχὸς τὴν δίποδα ἀγέλην πάλιν τῷ ψιλῷ καὶ τῷ πτεροφυεῖ τέμνειν, τμηθείσης δὲ αὐτῆς καὶ τότε ἤδη τῆς ἀνθρωπονομικῆς δηλωθείσης τέχνης, φέροντα τὸν πολιτικὸν καὶ βασιλικὸν οἶον ἡνίοχον εἰς αὐτὴν ἐνστήσαντα, παραδοῦναι τὰς τῆς πόλεως ἡνίας ὡς οἰκείας καὶ αὐτῷ ταύτης οὔσης τῆς ἐπιστήμης.

YS: Certainly.

267a

ST: Well, in that case, I say that those that go by foot should be assigned immediately to the two-footed or the four-footed class, and perceiving the human race still on its own, sharing the lot of those with feathers, we should cut the two-footed herd once more into featherless and feathered. But once it has been cut, and the skill in managing humans has been made evident, we should take the statesman, the kingly man, like a charioteer, and establish him within it, bestowing upon him the reins of the city as his own, since this knowledge is his.

NE. ΣΩ. καλῶς καὶ καθαπερεὶ χρέος ἀπέδωκάς μοι τὸν λόγον, προσθεὶς τὴν ἐκτροπὴν οἶον τόκον καὶ ἀναπληρώσας αὐτόν. ΞΕ. φέρε δὴ καὶ συνεῖρωμεν ἐπανελθόντες ἐπὶ τὴν ἀρχὴν μέχρι τῆς τελευτῆς τὸν λόγον τοῦ ὀνόματος τῆς τοῦ πολιτικοῦ τέχνης. NE. ΣΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. τῆς γνωστικῆς τοίνυν ἐπιστήμης ἡμῖν ἦν κατ' ἀρχὰς μέρος ἐπιτακτικόν· τούτου δὲ ἀπεικασθὲν τὸ μόριον αὐτεπιτακτικόν

267b

YS: You have rendered this account beautifully, and as if I were in your debt, you have added on the digression by way of interest to fill it out.

ἐρρήθη. ζωοτροφική δὲ πάλιν αὐτεπιτακτικῆς οὐ τὸ σμικρότατον τῶν γενῶν ἀπεσχίζετο· καὶ ζωοτροφικῆς εἶδος ἀγγελαιοτροφικόν, ἀγγελαιοτροφικοῦ δ' αὖ πεζονομικόν· τοῦ δὲ πεζονομικοῦ μάλιστα ἀπετέμενετο τέχνη τῆς ἀκεράτου φύσεως θρεπτική. ταύτης δ' αὖ τὸ μέρος οὐκ ἔλαττον τριπλοῦν συμπλέκειν ἀναγκαῖον, ἅν εἰς ἓν τις αὐτὸ ὄνομα συναγαγεῖν βουληθῇ, γενέσεως ἀμείκτου νομευτικὴν ἐπιστήμην προσαγορεύων.

ST: Come on, then. Let's draw together this account of the name of the statesman's skill, by going back over it from the beginning to the end.

YS: Certainly.

ST: Well, at the beginning we had a directive part of cognitive knowledge, and part of this was said, by comparison, to be 'own-directing'. Again, animal nurture, not the smallest of the classes, was split off from 'own-directing'; then a herd nurture form from animal nurture; and then command of those that go by foot from herd nurture; and in particular, from the management of those that go by foot, the skill in nurturing the hornless nature was cut off. But if we wish to construct one name for the subsequent part, it is necessary to weave together no less than three, and refer to it as the knowledge of the shepherding of the unmixed breed. And the cut from this, applied to the two-footed flock, still left the part concerned with the management of humans on its own. And this is already the very thing we sought, the same thing referred to at once as kingly, and as statesman-like.

267c

YS: Entirely so.

τὸ δ' ἀπὸ τούτου τμήμα, ἐπὶ ποιμνῇ δίποδι μέρος ἀνθρωπονομικὸν ἔτι λειφθὲν μόνον, τοῦτ' αὐτὸ ἐστὶν ἤδη τὸ ζητηθέν, ἅμα βασιλικὸν ταῦτὸν κληθὲν καὶ πολιτικόν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. παντάπασι μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. ἄρά γ', ὦ

Σώκρατες, ἀληθῶς ἡμῖν τοῦτο καθάπερ σὺ νῦν εἴρηκας οὕτως ἐστὶ καὶ πεπραγμένον; NE. ΣΩ. τὸ ποῖον δῆ; ΞΕ. τὸ παντάπασιν ἱκανῶς εἰρῆσθαι τὸ προτεθέν; ἢ τοῦτ' αὐτὸ καὶ μάλιστα ἡ ζήτησις ἐλλείπει, τὸ τὸν λόγον

267d

ST: Is this really how the matter stands, Socrates? Has our task been accomplished, as you have just said?

εἰρῆσθαι μὲν πως, οὐ μὴν παντάπασί γε τελέως ἀπειργάσθαι; NE. ΣΩ. πῶς εἶπες; ΞΕ. ἐγὼ νῶν πειράσομαι τοῦτ' αὐτὸ ὃ διανοοῦμαι νῦν ἔτι μᾶλλον δηλῶσαι. NE. ΣΩ. λέγοις ἄν. ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν τῶν νομευτικῶν ἡμῖν πολλῶν φανεισῶν ἄρτι τεχνῶν μία τις ἦν ἡ πολιτικὴ καὶ μιᾶς τινος ἀγέλης ἐπιμέλεια; NE. ΣΩ. ναί. ΞΕ. ταύτην δέ γε διώριζεν ὁ λόγος οὐχ ἵππων εἶναι τροφὸν οὐδ' ἄλλων θηρίων, ἀλλ' ἀνθρώπων κοινοτροφικὴν ἐπιστήμην. NE. ΣΩ. οὕτως.

YS: What task?

ST: The comprehensive description of the subject in an adequate manner. Yes, our search does lack one feature in particular, that it has somehow given us an account of the matter, but this has not been accomplished perfectly and comprehensively.

YS: What do you mean?

ST: I shall now try to make the very issue I am thinking of even more clear to both of us.

YS: Please proceed.

ST: Of the numerous skills of shepherding that were presented to us just now, was one of the skills statesmanship? And was it the care of one particular kind of herd?

YS: Yes.

267e

ST: Yes. And the argument determined this not as the nurture of horses, or of other beasts either, but as the knowledge of the common nurture of human beings.

ΞΕ. τὸ δὴ τῶν νομέων πάντων διάφορον καὶ τὸ τῶν βασιλέων θεασώμεθα. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. τὸ ποῖον; ΞΕ. εἴ τις τῶν ἄλλων τῷ, τέχνης ἄλλης ὄνομα ἔχων, κοινῇ τῆς ἀγέλης σύντροφος εἶναί φησι καὶ προσποιεῖται. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. πῶς φῆς; ΞΕ. οἷον οἱ ἔμποροι καὶ γεωργοὶ καὶ σιτουργοὶ πάντες, καὶ πρὸς τοῦτοις γυμναστὰι καὶ τὸ τῶν ἱατρῶν γένος, οἷσθ' ὅτι τοῖς περὶ τὰ ἀνθρώπινα νομεῦσιν, οὓς πολιτικούς ἐκαλέσαμεν,

YS: So it did.

ST: Let's look at the difference between all other herdsmen and kings.

YS: What sort of difference?

268a

ST: Let's see if any of the others, bearing the name of some other skill, claim to join with the king in the common nurture of the herd, and pretends to do so.

παντάπασι τῷ λόγῳ διαμάχουσιν' ἂν οὗτοι σύμπαντες, ὡς σφεῖς τῆς τροφῆς ἐπιμελοῦνται τῆς ἀνθρωπίνης, οὐ μόνον ἀγελαίων ἀνθρώπων ἀλλὰ καὶ τῆς τῶν ἀρχόντων αὐτῶν; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ὀρθῶς ἂν λέγοιεν; ΞΕ. ἴσως. καὶ τοῦτο μὲν ἐπισκεψόμεθα, τόδε δὲ ἴσμεν, ὅτι βουκόλῳ γε οὐδεὶς ἀμφισβητήσει περὶ τούτων οὐδενός, ἀλλ' αὐτὸς τῆς ἀγέλης τροφὸς ὁ βουφορβός, αὐτὸς ἱατρός, αὐτὸς οἷον νυμφευτὴς καὶ περὶ τοὺς τῶν γιγνομένων τόκους

YS: In what sense do you mean this?

ST: Take, for instance, all traders, farmers and bakers, and in addition to these the gymnastic trainers and the class of physicians. Do you realise that these fellows would all battle comprehensively in argument against those shepherds, of all things human, whom we call statesmen, claiming that they are the ones who care for the nurture of humanity, and not only for herds of human beings, but for those who rule over them too?

YS: And wouldn't they be right to say so?

268b

ST: Perhaps. This we shall investigate, but we do know that no one will argue with an oxherd on any of these issues. No, the herdsman himself is the nurturer of the herd. He himself is the physician, and he himself is a sort of matchmaker, and when it comes to childbirth and bringing children into the world, he alone is knowledgeable about midwifery. Then again, insofar as the beasts are naturally able to participate in music and education, no one is more powerful than he at consoling them and charming them into quietude, best at performing the music belonging to his own flock, on instruments or with the unaided voice. And, indeed, the other herdsman have the same manner. Is this so?

καὶ λοχείας μόνος ἐπιστήμων τῆς μαιευτικῆς. ἔτι τοίνυν παιδιᾶς καὶ μουσικῆς ἐφ’ ὅσον αὐτοῦ τὰ θρέμματα φύσει μετείληφεν, οὐκ ἄλλος κρείττων παραμυθεῖσθαι καὶ κηλῶν πραῦναι, μετὰ τε ὀργάνων καὶ ψιλῷ τῷ στόματι τὴν τῆς αὐτοῦ ποιμένης ἄριστα μεταχειριζόμενος μουσικῇν. καὶ δὴ καὶ τῶν ἄλλων πέρι νομέων ὁ αὐτὸς τρόπος. ἦ γάρ; NE. ΣΩ. ὀρθότατα. ΞΕ. πῶς οὖν ἡμῖν ὁ λόγος ὀρθὸς φανεῖται καὶ ἀκέραιος

YS: Quite right.

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ST: Now, how can our argument in relation to the king prove correct and flawless when we install him as the sole herdsman and nurturer of the human herd while singling him out from thousands of others who dispute this assertion?

ὁ περὶ τοῦ βασιλέως, ὅταν αὐτὸν νομέα καὶ τροφὸν ἀγέλης ἀνθρωπίνης θῶμεν μόνον ἐκκρίνοντες μυρίων ἄλλων ἀμφισβητούντων; NE. ΣΩ. οὐδαμῶς. ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν ὀρθῶς ὀλίγον ἔμπροσθεν ἐφοβήθημεν ὑποπτεύσαντες μὴ λέγοντες μὲν τι τυγχάνοιμεν σχῆμα βασιλικόν, οὐ μὴν ἀπειργασμένοι γε εἶμέν πω δι’ ἀκριβείας τὸν πολιτικόν, ἕως ἂν τοὺς περικεχυμένους αὐτῷ καὶ τῆς συννομῆς αὐτῷ ἀντιποιοιμένους περιελόντες καὶ χωρίσαντες ἀπ’ ἐκείνων καθαρὸν μόνον αὐτὸν ἀποφύνωμεν;

YS: We cannot do so at all.

ST: In that case, we were right to be afraid a moment ago, suspecting that although we might indeed turn out to be describing some kingly figure, we might not yet have given an accurate portrayal of the statesman until we had stripped away those who crowd about him and pretend to share his role. And once we had separated him from those fellows, we then revealed him pure and alone.

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YS: You're perfectly right.

NE. ΣΩ. ὀρθότατα μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. τοῦτο τοίνυν, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἡμῖν ποιητέον, εἰ μὴ μέλλομεν ἐπὶ τῷ τέλει καταισχυῖναι τὸν λόγον. NE. ΣΩ. ἀλλὰ μὴν οὐδαμῶς τοῦτό γε δραστέον. ΞΕ. πάλιν τοίνυν ἐξ ἄλλης ἀρχῆς δεῖ καθ' ἑτέραν ὁδὸν πορευθῆναί τινα. NE. ΣΩ. ποίαν δῆ; ΞΕ. σχεδὸν παιδιὰν ἐγκερασαμένους· συχνῶ γὰρ μέρος δεῖ μεγάλου μύθου προσχρήσασθαι, καὶ τὸ λοιπὸν δῆ, καθάπερ

ST: Then that's what must be done, Socrates, unless we want our argument to end up in disgrace.

YS: Well, that is something that we must never allow to happen at all.

ST: In that case, we need to proceed once more from another starting point based on some different approach.

YS: What sort of approach?

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ST: We should mix in some playfulness, since we need to make use in large part of a great story. And thereafter, just as we did previously, arrive at the pinnacle, the object of our search, by continually separating part from part. Isn't that what's needed?

ἐν τοῖς πρόσθεν, μέρος αἰὲ μέρους ἀφαιρουμένους ἐπ' ἄκρον ἀφικνεῖσθαι τὸ ζητούμενον. οὐκοῦν χρή; NE. ΣΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. ἀλλὰ δὴ τῷ μύθῳ μου πάνυ πρόσεχε τὸν νοῦν, καθάπερ οἱ παῖδες· πάντως οὐ πολλὰ ἐκφεύγεις παιδιὰς ἔτη. NE. ΣΩ. λέγοις ἄν. ΞΕ. ἦν τοίνυν καὶ ἔτι ἔσται τῶν πάλαι λεχθέντων πολλά τε ἄλλα καὶ δὴ καὶ τὸ περὶ τὴν Ἀτρέως τε καὶ Θυέστου λεχθεῖσαν ἔριν φάσμα. ἀκήκοας γάρ

που καὶ ἀπομνημονεύεις ὃ φασὶ γενέσθαι τότε. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. τὸ περὶ τῆς χρυσεῖς ἀρνὸς ἴσως σημεῖον φράξεις.

YS: Yes, certainly.

ST: Anyway, apply your mind fully to the story just as children do, since you are not really too long out of your childhood years.

YS: Please proceed.

ST: Well, many events recounted from ancient times have occurred and will occur again, but especially the portent described in the dispute between Atreus and Thyestes. Indeed, I presume you have heard it, and can recall what is said to have happened.¹²

YS: You are probably referring to the sign of the golden lamb.

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ST: Not at all, but to the change in the rising and setting of the sun and the other stars. Yes, apparently the sun used to set then in the place where it now rises, and used to rise in the opposite place. However, once the god had borne witness in favour of Atreus, he actually changed this to the present arrangement.

ΞΕ. οὐδαμῶς, ἀλλὰ τὸ περὶ τῆς μεταβολῆς δύσεώς τε καὶ ἀνατολῆς ἡλίου καὶ τῶν ἄλλων ἀστρῶν, ὥς ἄρα ὅθεν μὲν ἀνατέλλει νῦν εἰς τοῦτον τότε τὸν τόπον ἐδύετο, ἀνέτελλε δ' ἐκ τοῦ ἐναντίου, τότε δὲ δὴ μαρτυρήσας ἄρα ὁ θεὸς Ἀτρεΐ μετέβαλεν αὐτὸ ἐπὶ τὸ νῦν σχῆμα. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. λέγεται γὰρ οὖν δὴ καὶ τοῦτο. ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν αὖ καὶ τήν γε βασιλείαν ἣν ἥρξε Κρόνος πολλῶν ἀκηκόαμεν.

YS: Yes, indeed, that's what they say too.

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ST: And what's more, we have also heard from many sources about the kingship that Cronus exercised.

ΝΕ. ΣΩ. πλείστων μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. τί δέ; τὸ τοὺς ἔμπροσθεν φύεσθαι γηγενεῖς καὶ μὴ ἐξ ἀλλήλων γεννᾶσθαι; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. καὶ τοῦτο ἔν τῶν πάλαι λεχθέντων. ΞΕ. ταῦτα τοίνυν ἔστι μὲν σύμπαντα ἐκ ταύτου πάθους, καὶ

πρὸς τούτοις ἕτερα μυρία καὶ τούτων ἔτι θαυμαστότερα, διὰ δὲ χρόνου πλῆθος τὰ μὲν αὐτῶν ἀπέσβηκε, τὰ δὲ διεσπαρμένα εἴρηται χωρὶς ἕκαστα ἀπ' ἀλλήλων. ὃ δ' ἐστὶν πᾶσι

YS: Yes, from very many.

ST: And what about the story that the people of former times were earth-born and were not born from one another?

YS: That is another one of the ancient accounts.

ST: Well, all these originated from the same circumstance, and so do countless others besides that are even more amazing. But due to the great passage of time some of them have been obliterated, while others have been recounted in piecemeal fashion, omitting any connection between them. But no one has explained the circumstance responsible for them all, so that must now be recounted. Indeed, once it has been stated, it will prove relevant to our exposition of the king.

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YS: You have expressed that excellently. Speak on and omit nothing.

τούτοις αἴτιον τὸ πάθος οὐδεὶς εἴρηκεν, νῦν δὲ δὴ λεκτέον· εἰς γὰρ τὴν τοῦ βασιλέως ἀπόδειξιν πρέψει ῥηθέν. NE. ΣΩ. κάλλιστ' εἶπες, καὶ λέγε μηδὲν ἐλλείπων. ΞΕ. ἀκούοις ἄν. τὸ γὰρ πᾶν τόδε τοτὲ μὲν αὐτὸς ὁ θεὸς συμποδηγεῖ πορευόμενον καὶ συγκυκλεῖ, τοτὲ δὲ ἀνῆκεν, ὅταν αἱ περίοδοι τοῦ προσήκοντος αὐτῷ μέτρον εἰλήφωσιν ἤδη χρόνου, τὸ δὲ πάλιν αὐτόματον εἰς τάναντία περιάγεται,

ST: Please listen. For there is a time when God himself joins directly in guiding the movement of this universe and assists its circling motion, and another time when he lets it go once its revolutions have finally attained the appropriate measure of time, and it is, of itself, led around once more in the opposite direction because it is a living being, allotted intelligence by the one who constructed it in the beginning. There's a particular reason why this ability to retrace its path is necessarily inherent in its nature.

YS: What reason?

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ST: It belongs only to all the most divine things to hold always to the same characteristics and manner, and to be the same, but the nature of body does not partake of this arrangement. And what we refer to as heaven and the universe has inherited numerous blessed qualities from its creator, and yet it does also have communion with body. As a consequence, it is impossible for it to be devoid of change in every respect, and yet to the best of its ability it moves as much as possible in the same place, with a single direction. Therefore, it has been allotted the reverse revolution because that is the smallest possible deviation from its own motion. But it is quite impossible for anything, except that which, for its part, directs the movements of everything, to turn itself continually by itself. But it is not ordained that this causes motion first in one direction and then again in the opposite direction. So, on the basis of all these considerations, we should not assert that the world itself continually turns itself, nor that it is turned entirely by a god in a pair of opposed revolutions, nor again that a pair of gods, whose thinking is opposed, turns it. Rather, the only remaining option is just what we stated earlier. It is guided along by an extraneous divine cause, acquires life once again, and adopts a restored immortality once more from its craftsman. But then, when it is let go, it proceeds by means of itself, having been let go at such a time that it travels in the opposite direction for many thousands of revolutions because, indeed, it is in motion, being most enormous and well-balanced, resting on the smallest pivot.

ζῶον ὃν καὶ φρόνησιν εἰληχὸς ἐκ τοῦ συναρμόσαντος αὐτὸ κατ' ἀρχάς. τοῦτο δὲ αὐτῷ τὸ ἀνάπαλιν ἰέναι διὰ τόδ' ἐξ ἀνάγκης ἔμφυτον γέγονε. NE. ΣΩ. διὰ τὸ ποῖον δῆ; ΞΕ. τὸ κατὰ ταῦτά καὶ ὡσαύτως ἔχειν αἰεὶ καὶ ταῦτὸν εἶναι τοῖς πάντων θειοτάτοις προσήκει μόνοις, σώματος δὲ φύσις οὐ ταύτης τῆς τάξεως. ὃν δὲ οὐρανὸν καὶ κόσμον ἐπωνομάκαμεν, πολλῶν μὲν καὶ μακαρίων παρὰ τοῦ γεννήσαντος μετείληφεν, ἀτὰρ οὖν δὴ κεκοινώνηκέ γε καὶ σώματος· ὅθεν αὐτῷ μεταβολῆς ἀμοίρῳ γίγνεσθαι διὰ παντὸς ἀδύνατον, κατὰ δυνάμιν γε μὴν ὅτι μάλιστα ἐν τῷ

αὐτῷ κατὰ ταῦτά μίαν φορὰν κινεῖται· διὸ τὴν ἀνακύκλησιν εἴληχεν, ὅτι σμικροτάτην τῆς αὐτοῦ κινήσεως παράλλαξιν. αὐτὸ δὲ ἑαυτὸ στρέφειν ἀεὶ σχεδὸν οὐδενὶ δυνατὸν πλὴν τῷ τῶν κινουμένων αὖ πάντων ἡγουμένῳ· κινεῖν δὲ τούτῳ τοτὲ μὲν ἄλλως, αὐθις δὲ ἐναντίως οὐ θέμις. ΞΕ. ἐκ πάντων δὴ τούτων τὸν κόσμον μήτε αὐτὸν χρή φάναι στρέφειν ἑαυτὸν ἀεὶ, μήτ' αὖ ὅλον ἀεὶ ὑπὸ θεοῦ στρέφεσθαι διττὰς καὶ ἐναντίας

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YS: Well, it appears that everything you have recounted is very reasonable.

περιαγωγάς, μήτ' αὖ δύο τινε θεῷ φρονοῦντε ἑαυτοῖς ἐναντία στρέφειν αὐτόν, ἀλλ' ὅπερ ἄρτι ἐρρήθη καὶ μόνον λοιπόν, τοτὲ μὲν ὑπ' ἄλλης συμποδηγεῖσθαι θείας αἰτίας, τὸ ζῆν πάλιν ἐπικτώμενον καὶ λαμβάνοντα ἀθανασίαν ἐπισκευαστήν παρὰ τοῦ δημιουργοῦ, τοτὲ δ' ὅταν ἀνεθῇ, δι' ἑαυτοῦ αὐτὸν ἰέναι, κατὰ καιρὸν ἀφεθέντα τοιοῦτον, ὥστε ἀνάπαλιν πορεύεσθαι πολλὰς περιόδων μυριάδας διὰ δὴ τὸ μέγιστον ὃν καὶ ἰσορροπώτατον ἐπὶ μικροτάτου βαῖνον ποδὸς ἰέναι.

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ST: Then having reflected upon what has been said, let's come to an understanding of this circumstance, the one we declared to be the cause of all these wonders. In fact, this is it.

NE. ΣΩ. φαίνεται γοῦν δὴ καὶ μάλα εἰκότως εἰρῆσθαι πάνθ' ὅσα διελέλυθας. ΞΕ. λογιζάμενοι δὴ συννοήσωμεν τὸ πάθος ἐκ τῶν νῦν λεχθέντων, ὃ πάντων ἔφαμεν εἶναι τῶν θαυμαστῶν αἴτιον. ἔστι γὰρ οὖν δὴ τοῦτ' αὐτό. NE. ΣΩ. τὸ ποῖον; ΞΕ. τὸ τὴν τοῦ παντὸς φορὰν τοτὲ μὲν ἐφ' ἃ νῦν κυκλεῖται φέρεσθαι, τοτὲ δ' ἐπὶ τὰναντία. NE. ΣΩ. πῶς δὴ; ΞΕ. ταύτην τὴν μεταβολὴν ἡγεῖσθαι δεῖ τῶν περὶ τὸν

YS: What is it?

ST: That the course of the universe revolves at one time in the direction it does now, and at another time in the opposite direction.

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YS: How so?

οὐρανὸν γιγνομένων τροπῶν πασῶν εἶναι μεγίστην καὶ τελεωτάτην τροπήν. NE. ΣΩ. ἔοικε γοῦν. ΞΕ. μεγίστας τοίνυν καὶ μεταβολὰς χρὴ νομίζειν γίγνεσθαι τότε τοῖς ἐντὸς ἡμῖν οἰκοῦσιν αὐτοῦ. NE. ΣΩ. καὶ τοῦτο εἰκός. ΞΕ. μεταβολὰς δὲ μεγάλας καὶ πολλὰς καὶ παντοίας συμφερομένας ἄρ' οὐκ ἴσμεν τὴν τῶν ζώων φύσιν ὅτι χαλεπῶς ἀνέχεται; NE. ΣΩ. πῶς δ' οὐ; ΞΕ. φθοραὶ τοίνυν ἐξ ἀνάγκης τότε μέγιστα συμβαίνουσι τῶν τε ἄλλων ζώων, καὶ δὴ καὶ τῶν ἀνθρώπων

ST: We need to realise that of all the turnings taking place about the heaven, this alteration is the greatest and most comprehensive.

YS: So it seems, anyway.

ST: In that case, we should also presume that at that time enormous changes happen to us who dwell within it.

YS: This also seems to be the case.

ST: And yet, we are also aware that the nature of living beings has difficulty in enduring lots of enormous changes of all sorts when they happen.

YS: Of course.

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ST: So, at that stage, enormous destructions are a necessary consequence for living beings in general, and in the case of the human race, only a few survive. Now, numerous other wondrous and novel circumstances befall these people, but there is a most significant one that follows upon the reversal of the motion of the universe whenever the turn, opposite to what is now established, takes place.

γένος ὀλίγον τι περιλείπεται· περὶ δὲ τούτους ἄλλα τε παθήματα πολλὰ καὶ θαυμαστὰ καὶ καινὰ συμπύπτει, μέγιστον δὲ τόδε καὶ συνεπόμενον τῇ τοῦ παντὸς ἀνειλίζει τότε, ὅταν ἢ τῆς νῦν καθεστηκυίας ἐναντία γίγνηται τροπή. NE. ΣΩ. τὸ ποῖον; ΞΕ. ἥν ἡλικίαν ἕκαστον εἶχε τῶν

ζώων, αὕτη πρῶτον μὲν ἔστη πάντων, καὶ ἐπαύσατο πᾶν ὅσον ἦν θνητὸν ἐπὶ τὸ γεραίτερον ἰδεῖν πορευόμενον, μεταβάλλον δὲ πάλιν ἐπὶ

YS: What is it?

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ST: Firstly, the ageing process of each of the creatures stood still in all cases, and anything mortal stopped getting older in appearance, but changed once more to the opposite condition, as if it was growing younger and more tender. And the white hair of the older people turned to black, and in the case of the bearded men, their cheeks became smooth once more, and each reverted to a former time of life. And the bodies of the youths, becoming smoother and smaller every day and every night, returned once more to the nature of a new born child, like unto that both in body and in soul. And thereafter, fading away completely, they vanished altogether. What's more, the dead body of anyone who came to a violent end during that era went through the same processes, quickly disappeared in a few days, and was done away with.

τοῦναντίον οἷον νεώτερον καὶ ἀπαλώτερον ἐφύετο· καὶ τῶν μὲν πρεσβυτέρων αἱ λευκαὶ τρίχες ἐμελαίνοντο, τῶν δ' αὖ γενειώωντων αἱ παρειαὶ λεαινόμεναι πάλιν ἐπὶ τὴν παρελθοῦσαν ὥραν ἕκαστον καθίστασαν, τῶν δὲ ἡβώντων τὰ σώματα λεαινόμενα καὶ σμικρότερα καθ' ἡμέραν καὶ νύκτα ἐκάστην γιγνόμενα πάλιν εἰς τὴν τοῦ νεογενοῦς παιδὸς φύσιν ἀπῆει, κατὰ τε τὴν ψυχὴν καὶ κατὰ τὸ σῶμα ἀφομοιούμενα· τὸ δ' ἐντεῦθεν ἤδη μαραινόμενα κομιδῇ τὸ πάμπαν ἐξηφανίζετο. τῶν δ' αὖ βιαίως τελευτώντων ἐν τῷ τότε χρόνῳ τὸ τοῦ νεκροῦ σῶμα τὰ αὐτὰ ταῦτα πάσχον παθήματα διὰ

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YS: But, stranger, what was the origin of living creatures then? In what manner were they generated from one another?

τάχους ἄδηλον ἐν ὀλίγαις ἡμέραις διεφθείρετο. NE. ΣΩ. γένεσις δὲ δὴ τίς τότε ἦν, ὧς ξένη, ζώων; καὶ τίνα τρόπον ἐξ ἀλλήλων ἐγεννῶντο; ΞΕ. δῆλον, ὧς Σώκρατες, ὅτι τὸ μὲν ἐξ ἀλλήλων οὐκ ἦν ἐν τῇ τότε φύσει

γεννώμενον, τὸ δὲ γηγενὲς εἶναί ποτε γένος λεχθὲν τοῦτ' ἦν τὸ κατ' ἐκεῖνον τὸν χρόνον ἐκ γῆς πάλιν ἀναστρεφόμενον, ἀπεμνημονεύετο δὲ ὑπὸ τῶν ἡμετέρων προγόνων τῶν πρώτων, οἱ τελευτώσῃ μὲν τῇ προτέρᾳ περιφορᾷ τὸν ἐξῆς χρόνον ἐγειτόνουν, τῆσδε δὲ κατ' ἀρχὰς ἐφύοντο· τούτων γὰρ οὗτοι κήρυκες ἐγένονθ' ἡμῖν τῶν λόγων, οἱ νῦν ὑπὸ πολλῶν οὐκ ὀρθῶς ἀπιστοῦνται. τὸ γὰρ ἐντεῦθεν οἶμαι χρὴ συννοεῖν. ἐπόμενον γάρ ἐστι τῷ τοὺς πρεσβύτας ἐπὶ τὴν τοῦ παιδὸς ἰέναι φύσιν, ἐκ τῶν τετελευτηκότων αὖ, κειμένων δὲ ἐν γῇ, πάλιν ἐκεῖ συνισταμένους καὶ ἀναβιωσκομένους, ἔπεσθαι τῇ τροπῇ συνανακυκλουμένης εἰς τὰναντία τῆς γενέσεως, καὶ γηγενεῖς δὴ κατὰ τοῦτον τὸν

ST: It is clear, Socrates, that generation from one another was not in the nature of things at that time. Instead, the earth-born race that is said to have once existed, the one that returns once more from the earth, was the race that existed in that age. This was remembered by our earliest ancestors, who were born at the beginning of this present age, bordering upon the very end of the previous revolution. Indeed, these ancestors became our proclaimers of these accounts of those earth-born people, accounts that are met with unjustified disbelief by many people these days. Indeed, in my view, we need to consider what else happens. For it follows, from the fact of the return of the old people to the nature of the child, that from those who have died and are lying in the earth, people are reconstituted there, and coming back to life again they follow the direction of the opposite cycle of generation. And based upon that direction, they necessarily develop as earth-born and are named and described accordingly, except the ones whom God does not preserve for some other destiny.

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YS: Yes, this all follows quite well from what went before. But what about the life that you say is under the power of Cronus? Did that occur during those directions of the cycle, or during these? For it is evident that the change to the stars and the sun occurs during either of the two directions of the cycle.

λόγον ἐξ ἀνάγκης φυομένους, οὕτως ἔχειν τοῦνομα καὶ τὸν λόγον, ὅσους μὴ θεὸς αὐτῶν εἰς ἄλλην μοῖραν ἐκόμισεν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. κομιδῇ μὲν οὖν τοῦτό γε ἔπεται τοῖς ἔμπροσθεν. ἀλλὰ δὴ τὸν βίον ὃν ἐπὶ τῆς Κρόνου φῆς εἶναι δυνάμεως, πότερον ἐν ἐκείναις ἦν ταῖς τροπαῖς ἢ ἐν ταῖσδε; τὴν μὲν γὰρ τῶν ἄστρον τε καὶ ἡλίου μεταβολὴν δῆλον ὡς ἐν ἐκατέραις συμπίπτει ταῖς τροπαῖς γίνεσθαι. ΞΕ. καλῶς τῷ λόγῳ συμπαρακολούθηκας. ὁ δ' ἦρου

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ST: You have followed along with my account quite well. But in relation to your question about the spontaneous generation of everything for humanity, this is least applicable to the present revolution. This also belongs to the previous one. For in that era, god ruled first, caring for the revolution itself as a whole. What's more, the same applied to the individual regions. The parts of the universe were entirely allocated under ruling gods. And, indeed, the living creatures, based on their classes and herds, were adopted by particular daimons, like divine shepherds, each self-sufficient in every respect for each of the creatures he tended, so that none was wild, nor did they eat one another, neither was there any war or discord whatsoever. But details of all the consequences of such an arrangement would be too numerous to recount.

περὶ τοῦ πάντα αὐτόματα γίνεσθαι τοῖς ἀνθρώποις, ἥκιστα τῆς νῦν ἐστὶ καθεστηκυίας φορᾶς, ἀλλ' ἦν καὶ τοῦτο τῆς ἔμπροσθεν. τότε γὰρ αὐτῆς πρῶτον τῆς κυκλήσεως ἦρχεν ἐπιμελούμενος ὅλης ὁ θεός, ὡς δ' αὖ κατὰ τόπους ταῦτόν τοῦτο, ὑπὸ θεῶν ἀρχόντων πάντ' ἦν τὰ τοῦ κόσμου μέρη διειλημμένα· καὶ δὴ καὶ τὰ ζῶα κατὰ γένη καὶ ἀγέλας οἶον νομῆς θεοὶ διειλήφεσαν δαίμονες, αὐτάρκης εἰς πάντα ἕκαστος ἑκάστοις

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ST: Now, what was said about the spontaneous life of human beings was said for the following reason. A god presided over them and managed them himself. Just as humans nowadays, a different and more divine creature now tends upon other kinds of creatures lowlier than itself.

While he tended them, there were no constitutions or any possession of women or children, for they all came to life once more from the earth, remembering nothing of the past. And although this sort of thing was absent, they did have an abundance of fruit from trees, and from lots of other vegetation sent forth spontaneously from the earth, not a product of agricultural activity. They dwelt outdoors for the most part, living off the land, naked and without bedding, for their seasons were a blend, devoid of any distress, and they had soft beds of abundant grass sprung forth from the earth. Socrates, you are now hearing about the life of people under the dominion of Cronus. But the one that is said to be under Zeus, the present one, you are aware of because you are living in it. Now are you able, and indeed willing, to decide which of the two is happier?

ὦν οἷς αὐτὸς ἔνεμεν, ὥστε οὔτ' ἄγριον ἦν οὐδὲν οὔτε ἀλλήλων ἐδωδαί, πόλεμός τε οὐκ ἔνῃν οὐδὲ στάσις τὸ παράπαν· ἄλλα θ' ὅσα τῆς τοιαύτης ἐστὶ κατακοσμήσεως ἐπόμενα, μυρία ἂν εἴη λέγειν. τὸ δ' οὖν τῶν ἀνθρώπων λεχθὲν αὐτομάτου περὶ βίου διὰ τὸ τοιόνδε εἴρηται. ΞΕ. θεὸς ἔνεμεν αὐτοὺς αὐτὸς ἐπιστατῶν, καθάπερ νῦν ἀνθρωποι, ζῶν ὃν ἕτερον θεϊότερον, ἄλλα γένη φαυλότερα αὐτῶν νομεύουσι· νέμοντος δὲ ἐκεῖνον πολιτεῖαι τε οὐκ ἦσαν οὐδὲ κτήσεις γυναικῶν καὶ παίδων· ἐκ γῆς γὰρ ἀνεβίωσκοντο πάντες, οὐδὲν μεμνημένοι τῶν πρόσθεν· ἀλλὰ τὰ μὲν τοιαῦτα ἀπῆν πάντα, καρποὺς δὲ ἀφθόλους εἶχον ἀπὸ τε δένδρων καὶ πολλῆς ὕλης ἄλλης, οὐχ ὑπὸ γεωργίας φυομένους, ἀλλ' αὐτομάτης ἀναδιδούσης τῆς γῆς. γυμνοὶ δὲ καὶ ἄστρωτοι θυραυλοῦντες τὰ πολλὰ ἐνέμοντο· τὸ γὰρ τῶν ὠρῶν αὐτοῖς ἄλυπον ἐκέκρατο, μαλακὰς δὲ εὐνάς εἶχον ἀναφυομένης ἐκ

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YS: Not at all.

γῆς πόας ἀφθόνου. τὸν δὲ βίον, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἀκούεις μὲν τὸν τῶν ἐπὶ Κρόνου· τόνδε δ' ὃν λόγος ἐπὶ Διὸς εἶναι, τὸν νυνί, παρῶν αὐτὸς ἥσθησαι· κρῖναι δ' αὐτοῖν τὸν εὐδαιμονέστερον ἄρ' ἂν δύναιό τε καὶ ἐθελήσειας; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. οὐδαμῶς. ΞΕ. βούλει δῆτα ἐγὼ σοι τρόπον τινὰ

διακρίνω; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. εἰ μὲν τοίνυν οἱ τρόφιμοι τοῦ Κρόνου, παρουσίας αὐτοῖς οὕτω πολλῆς σχολῆς καὶ δυνάμεως πρὸς τὸ μὴ μόνον ἀνθρώποις ἀλλὰ καὶ θηρίοις διὰ λόγων δύνασθαι συγγίγνεσθαι,

ST: In that case, would you like me to make the judgement for you in some way?

YS: Yes, certainly.

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ST: Well, if the nurslings of Cronus, enjoying such extensive leisure and the ability to converse through words not only with humans but also with beasts, were to make use of all these advantages for philosophy, associating with beasts and with one another, and finding out from every nature whether any possessed some particular ability to discern something, over and above the others, in relation to the accumulation of understanding, it would be easy to decide that the people of that age vastly exceeded those of this age in happiness. However, if they were to stuff themselves full of food and drink, and converse with one another and the beasts, recounting the sort of tales told about them nowadays, this too, in my view of the matter anyway, would indeed be an easy decision. In any case, let's set this aside until someone appears who is up to the task of informing us in which of the two ways the people of that age directed their desires regarding knowledge and the use of words.

κατεχρῶντο τούτοις σύμπασιν ἐπὶ φιλοσοφίαν, μετὰ τε θηρίων καὶ μετ' ἀλλήλων ὁμιλοῦντες, καὶ πυνθανόμενοι παρὰ πάσης φύσεως εἴ τινα τις ἰδίαν δύναμιν ἔχουσα ἥσθητό τι διάφορον τῶν ἄλλων εἰς συναγυρμὸν φρονήσεως, εὔκριτον ὅτι τῶν νῦν οἱ τότε μυρίῳ πρὸς εὐδαιμονίαν διέφερον· εἰ δ' ἐμπιπλάμενοι σίτων ἄδην καὶ ποτῶν διελέγοντο πρὸς ἀλλήλους καὶ τὰ θηρία μύθους οἷα δὴ καὶ τὰ νῦν περὶ αὐτῶν

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ST: But we should state the reason why we have revived this story, so that we may bring what follows to its conclusion. For when the time

for all this had come to an end, and it was necessary for the change to occur – and indeed by then the entire earth-born race had been exhausted, each soul having rendered all its births, each falling to the earth as seed for its allotted number of times – at that stage the helmsman of the universe, as if letting go the handle of the helm, withdrew into his own viewing place, and the allotted and innate desire turned the universe once more in the opposite direction. So all the gods who shared the rule of the regions with the greatest daimon, recognising what was already taking place, withdrew in turn from the parts of the world under their own care. But the universe, in changing direction and being thrown together, the initial and final motions thrusting in opposite directions, produced a considerable convulsion within itself, and thus brought about another destruction of various living beings.

λέγονται, καὶ τοῦτο, ὥς γε κατὰ τὴν ἐμὴν δόξαν ἀποφίνασθαι, καὶ μάλ' εὐκριτον. ὅμως δ' οὖν ταῦτα μὲν ἀφῶμεν, ἕως ἂν ἡμῖν μηνυτὴς τις ἱκανὸς φανῇ, ποτέρως οἱ τότε τὰς ἐπιθυμίας εἶχον περὶ τε ἐπιστημῶν καὶ τῆς τῶν λόγων χρείας· οὗ δ' ἕνεκα τὸν μῦθον ἡγείραμεν, τοῦτο λεκτέον, ἵνα τὸ μετὰ τοῦτο εἰς τὸ πρόσθεν περαίνωμεν. ἐπειδὴ γὰρ πάντων τούτων χρόνος ἐτελεώθη καὶ μεταβολὴν ἔδει γίγνεσθαι καὶ δὴ καὶ τὸ γήινον ἤδη πᾶν ἀνήλωτο γένος, πάσας ἐκάστης τῆς ψυχῆς τὰς γενέσεις ἀποδεδωκυίας, ὅσα ἦν ἐκάστη προσταχθὲν τοσαῦτα εἰς γῆν σπέρματα πεσοῦσης, τότε δὴ τοῦ παντὸς ὁ μὲν κυβερνήτης, οἷον πηδαλίων οἶακος ἀφέμενος, εἰς τὴν αὐτοῦ περιωπὴν ἀπέστη, τὸν δὲ δὴ κόσμον ἄλιν ἀνέστρεφεν εἰμαρμένη τε καὶ σύμφυτος ἐπιθυμία. ΞΕ. πάντες οὖν οἱ κατὰ τοὺς τόπους συνάρχοντες τῷ μεγίστῳ δαίμονι θεοί, γνόντες ἤδη τὸ γιγνόμενον, ἀφίεσαν αὐτὰ τὰ μέρη τοῦ

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ST: Once sufficient time had elapsed thereafter, so that the tumult and confusion had ceased and calm was restored after the convulsions, it adopted the order of its own accustomed course, itself assuming care and control of itself and whatever was in itself, remembering the teaching of its father and maker as best it could. Now, in the beginning

this was achieved more precisely, but in the end it was more vague. And the cause of this was the bodily aspect of the combination, the ancient companion of its nature, which had partaken of much disorder before it arrived in the present world. For it has acquired all that is good from its maker, whereas anything that is troublesome or unjust in the universe it retains from that previous condition, and it engenders this in the living beings. When it nurtures the creatures within itself in company with the helmsman, the baseness it generates is minor, while the good is enormous. However, once it is separated from him, it always deals with everything excellently, during the time closest to the letting go, but with the advance of time and the onset of forgetfulness in itself, the ancient condition of disharmony also exerts more power over it and comes to full bloom towards the end of that era. Then, mixing a little good with a considerable blend of its opposite, it gets to the point at which both itself and whatever is within it are in danger of destruction. Therefore, at that stage, the god who had once put it in order, discerning the difficulties it is in – concerned lest it be storm-tossed by tribulations, break apart, and sink beneath the boundless ocean of diversity – takes his seat once more at its helm, and having reversed the diseases and weaknesses from the former revolution when it was subject to itself, brings order, sets it right, and renders it immortal and unageing.

κόσμου τῆς αὐτῶν ἐπιμελείας· ὁ δὲ μεταστρεφόμενος καὶ συμβάλλων, ἀρχῆς τε καὶ τελευτῆς ἐναντίαν ὁρμὴν ὁρμηθεὶς, σεισμὸν πολὺν ἐν ἑαυτῷ ποιῶν ἄλλην αὖ φθορὰν ζῶων παντοίων ἀπηργάσατο. μετὰ δὲ ταῦτα προελθόντος ἱκανοῦ χρόνου, θορύβων τε καὶ ταραχῆς ἤδη παυόμενος καὶ τῶν σεισμῶν γαλήνης ἐπιλαβόμενος εἰς τε τὸν εἰωθότα δρόμον τὸν ἑαυτοῦ κατακοσμούμενος ἦει, ἐπιμέλειαν καὶ κράτος ἔχων αὐτὸς τῶν ἐν αὐτῷ τε καὶ ἑαυτοῦ, τὴν τοῦ δημιουργοῦ καὶ πατρὸς ἀπομνημονεύων διδαχὴν εἰς δύναμιν. κατ’ ἀρχὰς μὲν οὖν ἀκριβέστερον ἀπετέλει, τελευτῶν δὲ ἀμβλύτερον· τούτων δὲ αὐτῷ τὸ σωματοειδὲς τῆς συγκράσεως αἴτιον, τὸ τῆς πάλαι ποτὲ φύσεως σύντροφον, ὅτι πολλῆς ἦν μετέχον ἀταξίας πρὶν εἰς τὸν νῦν κόσμον

ἀφικέσθαι. παρὰ μὲν γὰρ τοῦ συνθέντος πάντα καλὰ κέκτηται· παρὰ δὲ τῆς ἔμπροσθεν ἕξεως, ὅσα χαλεπὰ καὶ ἄδικα ἐν οὐρανῷ γίνονται, ταῦτα ἐξ ἐκείνης αὐτός τε ἔχει καὶ τοῖς ζώοις ἐναπεργάζεται. μετὰ μὲν οὖν τοῦ κυβερνήτου τὰ ζῶα τρέφων ἐν αὐτῷ σμικρὰ μὲν φλαῦρα, μεγάλα δὲ ἐνέτικτεν ἀγαθὰ· χωριζόμενος δὲ ἐκείνου τὸν ἐγγύτατα χρόνον αἰὶ τῆς ἀφέσεως κάλλιστα πάντα διάγει, προϊόντος δὲ τοῦ χρόνου καὶ λήθης ἐγγιγνομένης ἐν αὐτῷ μᾶλλον καὶ δυναστεύει τὸ τῆς παλαιᾶς ἀναρμοστίας πάθος, τελευτῶντος δὲ ἔξανθεῖ τοῦ χρόνου καὶ σμικρὰ μὲν τὰγαθὰ, πολλὴν δὲ τὴν τῶν ἐναντίων κρᾶσιν ἐπεγκεραννύμενος ἐπὶ διαφθορᾷς κίνδυνον αὐτοῦ τε ἀφικνεῖται καὶ τῶν ἐν αὐτῷ. διὸ δὴ καὶ τότ' ἤδη θεὸς ὁ κοσμήσας αὐτόν, καθορῶν ἐν ἀπορίαις ὄντα, κηδόμενος ἵνα μὴ χειμασθεῖς ὑπὸ ταραχῆς διαλυθεῖς εἰς τὸν τῆς ἀνομοιότητος ἄπειρον ὄντα

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ST: Now, although that concludes all there is to be said, it is sufficient, for the aspect that concerns the presentation of the king, to take note of the earlier part of the account. For once the universe had turned its course once more to the present process of generation, the direction of ageing stood still once more, and new processes opposite to the previous ones were imposed. Those creatures who were just on the point of vanishing due to their smallness grew larger, while the bodies that were new-born from the earth with grey hair, died once more and went back down into the earth. And everything else changed, imitating and following along with the tendencies of the universe. And, indeed, in the case of conception, birth and nurture, their imitation was of necessity in conformity with all else. For it was no longer possible in earth for living beings to be brought forth through the agency of artificers other than themselves. Rather, just as the universe had been directed to be the independent ruler of its own course, so too, on the same basis, its parts were directed to come forth, be born and develop as best they could, under similar guidance.

πόντον δύη, πάλιν ἔφεδρος αὐτοῦ τῶν πηδαλίων γιγνόμενος, τὰ νοσήσαντα καὶ λυθέντα ἐν τῇ καθ' ἑαυτὸν προτέρᾳ περιόδῳ στρέψας,

κοσμεῖ τε καὶ ἐπανορθῶν ἀθάνατον αὐτὸν καὶ ἀγῆρων ἀπεργάζεται. τοῦτο μὲν οὖν τέλος ἀπάντων εἴρηται· τὸ δ' ἐπὶ τὴν τοῦ βασιλέως ἀπόδειξιν ἱκανὸν ἐκ τοῦ πρόσθεν ἀπτομένοις τοῦ λόγου· στρεφθέντος γὰρ αὖ τοῦ κόσμου τὴν ἐπὶ τὴν νῦν γένεσιν ὁδὸν τὸ τῆς ἡλικίας αὖ πάλιν ἴστατο καὶ καινὰ τάναντία ἀπεδίδου τοῖς τότε. τὰ μὲν γὰρ ὑπὸ σμικρότητος ὀλίγου δέοντα ἠφανίσθαι τῶν ζώων ἠϋζάνετο, τὰ δ' ἐκ γῆς νεογενῇ σώματα πολὺὰ φύντα πάλιν ἀποθνήσκοντα εἰς γῆν κατήει. ΕΞ. καὶ τᾷλλά τε πάντα μετέβαλλε, ἀπομιμούμενα καὶ συνακολουθοῦντα τῷ τοῦ παντὸς παθήματι, καὶ δὴ καὶ τὸ τῆς κυήσεως καὶ γεννήσεως καὶ τροφῆς μίμημα συνείπετο τοῖς πᾶσιν ὑπ' ἀνάγκης· οὐ γὰρ ἐξῆν ἔτ' ἐν γῇ δι' ἐτέρων συνιστάντων φύεσθαι ζῶον, ἀλλὰ καθάπερ τῷ κόσμῳ προσετέτακτο αὐτοκράτορα εἶναι τῆς αὐτοῦ πορείας, οὕτω δὴ κατὰ ταῦτα καὶ τοῖς μέρεσιν αὐτοῖς δι' αὐτῶν, καθ' ὅσον οἷόν τ' ἦν, φύειν τε καὶ γεννᾶν καὶ τρέφειν προσετάρτετο ὑπὸ τῆς

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ST: The entire account was initiated for a purpose, and we have now attained it. Now, in the case of the other animals, it would be a complex and lengthy process to recount in each case what they changed from and what caused the change. However, in the case of human beings it would be shorter and more appropriate. For when we became bereft of the care of the daimon who had acquired and tended us, most of the animals whose natures are troublesome turned wild and preyed upon the humans, who had themselves become weak and unprotected, and in those early years were still devoid of ingenuity or skill, seeing that their spontaneous food source had failed them and they did not yet know how to provide for themselves because they had no compelling need to do so previously. They were facing enormous difficulties on account of all these issues. Hence, those gifts from the gods, described of old, have been bestowed upon us, along with the necessity for teaching and instruction: fire from Prometheus, skills from Hephaestus and his fellow artisan, seeds and plants in turn from other gods. And everything else that has helped the organisation of human life has arisen from these. When, as we said just now, the care of the gods for

humanity had failed, they had to maintain guidance and care of themselves by means of themselves, just like the entire world, which we are imitating and following through all time as we live and grow, now in this manner, then in that other manner. So let that be the end of the story. But we shall now make use of it, in order to discern the extent of our error in presenting an account of the king and the statesman in the earlier discussion.

ὁμοίας ἀγωγῆς. οὗ δὲ ἔνεκα ὁ λόγος ὥρμηκε πᾶς, ἐπ' αὐτῷ νῦν ἐσμὲν ἤδη. περὶ μὲν γὰρ τῶν ἄλλων θηρίων πολλὰ ἂν καὶ μακρὰ διεξελεῖν γίγνοιτο, ἐξ ὧν ἕκαστα καὶ δι' ἃς αἰτίας μεταβέβληκε· περὶ δὲ ἀνθρώπων βραχύτερα καὶ μᾶλλον προσήκοντα. τῆς γὰρ τοῦ κεκτημένου καὶ νέμοντος ἡμᾶς δαίμονος ἀπερημωθέντες ἐπιμελείας, τῶν πολλῶν αὖ θηρίων, ὅσα χαλεπὰ τὰς φύσεις ἦν, ἀπαγριωθέντων, αὐτοὶ δὲ ἀσθενεῖς ἄνθρωποι καὶ ἀφύλακτοι γεγονότες διηρπάζοντο ὑπ' αὐτῶν, καὶ ἔτ' ἀμήχανοι καὶ ἄτεχνοι κατὰ τοὺς πρώτους ἦσαν χρόνους, ἅτε τῆς μὲν αὐτομάτης τροφῆς ἐπιλελοιπιῦας, πορίζεσθαι δὲ οὐκ ἐπιστάμενοι πῶς διὰ τὸ μηδεμίαν αὐτοὺς χρεῖαν πρότερον ἀναγκάζειν. ἐκ τούτων πάντων ἐν μεγάλαις ἀπορίαις ἦσαν. ὅθεν δὴ τὰ πάσαις λεχθέντα παρὰ θεῶν δῶρα ἡμῖν δεδωρῆται μετ' ἀναγκαίας διδαχῆς καὶ παιδείσεως, πῦρ μὲν παρὰ Προμηθέως, τέχναι δὲ παρ' Ἥφαιστου καὶ τῆς συντέχνου, σπέρματα δὲ αὖ καὶ φυτὰ παρ' ἄλλων· καὶ πάνθ' ὅποσα τὸν ἀνθρώπινον βίον συγκατεσκεύακεν ἐκ τούτων γέγονεν, ἐπειδὴ τὸ μὲν ἐκ θεῶν, ὅπερ ἐρρήθη νυνδὴ, τῆς ἐπιμελείας ἐπέλιπεν ἀνθρώπους, δι' ἑαυτῶν τε ἔδει τὴν τε διαγωγὴν καὶ τὴν ἐπιμέλειαν αὐτοὺς αὐτῶν ἔχειν καθάπερ ὅλος ὁ κόσμος, ὃ συμμιμούμενοι καὶ συνεπόμενοι τὸν αἰεὶ χρόνον νῦν μὲν οὕτως, τότε δὲ ἐκείνως ζῶμέν τε καὶ φυόμεθα. καὶ τὸ μὲν δὴ τοῦ μύθου τέλος ἐχέτω, χρήσιμον δὲ αὐτὸν ποιησόμεθα πρὸς τὸ κατιδεῖν ὅσον ἡμάρτομεν ἀποφηνάμενοι τὸν βασιλικὸν τε καὶ πολιτικὸν ἐν τῷ πρόσθε λόγῳ. NE. ΣΩ. πῶς οὖν καὶ πόσον ἁμάρτημα φῆς εἶναι γεγονὸς ἡμῖν; ΞΕ. τῇ μὲν βραχύτερον, τῇ δὲ μάλα γενναῖον καὶ πολλῷ μείζον καὶ πλεον ἢ τότε. NE. ΣΩ. πῶς; ΞΕ. ὅτι μὲν ἐρωτώμενοι τὸν ἐκ τῆς νῦν περιφορᾶς καὶ γενέσεως βασιλέα καὶ πολιτικὸν τὸν ἐκ τῆς ἐναντίας περιόδου

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YS: But how do you say our error occurred, and what was the extent of it?

ποιμένα τῆς τότε ἀνθρωπίνης ἀγέλης εἵπομεν, καὶ ταῦτα θεὸν ἀντὶ θνητοῦ, ταύτῃ μὲν πάμπολυ παρηνέχθημεν· ὅτι δὲ συμπάσης τῆς πόλεως ἄρχοντα αὐτὸν ἀπεφήναμεν, ὅντινα δὲ τρόπον οὐ διείπομεν, ταύτῃ δὲ αὖ τὸ μὲν λεχθὲν ἀληθές, οὐ μὴν ὅλον γε οὐδὲ σαφὲς ἐρρήθη, διὸ καὶ βραχύτερον ἢ κατ' ἐκεῖνο ἡμαρτήκαμεν. NE. ΣΩ. ἀληθῆ. ΞΕ. δεῖ τοίνυν τὸν τρόπον, ὡς ἔοικε, διορίσαντας τῆς ἀρχῆς τῆς πόλεως οὕτω τελέως τὸν πολιτικὸν ἡμῖν εἰρῆσθαι προσδοκᾶν. NE. ΣΩ. καλῶς.

ST: In one sense it was more trivial, but in another sense it was extremely significant, and much greater and more extensive than I thought at the time.

YS: In what way?

ST: When we were asked about the king and statesman belonging to the current revolution and manner of coming into being, we described the shepherd of the human herd belonging to the opposite cycle, and he was a god rather than a mortal, and in this way we went completely wrong. However, when we presented him as ruling the entire city, we did not state the manner of such rule, and in that sense, although we did speak the truth, it was not stated comprehensively or clearly, and therefore we were in error, but to a lesser extent than that.

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YS: True.

ΞΕ. διὰ ταῦτα μὴν καὶ τὸν μῦθον παρεθέμεθα, ἵνα ἐνδείξαιτο περὶ τῆς ἀγελαιοτροφίας μὴ μόνον ὡς πάντες αὐτῆς ἀμφισβητοῦσι τῷ ζητουμένῳ τὰ νῦν, ἀλλὰ κάκεῖνον αὐτὸν ἐναργέστερον ἴδοιμεν, ὃν προσήκει μόνον κατὰ τὸ παράδειγμα ποιμένων τε καὶ βουκόλων τῆς ἀνθρωπίνης ἐπιμέλειαν ἔχοντα τροφῆς τούτου μόνον ἀξιοθῆναι τοῦ προσρήματος. NE. ΣΩ. ὀρθῶς. ΞΕ. οἶμαι δέ γ', ὃ Σώκρατες, τοῦτο μὲν ἔτι μεῖζον ἢ

ST: Then once we have defined the manner of such rule over the city, we should expect accordingly to describe our statesman comprehensively.

YS: Very good.

ST: And it was for these reasons we included the myth, in order to point out not only that when it comes to herd nurture, everyone nowadays disputes over that title with the person we are looking for, but also to discern more clearly, based upon the example of shepherds and cowherds, the one person whom it is appropriate, in view of his care for the nurture of humanity, to deem worthy of this title alone.

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YS: Rightly so.

κατὰ βασιλέα εἶναι τὸ σχῆμα τὸ τοῦ θεοῦ νομέως, τοὺς δ' ἐνθάδε νῦν ὄντας πολιτικούς τοῖς ἀρχομένοις ὁμοίους τε εἶναι μᾶλλον πολὺ τὰς φύσεις καὶ παραπλησιαίτερον παιδείας μετεिल्φέναι καὶ τροφῆς. NE. ΣΩ. πάντως που. ΞΕ. ζητητέοι γε μὴν οὐδὲν ἂν εἴησαν οὔθ' ἦττον οὔτε μᾶλλον, εἴθ' οὕτως εἴτ' ἐκείνως πεφύκασιν. NE. ΣΩ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΞΕ. τῆδε δὴ πάλιν ἐπανεέλθωμεν. ἦν γὰρ ἔφαμεν αὐτεπιτακτικὴν μὲν εἶναι τέχνην ἐπὶ ζώοις, οὐ μὴν ἰδίᾳ γε ἀλλὰ

ST: And yet, Socrates, I really think that this figure of the divine herdsman is even greater than that of a king, while the statesmen of the present day have natures much more like those whom they rule over, and they share in an education and nurture closer to their subjects.

YS: Entirely so, I presume. I suppose that's true, on the whole.

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ST: Yet they should be sought out anyway, neither more nor less, regardless of whether they have the former or the latter nature.

κοινῇ τὴν ἐπιμέλειαν ἔχουσιν, καὶ προσείπομεν δὴ τότε εὐθύς ἀγελαιοτροφικὴν—μέμνησαι γάρ; NE. ΣΩ. ναί. ΞΕ. ταύτης τοίνυν πη διημαρτάνομεν. τὸν γὰρ πολιτικὸν οὐδαμοῦ συνελάβομεν οὐδ'

ὠνομάσαμεν, ἀλλ' ἡμᾶς ἔλαθεν κατὰ τὴν ὀνομασίαν ἐκφυγών. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. πῶς; ΞΕ. τοῦ τὰς ἀγέλας ἐκάστας τρέφειν τοῖς μὲν ἄλλοις που πᾶσι μέτεστι νομεῦσι, τῷ πολιτικῷ δὲ οὐ μετὸν ἐπηνέγκαμεν

YS: They must.

ST: Then let's go back once more to this point. We said that the 'own-directing' skill, as applied to living creatures, exercised its care not individually but collectively, and then we referred to it immediately as 'herd-nurture'. You do remember?

YS: Yes.

ST: Well, somehow we went badly wrong on this topic for we utterly failed to include the statesman or to name him. Rather he escaped our naming process without our noticing.

YS: How?

275e

ST: The various other herdsmen share in the nurture of their several herds, but although the statesman has no share in this process, we still applied that name, when we should have applied, to all of them, some name they had in common.

τοῦνομα, δέον τῶν κοινῶν ἐπενεγκεῖν τι σύμπασιν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ἀληθῆ λέγεις, εἴπερ ἐτύχχανέ γε ὄν. ΞΕ. πῶς δ' οὐκ ἦν τό γε θεραπεύειν που πᾶσι κοινόν, μηδὲν διορισθείσης τροφῆς μηδέ τινος ἄλλης πραγματείας; ἀλλ' ἢ τινα ἀγελαιοκομικὴν ἢ θεραπευτικὴν ἢ καὶ τινα ἐπιμελητικὴν αὐτὴν ὀνομάσασιν ὥς κατὰ πάντων ἐξῆν περικαλύπτειν καὶ τὸν πολιτικὸν ἅμα τοῖς ἄλλοις, ἐπειδὴ δεῖν τοῦτ' ἐσήμεναιεν ὁ λόγος.

YS: What you say is true, if there happens to be such a name.

ST: Why wouldn't 'ministering' be somehow common to them all, since it is not defined in terms of nurture or any other particular activity? But if we had called it 'herd-minding' or 'ministration' or 'caring', which is applicable to them all, we would have been able to

include the statesman and the others simultaneously, and the argument indicated that this should be so.

276a

YS: Correct. But in what manner would the next division be made?

NE. ΣΩ. ὀρθῶς. ἀλλ' ἡ μετὰ τοῦτο διαίρεσις αὐτῆς τίνα τρόπον ἐγίγνετ' ἄν;
ΞΕ. κατὰ ταῦτά καθ' ἅπερ ἔμπροσθεν διηρούμεθα τὴν ἀγελαιοτροφικὴν
πεζοῖς τε καὶ ἀπτῆσι, καὶ ἀμείκτοις τε καὶ ἀκεράτοις, τοῖς αὐτοῖς ἄν που
τούτοις διαιρούμενοι καὶ τὴν ἀγελαιοκομικὴν τὴν τε νῦν καὶ τὴν ἐπὶ
Κρόνου βασιλείαν περιειληφότες ἄν ἤμεν ὁμοίως ἐν τῷ λόγῳ. NE. ΣΩ.
φαίνεται ζητῶ δὲ αὐτὸ τί τὸ μετὰ τοῦτο. ΞΕ. δῆλον ὅτι λεχθέντος οὕτω
τοῦ τῆς ἀγελαιοκομικῆς

ST: Based on the same divisions as before, when we divided herd-nurture into foot-borne, un-winged, unmixed in breed, and hornless, and dividing 'herd-minding' on the same basis, we would presumably be encompassing kingship of today, and of the age of Cronus alike, in our account.

YS: Apparently, but I am still asking what comes next.

276b

ST: It is obvious that if the word 'herd-minding' had been used in this context, the contention that there is no care whatsoever would never have occurred to us, which is just what happened when it was rightly contended that in the case of humans, there is no skill worthy of the title 'nurturing'. And even if there were such a skill, many people have a prior and better claim to it than any of our kings.

ὀνόματος οὐκ ἄν ποτε ἐγένεθ' ἡμῖν τό τινας ἀμφισβητεῖν ὥς οὐδ' ἐπιμέλεια τὸ παράπαν ἐστίν, ὥσπερ τότε δικαίως ἡμφεσβητήθη μηδεμίαν εἶναι τέχνην ἐν ἡμῖν ἀξίαν τούτου τοῦ θεραπευτικοῦ προσρήματος, εἰ δ' οὖν τις εἴη, πολλοῖς πρότερον αὐτῆς καὶ μᾶλλον προσήκειν ἢ τινι τῶν βασιλέων. NE. ΣΩ. ὀρθῶς. ΞΕ. ἐπιμέλεια δέ γε ἀνθρωπίνης συμπάσης κοινωνίας οὐδεμία ἄν ἐθελήσειεν ἑτέρα μᾶλλον καὶ προτέρα τῆς βασιλικῆς

YS: Correct.

276c

ST: But when it comes to the common care of humanity in its entirety, no other skill would wish to assert a prior and better claim than kingly rule, which is the rule of all human beings.

φάναι καὶ κατὰ πάντων ἀνθρώπων ἀρχῆς εἶναι τέχνη. NE. ΣΩ. λέγεις ὀρθῶς. ΞΕ. μετὰ ταῦτα δέ γε, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἄρ' ἐννοοῦμεν ὅτι πρὸς αὐτῷ δὴ τῷ τέλει συχνὸν αὐτὸν διημαρτάνετο; NE. ΣΩ. τὸ ποῖον; ΞΕ. τόδε, ὡς ἄρ' εἰ καὶ διενοήθημεν ὅτι μάλιστα τῆς δίποδος ἀγέλης εἶναι τινα θρεπτικὴν τέχνην, οὐδέν τι μᾶλλον ἡμᾶς ἔδει βασιλικὴν αὐτὴν εὐθύς καὶ πολιτικὴν ὡς ἀποτετελεσμένην προσαγορεύειν. NE. ΣΩ. τί μὴν; ΞΕ. πρῶτον μὲν, ὃ λέγομεν, τοῦνομα μετασκευωρήσασθαι,

YS: What you say is correct.

ST: And yet, Socrates, after all this, do we recognise that a considerable further error was made at the very end?

YS: Of what sort?

ST: As follows. If we really did think that there was a skill of nurturing herds of bipeds, we should not have referred to it immediately as kingship or statesmanship with such finality.

YS: What then?

276d

ST: Firstly, as we are saying, we should have changed the manner of the name, orienting it towards care rather than nurture, and then made a cut in this. Indeed, it still has capacity for significant cuts.

πρὸς τὴν ἐπιμέλειαν μᾶλλον προσαγαγόντας ἢ τὴν τροφήν, ἔπειτα ταύτην τέμνειν· οὐ γὰρ σμικρὰς ἂν ἔχοι τμήσεις ἔτι. NE. ΣΩ. ποίας; ΞΕ. ἥι τε τὸν θεῖον ἂν που διειλόμεθα νομέα χωρὶς καὶ τὸν ἀνθρώπινον ἐπιμελητήν. NE. ΣΩ. ὀρθῶς. ΞΕ. αὐθις δέ γε τὴν ἀπονεμηθεῖσαν ἐπιμελητικὴν δίχα τέμνειν ἀναγκαῖον ἦν. NE. ΣΩ. τίνι; ΞΕ. τῷ βιάίῳ τε καὶ ἔκουσίῳ. NE. ΣΩ. τί δή;

YS: Of what sort?

ST: A cut, I presume, whereby we could have separated the divine shepherd and the human carer apart.

YS: Correct.

ST: And yet it was necessary to cut the caring which has been parted off into two once more.

YS: Into what?

ST: Into enforced and voluntary.

YS: Why so?

276e

ST: Well, I think this is how we went wrong previously when, proceeding more simplistically than we should, we treated the king and the tyrant as the same, although they are quite dissimilar in themselves and in the manner of their particular rule.

ΞΕ. καὶ ταύτη που τὸ πρότερον ἀμαρτάνοντες εὐηθέστερα τοῦ δέοντος εἰς ταῦτὸν βασιλέα καὶ τύραννον συνέθεμεν, ἀνομοιοτάτους ὄντας αὐτούς τε καὶ τὸν τῆς ἀρχῆς ἑκατέρου τρόπον. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ἀληθῆ. ΞΕ. νῦν δέ γε πάλιν ἐπανορθούμενοι, καθάπερ εἶπον, τὴν ἀνθρωπίνην ἐπιμελητικὴν δίχα διαιρώμεθα, τῷ βιαίῳ τε καὶ ἐκουσίῳ; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. καὶ τὴν μὲν γέ που τῶν βιαίων τυραννικὴν, τὴν δὲ ἐκούσιον καὶ ἐκουσίων διπόδων ἀγγελαιοκομικὴν ζῶων προσειπόντες πολιτικὴν, τὸν ἔχοντα αὖ τέχνην ταύτην καὶ ἐπιμέλειαν ὄντως ὄντα βασιλέα καὶ πολιτικὸν ἀποφαινόμεθα;

YS: True.

ST: But now, correcting ourselves once more, should we make a twofold division of the care of humanity into enforced and voluntary, just as I said?

YS: Yes, certainly.

ST: And presumably the herd-minding of subjects who are forced is tyrannical, while the voluntary herd-minding of willing two-legged creatures should be called statesmanship, and we should affirm that the one who, for his part, possesses this skill and care is really a king and statesman.

277a

YS: Indeed, stranger, it is likely that our exposition of the statesman may have reached a conclusion.

NE. ΣΩ. καὶ κινδυνεύει γε, ὦ ξένε, τελέως ἂν ἡμῖν οὕτως ἔχειν ἢ περὶ τὸν πολιτικὸν ἀπόδειξις. ΞΕ. καλῶς ἂν, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἡμῖν ἔχοι. δεῖ δὲ μὴ σοὶ μόνῳ ταῦτα, ἀλλὰ κάμοι μετὰ σοῦ κοινῇ συνδοκεῖν. νῦν δὲ κατὰ γε τὴν ἐμὴν οὕτω φαίνεται τέλεον ὁ βασιλεὺς ἡμῖν σχῆμα ἔχειν, ἀλλὰ καθάπερ ἀνδριαντοποιοὶ παρὰ καιρὸν ἐνίστε σπεύδοντες πλείω καὶ μείζω τοῦ δέοντος ἕκαστα τῶν ἔργων ἐπεμβαλλόμενοι βραδύνουσι, καὶ νῦν ἡμεῖς, ἵνα δὴ πρὸς τῷ ταχὺ καὶ μεγαλοπρεπῶς δηλώσαιμεν τὸ τῆς ἔμπροσθεν ἀμάρτημα διεξόδου, τῷ βασιλεῖ νομίσαντες πρέπειν μεγάλα παραδείγματα ποιῆσθαι, θαυμαστὸν ὄγκον ἀράμενοι τοῦ μύθου, μείζονι τοῦ δέοντος ἠναγκάσθημεν αὐτοῦ μέρει προσχρήσασθαι· διὸ μακροτέραν τὴν ἀπόδειξιν πεποιήκαμεν καὶ πάντως τῷ μύθῳ τέλος οὐκ ἐπέθεμεν, ἀλλ' ἀτεχνῶς ὁ

ST: That would be excellent for us, Socrates. But it is necessary for me to share these views with you, in common, so that they are not just your views. Right now, in my view anyway, it seems we have not yet arrived at a figure of the king that is complete. Rather, just as sculptors sometimes cause delay by rushing inappropriately to make greater and more numerous additions than necessary to parts of their work, so too have we, presumably with the aim of presenting a quick and high-sounding demonstration of the error in our previous process, considered it appropriate to apply elaborate examples to the king, and drawing upon a wondrous chunk of the myth, we were compelled to employ a greater part of it than was necessary. Therefore, we have made the exposition longer, and have failed to bring a conclusion to

the story fully. Indeed, our account, just like a sketch of a living creature, has a fairly adequate outline, but has not yet been given actuality as it were, from pigments and the blending of colours. But for those who are able to follow, it is more fitting to reveal every living creature through speech and argument, rather than through drawing and all sorts of craftsmanship. But for everyone else, we should resort to craftsmanship.

277c

YS: That is correct. But please reveal the way in which, according to you, we have not yet described this adequately.

λόγος ἡμῖν ὥσπερ ζῶον τὴν ἔξωθεν μὲν περιγραφὴν ἔοικεν ἱκανῶς ἔχειν, τὴν δὲ οἷον τοῖς φαρμάκοις καὶ τῇ συγκράσει τῶν χρωμάτων ἐνάργειαν οὐκ ἀπειληφέναι πω. γραφῆς δὲ καὶ συμπάσης χειρουργίας λέξει καὶ λόγῳ δηλοῦν πᾶν ζῶον μᾶλλον πρέπει τοῖς δυναμένοις ἔπεσθαι· τοῖς δ' ἄλλοις διὰ χειρουργιῶν. NE. ΣΩ. τοῦτο μὲν ὀρθῶς ὅπη δὲ ἡμῖν οὕτω φης ἱκανῶς εἰρησθαι δήλωσον.

ST: It is difficult, my divine friend, to present anything of significance in an adequate manner without recourse to exemplars. For it is likely that each of us knows all that we know as though in a dream, and then again, when we really are awake, are ignorant of everything.

YS: What do you mean by that?

277d

ST: Yes. In a strange way I seem at the moment to have raised the issue of the experience of knowledge within us.

ΞΕ. χαλεπόν, ὦ δαιμόνιε, μὴ παραδείγμασι χρώμενον ἱκανῶς ἐνδείκνυσθαι τι τῶν μειζόνων. κινδυνεύει γὰρ ἡμῶν ἕκαστος οἷον ὄναρ εἰδὼς ἅπαντα πάντ' αὖ πάλιν ὥσπερ ὕπαρ ἀγνοεῖν. NE. ΣΩ. πῶς τοῦτ' εἶπες; ΞΕ. καὶ μάλ' ἀτόπως ἔοικά γε ἐν τῷ παρόντι κινήσας τὸ περὶ τῆς ἐπιστήμης πάθος ἐν ἡμῖν. NE. ΣΩ. τί δῆ; ΞΕ. παραδείγματος, ὦ μακάριε, αὖ μοι καὶ τὸ παράδειγμα αὐτὸ δεδέηκεν.

YS: In what way?

ST: Blessed man, my example itself stands in turn in need of an example.

YS: Why so? Speak, and do not hesitate on my account.

ST: Speak I must, since you are ready to follow. We know, I presume, that children, whenever they are first developing their skill in writing...

YS: What do we know?

ST: That they adequately recognise each of the letters in the shortest and easiest syllables, and become capable of speaking the truth in relation to those.

YS: Of course.

277e

ST: And yet they are doubtful about the very same letters in other syllables, and their opinions and formulations are false.

NE. ΣΩ. τί οὖν; λέγε μηδὲν ἐμοῦ γε ἔνεκα ἀποκνῶν. ΞΕ. λεκτέον ἐπειδὴ καὶ σύ γε ἔτοιμος ἀκολουθεῖν. τοὺς γάρ που παῖδας ἴσμεν, ὅταν ἄρτι γραμμάτων ἔμπειροι γίνωνται— NE. ΣΩ. τὸ ποῖον; ΞΕ. ὅτι τῶν στοιχείων ἕκαστον ἐν ταῖς βραχυτάταις καὶ ῥάσταις τῶν συλλαβῶν ἱκανῶς διαισθάνονται, καὶ τἀληθῆ φράζειν περὶ ἐκεῖνα δυνατοὶ γίνονται.

YS: Yes, certainly.

ST: Now wouldn't the easiest and best way to lead them on to what they do not yet recognise be as follows?

YS: How is it done?

278a

ST: Firstly, to take them back to those instances in which their opinions on these same letters were correct, and having done so, then place these alongside the ones they do not yet recognise, and by comparing them, point out that there is the same common feature and characteristic present in both intertwinings, until such time as all the

cases where their opinions are true have been shown, alongside all of those they don't know about. Accordingly, these act as examples that make them, in the case of all letters in all the syllables, refer to each as different insofar as it is different from the others, and as the same insofar as it is always the same as itself in the same respect.

NE. ΣΩ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΞΕ. ταῦτά δέ γε ταῦτα ἐν ἄλλαις ἀμφιγνοοῦντες πάλιν δόξη τε ψεύδονται καὶ λόγῳ. NE. ΣΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. ἄρ' οὖν οὐχ ὥδε ῥᾶστον καὶ κάλλιστον ἐπάγειν αὐτοὺς ἐπὶ τὰ μήπω γιγνωσκόμενα; NE. ΣΩ. πῶς; ΞΕ. ἀνάγειν πρῶτον ἐπ' ἐκεῖνα ἐν οἷς ταῦτα ταῦτα ὁρθῶς ἐδόξαζον, ἀναγαγόντας δὲ τιθέναι παρὰ τὰ μήπω

278b

YS: Entirely so.

γιγνωσκόμενα, καὶ παραβάλλοντας ἐνδεικνύναι τὴν αὐτὴν ὁμοιότητα καὶ φύσιν ἐν ἀμφοτέραις οὖσαν ταῖς συμπλοκαῖς, μέχρι περ ἂν πᾶσι τοῖς ἀγνοουμένοις τὰ δοξαζόμενα ἀληθῶς παρατιθέμενα δειχθῇ, δειχθέντα δέ, παραδείγματα οὕτω γιγνώμενα, ποιήσῃ τῶν στοιχείων ἕκαστον πάντων ἐν πάσαις ταῖς συλλαβαῖς τὸ μὲν ἕτερον ὡς τῶν ἄλλων ἕτερον ὄν, τὸ

ST: So, have we fully appreciated that example has its origin when something that is the same is appreciated correctly in a different, separate context, and the two contexts, by being brought together, a single true opinion about each instance and both instances together is attained?

278c

YS: Apparently so.

δὲ ταῦτ' ὡς ταῦτ' ἀεὶ κατὰ ταῦτα ἑαυτῷ προσαγορεύεσθαι. NE. ΣΩ. παντάπασιν μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν τοῦτο μὲν ἱκανῶς συνειλήφαμεν, ὅτι παραδείγματός γ' ἐστὶ τότε γένεσις, ὅποταν ὃν ταῦτ' ἐν ἑτέρῳ διεσπασμένῳ δοξαζόμενον ὁρθῶς καὶ συναχθὲν περὶ ἑκάτερον ὡς συνάμφω μίαν ἀληθῆ δόξαν ἀποτελῇ; NE. ΣΩ. φαίνεται. ΞΕ. θαυμάζοιμεν ἂν οὖν εἰ ταῦτ' οὗτο ἡμῶν ἢ ψυχῇ

ST: Well, would we be surprised if our soul, by nature, underwent this same process in relation to the letters of the universe, sometimes standing in a true relation to each one in a particular case, then again all at sea about all of them under different circumstances, somehow or other recognising some of the combinations correctly. But once these are transposed to the lengthy and difficult syllables of human affairs, it is ignorant once more of these same letters.

278d

YS: That would be nothing particularly surprising.

φύσει περὶ τὰ τῶν πάντων στοιχεῖα πεπονθυῖα τοτὲ μὲν ὑπ' ἀληθείας περὶ ἓν ἕκαστον ἓν τισι συνίσταται, τοτὲ δὲ περὶ ἅπαντα ἐν ἑτέροις αὖ φέρεται, καὶ τὰ μὲν αὐτῶν ἀμῇ γέ πη τῶν συγκράσεων ὀρθῶς δοξάζει, μετατιθέμενα δ' εἰς τὰς τῶν πραγμάτων μακρὰς καὶ μὴ ῥαδίους συλλαβὰς ταῦτά ταῦτα πάλιν ἀγνοεῖ; NE. ΣΩ. καὶ θαυμαστόν γε οὐδέν. ΞΕ. πῶς γάρ, ὦ φίλε, δύναίτο ἄν τις ἀρχόμενος ἀπὸ

278e

ST: How could anyone, my friend, who begins from false opinion, arrive at even a small portion of truth and acquire understanding?

δόξης ψευδοῦς ἐπὶ τι τῆς ἀληθείας καὶ μικρὸν μέρος ἀφικόμενος κτήσασθαι φρόνησιν; NE. ΣΩ. σχεδὸν οὐδαμῶς. ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν ταῦτα εἰ ταύτη πέφυκεν, οὐδὲν δὴ πλημμελοῖμεν ἂν ἐγώ τε καὶ σὺ πρῶτον μὲν ἐπιχειρήσαντες ὅλου παραδείγματος ἰδεῖν τὴν φύσιν ἐν σμικρῷ κατὰ μέρος ἄλλω παραδείγματι, μετὰ δὲ ταῦτα μέλλοντες, ἐπὶ τὸ τοῦ βασιλέως μέγιστον ὃν ταῦτὸν εἶδος ἀπ' ἐλαττόνων φέροντές ποθεν, διὰ παραδείγματος ἐπιχειρεῖν αὖ τὴν τῶν κατὰ πόλιν θεραπείαν τέχνη γινώσκειν, ἵνα ὕπαρ ἂντ' ὀνειράτος ἡμῖν γίγνηται; NE. ΣΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν ὀρθῶς.

YS: That is well-nigh impossible.

ST: Well, if that's how things naturally operate, you and I would not go much astray if, having first attempted to discern the nature of example as a whole, we were to discern it in turn in a further minor example, and transposing these processes thereafter to the very important

matter of the king, we were to apply the same format and proceed from the lesser. Thereafter, we should endeavour, through an example, by means of a skill, to understand the ministration towards those who live in a city so that it becomes a waking reality for us and no mere dream.

YS: That is surely correct.

279a

ST: Then we should take up that earlier argument once more, that since thousands dispute with the kingly class over the care of the city, it is necessary to separate off all these competitors and leave that single personage. And we said that, to this end, we do indeed need an example.

ΞΕ. πάλιν δὴ τὸν ἔμπροσθε λόγον ἀναληπτέον, ὥς ἐπειδὴ τῷ βασιλικῷ γένει τῆς περὶ τὰς πόλεις ἐπιμελείας ἀμφισβητοῦσι μυρίοι, δεῖ δὴ πάντας ἀποχωρίζειν τούτους καὶ μόνον ἐκεῖνον λείπειν καὶ πρὸς τοῦτο δὴ παραδείγματος ἔφαμεν δεῖν τινος ἡμῖν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. καὶ μάλα. ΞΕ. τί δῆτα παράδειγμά τις ἂν, ἔχον τὴν αὐτὴν πολιτικὴν πραγματείαν, σμικρότατον παραθέμενος ἱκανῶς ἂν εὖροι τὸ

YS: Very much so.

279b

ST: Then, what example, an insignificant one, involving the same activity as the statesman, might someone set beside it and discover what we are seeking well enough? By Zeus, Socrates, do you want, if we have nothing to hand, at least to choose weaving? And if you agree, not all of it? In fact, the weaving of items made of wool will probably suffice. Indeed, if we select it, this part of it is likely to provide the evidence we desire.

ζητούμενον; βούλει πρὸς Διός, ὦ Σώκρατες, εἰ μή τι πρόχειρον ἕτερον ἔχομεν, ἀλλ' οὖν τὴν γε ὑφαντικὴν προσελώμεθα; καὶ ταύτην, εἰ δοκεῖ, μὴ πᾶσαν; ἀποχρήσει γὰρ ἴσως ἢ περὶ τὰ ἐκ τῶν ἐρίων ὑφάσματα τάχα γὰρ ἂν ἡμῖν καὶ τοῦτο τὸ μέρος αὐτῆς μαρτυρήσειε προαιρεθὲν ὃ

βουλόμεθα. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. τί γὰρ οὐ; ΞΕ. τί δῆτα οὐ, καθάπερ ἐν τοῖς ἔμπροσθε τέμνοντες μέρη μερῶν ἕκαστον διηρούμεθα, καὶ νῦν περὶ ὑφαντικὴν

YS: Yes, why not?

279c

ST: Then why not do just what we did before when we divided each object by cutting parts into parts. Let's do the same thing now in relation to weaving, and as best we can go over everything again as briefly as possible, and arrive at what is useful to us now.

ταῦτόν τοῦτ' ἐδράσαμεν, καὶ κατὰ δύναμιν ὅτι μάλιστα διὰ βραχέων ταχὺ πάντ' ἐπελθόντες πάλιν ἤλθομεν ἐπὶ τὸ νῦν χρήσιμον; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. πῶς λέγεις; ΞΕ. αὐτὴν τὴν διέξοδον ἀπόκρισίν σοι ποιήσομαι. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. κάλλιστ' εἶπες. ΞΕ. ἔστι τοίνυν πάντα ἡμῖν ὅποσα δημιουργοῦμεν καὶ κτώμεθα, τὰ μὲν ἕνεκα τοῦ ποιεῖν τι, τὰ δὲ τοῦ μὴ πάσχειν ἀμυντήρια· καὶ τῶν ἀμυντηρίων τὰ μὲν ἀλεξιφάρμακα καὶ

YS: What do you mean?

ST: I shall make the exposition itself my answer to you.

YS: Excellent.

279d

ST: Well, in the case of everything we produce or acquire, some are for the purpose of doing something, while others are a defence against suffering something. Now, some of the defences are antidotes, whether divine or human, while others are barriers. And some of the barriers are military armaments, while others are screens. And some of the screens are covers, while others are protections against heat and cold. And some of the protections are shelters, others are blankets. And some of the blankets are carpets, while a different sort are garments. And some of the garments are cut from one piece, while a different sort are put together. And some of the put-together garments are sewn, while others are put together without sewing. And some of those that are unsewn are made from the fibres of plants from the earth, others from hair. And some of those made from hair are held together by

water or earth, while others bind themselves together by themselves. Now, we give the name clothes to those blankets and defences produced from materials bound together by themselves, while the skill that is particularly concerned with clothes – in the exact same way that we once said statesmanship is concerned with the city – should we now refer to this as 'clothes-making', naming it after the activity itself? And should we also state that weaving, insofar as it is for the most part the production of clothes, differs in nothing but name from that skill in clothes-making, just as in the other consideration kingship did not differ from statesmanship?

θεῖα καὶ ἀνθρώπινα, τὰ δὲ προβλήματα τῶν δὲ προβλημάτων τὰ μὲν πρὸς τὸν πόλεμον ὀπλίσματα, τὰ δὲ φράγματα καὶ τῶν φραγμάτων τὰ μὲν παραπετάσματα, τὰ δὲ πρὸς χειμῶνας καὶ καύματα ἀλεξητήρια τῶν δὲ ἀλεξητηρίων τὰ μὲν στεγάσματα, τὰ δὲ σκεπάσματα καὶ τῶν σκεπασμάτων ὑποπετάσματα μὲν ἄλλα, περικαλύμματα δὲ ἕτερα· περικαλυμμάτων δὲ τὰ μὲν ὀλόσχιστα, σύνθετα δὲ ἕτερα τῶν δὲ συνθέτων τὰ μὲν τρητά, τὰ δὲ ἄνευ τρήσεως συνδετά· καὶ τῶν ἀτρήτων τὰ μὲν νεύρινα φυτῶν ἐκ γῆς, τὰ δὲ τρίχινα τῶν δὲ τριχίνων τὰ μὲν ὕδασι καὶ γῇ κολλητά, τὰ δὲ αὐτὰ αὐτοῖς συνδετά. τούτοισι δὴ τοῖς ἐκ τῶν ἑαυτοῖς συνδουμένων ἐργασθεῖσιν ἀμυντηρίοις καὶ σκεπάσμασι τὸ μὲν ὄνομα ἱμάτια ἐκαλέσαμεν· τὴν δὲ τῶν ἱματίων μάλιστα ἐπιμελουμένην

280a

YS: You are absolutely right about that anyway.

τέχνην, ὥσπερ τότε τὴν τῆς πόλεως πολιτικὴν εἵπομεν, οὕτω καὶ νῦν ταύτην προσείπωμεν ἀπ' αὐτοῦ τοῦ πράγματος ἱματιουργικὴν; φῶμεν δὲ καὶ ὑφαντικὴν, ὅσον ἐπὶ τῇ τῶν ἱματίων ἐργασίᾳ μέγιστον ἦν μόριον, μὴδὲν διαφέρειν πλὴν ὀνόματι ταύτης τῆς ἱματιουργικῆς, καθάπερ κάκεῖ τότε τὴν βασιλικὴν τῆς πολιτικῆς; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ὀρθότατά γε. ΞΕ. τὸ μετὰ τοῦτο δὴ συλλογισώμεθα ὅτι τὴν ἱματίων

280b

ST: Yet we should recognise after this, that once the weaving of garments has been described in this way, someone might presume that it has been adequately described because he is unable to understand that although it has been distinguished from numerous other kindred skills, it has not yet been separated from its closest collaborators.

ύφαντικὴν οὕτω ῥηθεῖσάν τις τάχ' ἂν ἱκανῶς εἰρῆσθαι δόξειεν, μὴ δυνάμενος συννοεῖν ὅτι τῶν μὲν ἐγγὺς συνεργῶν οὕτω διώρισται, πολλῶν δὲ ἑτέρων συγγενῶν ἀπεμερίσθη. NE. ΣΩ. ποίων, εἰπέ, συγγενῶν; ΞΕ. οὐχ ἔσπου τοῖς λεχθεῖσιν, ὥς φαίνει· πάλιν οὖν ἔοικεν ἐπανιτέον ἀρχόμενον ἀπὸ τελευτῆς. εἰ γὰρ συννοεῖς τὴν οἰκειότητα, τὴν μὲν διετέμενον ἀπ' αὐτῆς νυνδὴ, τὴν τῶν στρωμάτων σύνθεσιν περιβολῇ χωρίζοντες καὶ ὑποβολῇ. NE. ΣΩ. μαθάνω.

YS: What sort of kindred skills do you mean?

ST: It appears you did not follow what was said, so it seems we must go back once more and begin where we ended. Yes. If you understand me, we have already cut off its closest relations by separating the assembly of blankets into those that are wrapped around and those that are placed beneath.

YS: I understand.

280c

ST: And, indeed, we set aside all manufacturing out of flax or rushes and out of everything we described summarily just now as plant fibres. And furthermore, we set aside felt-making and the putting together that employs stitching and sewing, the most significant of which is shoe-making.

ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν τὴν ἐκ τῶν λίνων καὶ σπάρτων καὶ πάντων ὅποσα φυτῶν ἄρτι νεῦρα κατὰ λόγον εἵπομεν, δημιουργίαν πᾶσαν ἀφείλομεν· τὴν τε αὖ πηλητικὴν ἀφωρισάμεθα καὶ τὴν τρήσει καὶ ῥαφῇ χρωμένην σύνθεσιν, ἧς ἡ πλείστη σκυτοτομική. NE. ΣΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. καὶ τοίνυν τὴν τῶν ὀλοσχίστων σκεπασμάτων θεραπείαν δερματοουργικὴν

καὶ τὰς τῶν στεγασμάτων, ὅσαι τε ἐν οἰκοδομικῇ καὶ ὅλη τεκτονικῇ καὶ ἐν ἄλλαις τέχναις ῥευμάτων

YS: Entirely so.

280d

ST: And what's more, leather-working ministers to blankets of one piece, and all those activities concerned with shelters, and any that are involved in house-building, in carpentry as a whole, and in other skills that protect against the influx of water. All these we set aside. Also, any skills concerned with shelters, and which provide preventive products against theft and violent actions, and involve the making of lids and the fitting of doors, and are designated as parts of the skill of joinery. We also cut away the making of armaments, which was a significant and extensive division of the barrier-making power. And, indeed, at the very outset we separated off the entire skill of magic that is concerned with antidotes. And we are left with what we take to be a defence against cold weather, the very skill we were looking for, the one that manufactures a woollen barrier and has been given the name weaving.

στεκτικαὶ γίνονται, συμπάσας ἀφείλομεν, ὅσαι τε περὶ τὰς κλοπὰς καὶ τὰς βίᾳ πράξεις διακωλυτικὰ ἔργα παρέχονται τέχναι φραγμάτων, περὶ τε γένεσιν ἐπιθηματοουργίας οὗσαι καὶ τὰς τῶν θυρωμάτων πήξεις, γομφωτικῆς ἀπονεμηθεῖσαι μόρια τέχνης· τήν τε ὀπλοποιικὴν ἀπετεμόμεθα, μεγάλης καὶ παντοίας τῆς προβληματουργικῆς τμήμα οὗσαν δυνάμεως·

280e

YS: Yes, that's how it seems.

καὶ δὴ καὶ τὴν μαγευτικὴν τὴν περὶ τὰ ἀλεξιφάρμακα κατ' ἀρχὰς εὐθύς διωρισάμεθα σύμπασαν, καὶ λελοίπαμεν, ὡς δόξαμεν ἄν, αὐτὴν τὴν ζητηθεῖσαν ἀμυντικὴν χειμώνων, ἐρεοῦ προβλήματος ἐργαστικὴν, ὄνομα δὲ ὑφαντικὴν λεχθεῖσαν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ἔοικε γὰρ οὖν. ΞΕ. ἀλλ' οὐκ ἔστι πῶ τέλεον, ὦ παῖ, τοῦτο λελεγμένον. ὁ γὰρ ἐν ἀρχῇ τῆς τῶν ἱματίων ἐργασίας ἀπτόμενος τούναντίον

ST: But, my boy, having said all this, it is still not complete, for the process involved at the start of the manufacture of clothing appears to do the opposite of weaving.

YS: How so?

ST: The process of weaving is presumably a kind of intertwining.

YS: Yes.

ST: And yet there is an initial process of breaking apart materials that have been combined and forced together.

YS: What sort of process do you mean?

281a

ST: The process associated with the skill of the carder of wool. Or shall we dare to refer to carding as weaving, or to the carder as though he were a weaver?

ὕφῃ δρᾶν φαίνεται. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. πῶς; ΞΕ. τὸ μὲν τῆς ὕφῆς συμπλοκή τις ἐστί που. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ναί. ΞΕ. τὸ δέ γε τῶν συνεστώτων καὶ συμπεπιλημένων διαλυτική. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. τὸ ποῖον δῆ; ΞΕ. τὸ τῆς τοῦ ξαίνοντος τέχνης ἔργον. ἢ τὴν ξαντικὴν τολμήσομεν ὕφαντικὴν καὶ τὸν ξάντην ὥς ὄντα ὕφάντην καλεῖν; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. οὐδαμῶς. ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν τὴν γε αὖ στήμονος ἐργαστικὴν καὶ κρόκης εἴ τις ὕφαντικὴν προσαγορεύει, παράδοξόν τε καὶ ψεῦδος

YS: Not at all.

ST: And, indeed, if anyone refers to the production of the warp and the woof as weaving, he is assigning a name that is both bizarre and false.

YS: He is, indeed.

281b

ST: What about this? Should we propose the entire skill of the fuller, and that of clothes-mending, are not in any sense either the care of clothes or attention to them, or shall we also refer to these as weaving skills?

ὄνομα λέγει. NE. ΣΩ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΞΕ. τί δέ; κναφευτικὴν σύμπασαν καὶ τὴν ἀκεστικὴν πότερα μηδεμίαν ἐπιμέλειαν μηδέ τινα θεραπείαν ἐσθῆτος θῶμεν, ἢ καὶ ταύτας πάσας ὥς ὑφαντικὰς λέξομεν; NE. ΣΩ. οὐδαμῶς. ΞΕ. ἀλλὰ μὴν τῆς γε θεραπείας ἀμφισβητήσουσιν αὐταὶ σύμπασαι καὶ τῆς γενέσεως τῆς τῶν ἱματίων τῇ τῆς ὑφαντικῆς δυνάμει, μέγιστον μὲν μέρος ἐκείνη διδοῦσαι, μεγάλα δὲ καὶ σφίσιν αὐταῖς ἀπονέμουσαι.

YS: Not at all.

ST: And yet, these will all dispute with the power of the weaving skill about the attention to, and the production of, clothes, conceding the largest part to that power, while allocating important parts to themselves too.

281c

YS: Entirely so.

NE. ΣΩ. πάνυ γε. ΞΕ. πρὸς τοίνυν ταύταις ἔτι τὰς τῶν ἐργαλείων δημιουργοὺς τέχνας, δι' ὧν ἀποτελεῖται τὰ τῆς ὑφῆς ἔργα, δοκεῖν χρή τό γε συναιτίας εἶναι προσποιήσασθαι παντὸς ὑφάσματος. NE. ΣΩ. ὀρθότατα. ΞΕ. πότερον οὖν ἡμῖν ὁ περὶ τῆς ὑφαντικῆς λόγος, οὗ προειλόμεθα μέρους, ἱκανῶς ἔσται διωρισμένος, ἐὰν ἄρ' αὐτὴν τῶν ἐπιμελειῶν ὅποσαι περὶ τὴν ἐρεᾶν ἐσθῆτα, εἰς τὴν

ST: Then, in addition to these claimants, it seems necessary that the skills that produce the instruments whereby the processes of weaving are accomplished will also pretend to be at least contributory causes of everything that is woven.

YS: Absolutely correct.

281d

ST: Now, will our account dealing with the part of weaving we have selected be definite enough, provided we position the skill as "the noblest and greatest of all those that are concerned with the care of woollen clothes"? Or would we be stating something true, but neither

clear nor complete until we have also taken away all those skills that surround it?

καλλίστην καὶ μεγίστην πασῶν τιθῶμεν· ἢ λέγοιμεν μὲν ἄν τι ἀληθές, οὐ μὴν σαφές γε οὐδὲ τέλος, πρὶν ἂν καὶ ταύτας αὐτῆς πάσας περιέλωμεν; NE. ΣΩ. ὀρθῶς. ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν μετὰ ταῦτα ποιητέον ὃ λέγομεν, ἴν' ἐφεξῆς ἡμῖν ὁ λόγος ᾗ; NE. ΣΩ. πῶς δ' οὐ; ΞΕ. πρῶτον μὲν τοίνυν δύο τέχνας οὔσας περὶ πάντα τὰ δρώμενα θεασώμεθα. NE. ΣΩ. τίνας; ΞΕ. τὴν μὲν γενέσεως οὔσαν συναίτιον, τὴν δ' αὐτὴν αἰτίαν. NE. ΣΩ. πῶς;

YS: Correct.

ST: So, shouldn't we go on to do what we are saying so that our account may proceed in due order?

YS: Of course.

ST: Then we should first look at two skills that are involved in all activities.

YS: What are they?

ST: The contributory cause of the production, and also the cause itself.

YS: How so?

281e

ST: Contributory causes are those which do not produce the product itself, but provide instruments to those who do produce it, without which the activity allotted to each of the skills would never take place. However, those that bring the product itself into existence are causes.

ΞΕ. ὅσαι μὲν τὸ πρᾶγμα αὐτὸ μὴ δημιουργοῦσι, ταῖς δὲ δημιουργούσαις ὄργανα παρασκευάζουσιν, ὧν μὴ παραγενομένων οὐκ ἂν ποτε ἐργασθεῖν τὸ προστεταγμένον ἐκάστη τῶν τεχνῶν, ταύτας μὲν συναιτίους, τὰς δὲ αὐτὸ τὸ πρᾶγμα ἀπεργαζομένας αἰτίας. NE. ΣΩ. ἔχει γοῦν λόγον. ΞΕ. μετὰ τοῦτο δὴ τὰς μὲν περὶ τε ἀτράκτους καὶ κερκίδας καὶ ὅποσα ἄλλα ὄργανα τῆς περὶ τὰ ἀμφιέσματα γενέσεως κοινωνεῖ,

πάσας συναιτίους εἵπωμεν, τὰς δὲ αὐτὰ θεραπευούσας καὶ δημιουργούσας αἰτίας; NE. ΣΩ. ὀρθότατα.

YS: Well, that makes sense anyway.

ST: So after this, should we refer to all that is concerned with spindles, shuttles and any other instruments that are involved in the production of garments as contributory causes, and those that minister to and produce the garments themselves as causes?

YS: Quite right.

282a

ST: Now, in the realm of causes, since the skill of adorning is so extensive, it is probably best to include clothes-cleaning, clothes-mending and any ministration associated therewith as part of this, and assign all of it the name 'the skill of the fuller'.

ΞΕ. τῶν αἰτιῶν δὴ πλυντικὴν μὲν καὶ ἀκεστικὴν καὶ πᾶσαν τὴν περὶ ταῦτα θεραπευτικὴν, πολλῆς οὔσης τῆς κοσμητικῆς, τούνταῦθα αὐτῆς μόριον εἰκὸς μάλιστα περιλαμβάνειν ὀνομάζοντας πᾶν τῇ τέχνῃ τῇ κναφευτικῇ. NE. ΣΩ. καλῶς. ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν ξαντικὴ γε καὶ νηστικὴ καὶ πάντα αὖ τὰ περὶ τὴν ποιήσιν αὐτὴν τῆς ἐσθῆτος ἧς λέγομεν μέρη, μία τίς ἐστι τέχνη τῶν ὑπὸ πάντων λεγομένων, ἡ ταλασιουργικὴ. NE. ΣΩ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ;

YS: Very well.

ST: And, indeed, carding and spinning, and everything which for its part concerns the manufacture of the clothing itself, the parts of which we are describing, is a single skill, one whose name is familiar to everyone – wool-working.

YS: Of course.

282b

ST: Now there are two divisions of wool-working, and each of these is, at the same time, part of two skills.

ΞΕ. τῆς δὴ ταλασιουργικῆς δύο τμήματά ἐστον, καὶ τούτοις ἐκάτερον ἅμα δυοῖν πεφύκατον τέχναις μέρη. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. πῶς; ΞΕ. τὸ μὲν ξαντικὸν καὶ τὸ τῆς κερκιστικῆς ἡμῖς καὶ ὅσα τὰ συγκείμενα ἀπ' ἀλλήλων ἀφίστησι, πᾶν τοῦτο ὡς ἐν φράζειν τῆς τε ταλασιουργίας αὐτῆς ἐστὶ που, καὶ μεγάλα τινεῖς κατὰ πάντα ἡμῖν ἦσθιν τέχνα, ἢ συγκριτικὴ τε καὶ διακριτικὴ. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ναί. ΞΕ. τῆς τοίνυν διακριτικῆς ἢ τε ξαντικῆς καὶ τὰ νυνδὴ

YS: How so?

ST: Carding, and one half of the activity associated with the shuttle, and any processes that separate compounded things from one another – all these can presumably be said to belong, as one, to wool-working itself. And we said that there are two particular major skills applicable to everything, combination and separation.

YS: Yes.

282c

ST: Well, carding and all the activities we mentioned just now are parts of the skill of separating, for the separation into woof and warp, arising in one way by means of the shuttle, and in another way by means of the hand, has acquired as many names as we mentioned a moment ago.

ῥηθέντα ἅπαντά ἐστιν· ἢ γὰρ ἐν ἐρίοις τε καὶ στήμοσι διακριτικὴ, κερκίδι μὲν ἄλλον τρόπον γιγνομένη, χερσὶ δὲ ἕτερον, ἔσχεν ὅσα ἀρτίως ὀνόματα ἐρρήθη. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. αὖθις δὴ πάλιν συγκριτικῆς μῶριον ἅμα καὶ ταλασιουργίας ἐν αὐτῇ γιγνόμενον λάβωμεν· ὅσα δὲ τῆς διακριτικῆς ἦν αὐτόθι, μεθιῶμεν σύμπαντα, δίχα τέμνοντες τὴν ταλασιουργίαν διακριτικῶς τε καὶ συγκριτικῶς τμήματι. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. διηρήσθω. ΞΕ. τὸ συγκριτικὸν τοίνυν αὖ σοι καὶ ταλασιουργικὸν

YS: Entirely so.

ST: Then again, we should once more take a part of the skill of combining, a part that is at the same time a part of wool-working. Let's

set aside the entire skill of dividing we find there, and cut wool-working into two parts, separative and combinative.

282d

YS: Let the division be made.

ἅμα μόνιον, ὧ Σώκρατες, διαιρετέον, εἴπερ ἱκανῶς μέλλομεν τὴν προρρηθεῖσαν ὑφαντικὴν αἰρήσειν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν χρή. ΞΕ. χρή μὲν οὖν· καὶ λέγωμέν γε αὐτῆς τὸ μὲν εἶναι στρεπτικόν, τὸ δὲ συμπλεκτικόν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν μανθάνω; δοκεῖς γάρ μοι τὸ περὶ τὴν τοῦ στήμονος ἐργασίαν λέγειν στρεπτικόν. ΞΕ. οὐ μόνον γε, ἀλλὰ καὶ κρόκης ἢ γένεσιν ἄστροφόν τινα αὐτῆς εὐρήσομεν; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. οὐδαμῶς.

ST: Then, Socrates, you should go on to divide the part that at once involves combination and wool-working if we are going to properly apprehend the aforementioned skill of weaving.

YS: So that's what's needed.

ST: It is needed. So, let's say that one part of it is twisting while the other is intertwining.

YS: Do I understand you? You seem to be referring to the process involved in the production of the warp as twisting.

ST: Not only of the warp, but of the woof too. Or shall we expect to find some origin for the woof that avoids twisting?

YS: Not at all.

ST: Then you should also distinguish each of these two, for perhaps the distinction may prove opportune for you.

YS: In what way?

282e

ST: As follows. Are the products of the carding process, once they have been lengthened and have also acquired breadth, referred to as drawn wool?

ΞΕ. διόρισαι δὴ καὶ τούτοις ἑκάτερον· ἴσως γὰρ ὁ διορισμὸς ἔγκαιρος ἂν σοι γένοιτο. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. πῃ; ΞΕ. τῇδε· τῶν περὶ ξαντικὴν ἔργων μηκυνθέν τε καὶ σχὸν πλάτος λέγομεν εἶναι κατάγμά τι; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ναί. ΞΕ. τούτου δὴ τὸ μὲν ἀτράκτω τε στραφέν καὶ στερεὸν νῆμα γενόμενον στήμονα μὲν φάθι τὸ νῆμα, τὴν δὲ ἀπευθύνουσιν αὐτὸ τέχνην εἶναι στημονονητικὴν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ὀρθῶς. ΞΕ. ὅσα δέ γε αὖ τὴν μὲν συστροφὴν χαύνην λαμβάνει, τῇ δὲ τοῦ στήμονος ἐμπλέξει πρὸς τὴν τῆς γνάψεως ὀλκὴν ἐμμέτρως τὴν μαλακότητα ἴσχει, ταῦτ' ἄρα κρόκην μὲν τὰ νηθέντα, τὴν δὲ ἐπιτεταγμένην αὐτοῖς εἶναι τέχνην τὴν

YS: Yes.

ST: Well, any of this that has been twisted by the spindle and has become hard yarn, you call warp yarn, and the skill that directs this, warp-spinning.

YS: Correct.

ST: While any threads that for their part undergo a loose twisting and possess a measure of softness appropriate to being woven into the warp – in view of the force applied in the dressing of the cloth – these we call woof yarn, and the skill that presides over them we call woof-spinning.

283a

YS: Quite right.

κροκονητικὴν φῶμεν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ὀρθότατα. ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν τό γε τῆς ὕφαντικῆς μέρος ὃ προυθέμεθα, παντί που δῆλον ἦδη. τὸ γὰρ συγκριτικῆς τῆς ἐν ταλασιουργίᾳ μόριον ὅταν εὐθυπλοκίᾳ κρόκης καὶ στήμονος ἀπεργάζεται πλέγμα, τὸ μὲν πλεχθὲν σύμπαν ἐσθῆτα ἐρεᾶν, τὴν δ' ἐπὶ τούτῳ τέχνην οὕσαν προσαγορεύομεν ὕφαντικὴν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ὀρθότατα.

ST: And so, the part of weaving which we have been pursuing is presumably evident to everyone by now. For whenever the combinative part that is involved in wool-working produces a web by

directly intertwining woof and warp, the entire web is referred to as a woollen garment, and the skill set over it as weaving.

YS: Quite right.

283b

ST: So be it. Now, why ever did we not reply straight away that weaving was the twining of woof and warp, instead of going around in a circle, pointlessly making a whole range of distinctions?

ΞΕ. εἶεν· τί δὴ ποτε οὖν οὐκ εὐθὺς ἀπεκρινάμεθα πλεκτικὴν εἶναι κρόκης καὶ στήμονος ὑφαντικὴν, ἀλλὰ περιήλθομεν ἐν κύκλῳ πάμπολλα διοριζόμενοι μάτην; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. οὐκ οὐκ ἔμοιγε, ὦ ξέने, μάτην οὐδὲν τῶν ῥηθέντων ἔδοξε ῥηθῆναι. ΞΕ. καὶ θαυμαστόν γε οὐδέν· ἀλλὰ τάχ' ἂν, ὦ μακάριε, δόξειε. πρὸς δὴ τὸ νόσημα τὸ τοιοῦτον, ἂν ἄρα πολλάκις ὕστερον ἐπὶ—θαυμαστόν γάρ οὐδέν—λόγον ἄκουσόν τινα

YS: Well, stranger, nothing that was said seemed pointless to me, anyway.

ST: That is no surprise, bless you, but perhaps in time it may seem so. Well, to counteract such a malady as this, in case it ever afflicts you in future – which would be no surprise – listen to an argument which it is appropriate to state concerning everything like this.

YS: Please state it.

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ST: Well, in the first place, let's look at all excess and deficiency so that we attribute praise and blame on a reasonable basis, on occasions when the speeches involved in discussions of this sort are longer than necessary, or the opposite.

προσήκοντα περὶ πάντων τῶν τοιούτων ῥηθῆναι. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. λέγε μόνον. ΞΕ. πρῶτον τοῖνυν ἴδωμεν πᾶσαν τήν τε ὑπερβολὴν καὶ τὴν ἑλλειψιν, ἵνα κατὰ λόγον ἐπαινώμεν καὶ ψέγωμεν τὰ μακρότερα τοῦ δέοντος ἐκάστοτε λεγόμενα καὶ τὰναντία περὶ τὰς τοιάσδε διατριβάς. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν χρή. ΞΕ. περὶ δὴ τούτων αὐτῶν ὁ λόγος ἡμῖν οἶμαι γιγνώμενος

ὀρθῶς ἂν γίγνοιτο. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. τίνων; ΞΕ. μήκους τε πέρι καὶ βραχύτητος καὶ πάσης ὑπεροχῆς

YS: That's what's needed.

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ST: Well, if our discussion was about these issues themselves, I think it would be proceeding correctly.

τε καὶ ἐλλείψεως· ἡ γάρ που μετρητικὴ περὶ πάντ' ἐστὶ ταῦτα. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ναί. ΞΕ. διέλωμεν τοίνυν αὐτὴν δύο μέρη· δεῖ γὰρ δὴ πρὸς ὃ νῦν σπεύδομεν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. λέγοις ἂν τὴν διαίρεσιν ὅπῃ. ΞΕ. τῇδε· τὸ μὲν κατὰ τὴν πρὸς ἄλληλα μεγέθους καὶ σμικρότητος κοινωνίαν, τὸ δὲ τὸ κατὰ τὴν τῆς γενέσεως ἀναγκαίαν οὐσίαν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. πῶς λέγεις; ΞΕ. ἄρ' οὐ κατὰ φύσιν δοκεῖ σοι τὸ μείζον μηδενὸς ἐτέρου δεῖν μείζον λέγειν ἢ τοῦ ἐλάττονος, καὶ τοῦλαττον αὖ

YS: About what issues?

ST: About length and brevity and all excess and deficiency, for I presume that the skill of measurement is concerned with all these?

YS: Yes.

ST: Then we should distinguish two parts of this, since that's what is necessary for our present objective.

YS: Please tell us how to make the division.

ST: As follows. One corresponds to the shared interrelationship of greatness and smallness, and the other corresponds to the being necessary for becoming.

YS: What do you mean?

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ST: Well, don't you think it is natural that the greater should be referred to as greater than nothing else except the lesser, and the lesser for its part as lesser than nothing other than the greater?

τοῦ μείζονος ἔλαττον, ἄλλου δὲ μηδενός; NE. ΣΩ. ἔμοιγε. ΞΕ. τί δέ; τὸ τὴν τοῦ μετρίου φύσιν ὑπερβάλλον καὶ ὑπερβαλλόμενον ὑπ' αὐτῆς ἐν λόγοις εἴτε καὶ ἐν ἔργοις ἄρ' οὐκ αὖ λέξομεν ὡς ὄντως γιγνόμενον, ἐν ᾧ καὶ διαφέρουσι μάλιστα ἡμῶν οἱ τε κακοὶ καὶ οἱ ἀγαθοί; NE. ΣΩ. φαίνεται. ΞΕ. διττὰς ἄρα ταύτας οὐσίας καὶ κρίσεις τοῦ μεγάλου καὶ τοῦ μικροῦ θετέον, ἀλλ' οὐχ ὡς ἔφαμεν ἄρτι πρὸς ἄλληλα μόνον δεῖν, ἀλλ' ὥσπερ νῦν εἴρηται μᾶλλον τὴν μὲν πρὸς ἄλληλα λεκτέον, τὴν δ' αὖ πρὸς τὸ μέτριον οὗ δὲ ἕνεκα, μαθεῖν ἄρ' ἂν βουλοίμεθα; NE. ΣΩ. τί μήν;

YS: I do.

ST: What about this? Won't we say also that exceeding the nature of the measure, and being exceeded by it, be it in word or deed, does actually happen. And this is how those who are good and those who are bad among us are chiefly distinguished?

YS: Apparently so.

ST: So, we should propose then that things can be, and can be judged to be, great and small in these two ways. But we should not state, as we did a moment ago, that they only relate to one another. Rather, as we are now saying, we should declare that they relate to one another, but also to the measure. Would you like to understand why we should say so?

YS: Of course.

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ST: If we allow the nature of the greater to relate to nothing except to the lesser, it will never relate to the measure. Is this so?

ΞΕ. εἰ πρὸς μηδὲν ἕτερον τὴν τοῦ μείζονος ἐάσει τις φύσιν ἢ πρὸς τοῦλαττον, οὐκ ἔσται ποτὲ πρὸς τὸ μέτριον ἢ γάρ; NE. ΣΩ. οὕτως. ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν τὰς τέχνας τε αὐτὰς καὶ τᾶργα αὐτῶν σύμπαντα διολοῦμεν τούτῳ τῷ λόγῳ, καὶ δὴ καὶ τὴν ζητουμένην νῦν πολιτικὴν καὶ τὴν ῥηθεῖσαν ὑφαντικὴν ἀφανιοῦμεν; ἅπασαι γὰρ αἱ τοιαῦταί που τὸ τοῦ μετρίου πλεον καὶ ἔλαττον οὐχ ὡς οὐκ ὄν ἀλλ' ὡς ὄν χαλεπὸν περὶ τὰς πράξεις

YS: Quite so.

ST: In that case, won't we destroy both the skills themselves and their products in their entirety by this argument, and what's more, obliterate the statesmanship we are now seeking and the weaving we have been describing? For all such skills are, somehow, vigilant about excess and deficiency of the measure, regarding it not as something that is not, but as something that is a difficult aspect of their activities, and indeed by so doing they preserve the measure and make everything good and beautiful.

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YS: Of course.

παραφυλάττουσι, καὶ τούτῳ δὴ τῷ τρόπῳ τὸ μέτρον σώζουσai πάντα ἀγαθὰ καὶ καλὰ ἀπεργάζονται. NE. ΣΩ. τί μήν; ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν ἂν τὴν πολιτικὴν ἀφανίσωμεν, ἄπορος ἡμῖν ἢ μετὰ τοῦτο ἔσται ζητησις τῆς βασιλικῆς ἐπιστήμης; NE. ΣΩ. καὶ μάλα. ΞΕ. πότερον οὖν, καθάπερ ἐν τῷ σοφιστῇ προσηναγκάσαμεν εἶναι τὸ μὴ ὄν, ἐπειδὴ κατὰ τοῦτο διέφυγεν ἡμᾶς ὁ λόγος, οὕτω καὶ νῦν τὸ πλέον αὖ καὶ ἔλαττον μετρητὰ προσαναγκαστέον γίνεσθαι μὴ πρὸς ἄλληλα μόνον ἀλλὰ καὶ

ST: And if we should obliterate statesmanship, our subsequent search for the knowledge of kingship will be blocked.

YS: Very much so.

ST: Then, just as in considering the sophist we compelled what is not to be when the argument got away from us on this issue, so too mustn't we now compel the more and the less, for their part, to come to be measured not only in relation to one another, but also in relation to the source of the measure? Indeed, unless this has been agreed, it is not actually possible that a statesman, or anyone else with knowledge of practical matters, should come into being in an undisputed manner.

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YS: In that case, as best we can, we must do the same thing now.

πρὸς τὴν τοῦ μετρίου γένεσιν; οὐ γὰρ δὴ δυνατόν γε οὔτε πολιτικὸν οὔτ' ἄλλον τινὰ τῶν περὶ τὰς πράξεις ἐπιστήμονα ἀναμφισβητήτως γεγονέναι τούτου μὴ συνομολογηθέντος. NE. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν καὶ νῦν ὅτι μάλιστα χρὴ ταῦτόν ποιεῖν. ΞΕ. πλέον, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἔτι τοῦτο τὸ ἔργον ἢ 'κεῖνο— καίτοι κάκεινός γε μεμνήμεθα τὸ μῆκος ὅσον ἦν—ἀλλ' ὑποτίθεσθαι μὲν τὸ τοιόνδε περὶ αὐτῶν καὶ μάλα δίκαιον. NE. ΣΩ. τὸ ποῖον;

ST: This topic, Socrates, is more extensive than that earlier one, and you do remember how long that was. However, it is most appropriate to put forward the following hypothesis about them.

YS: What is it?

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ST: That what has been said now will be needed some time for the demonstration of the utmost precision. But for our present purposes, what is being demonstrated beautifully and adequately seems to be supported magnificently by this argument of ours, according to which we should think that all the skills exist in like manner, and at the same time, that greater and less are to be measured not only in relation to one another, but also in relation to the source of the measure. For if this measure exists, then those skills exist, and if they exist, then this also exists, and if either of these doesn't exist, neither will ever exist.

ΞΕ. ὥς ποτε δεήσει τοῦ νῦν λεχθέντος πρὸς τὴν περὶ αὐτὸ τὰκριβὲς ἀπόδειξιν. ὅτι δὲ πρὸς τὰ νῦν καλῶς καὶ ἱκανῶς δείκνυται, δοκεῖ μοι βοηθεῖν μεγαλοπρεπῶς ἡμῖν οὗτος ὁ λόγος, ὥς ἄρα ἡγητέον ὁμοίως τὰς τέχνας πάσας εἶναι, μεῖζόν τε ἅμα καὶ ἔλαττον μετρεῖσθαι μὴ πρὸς ἄλληλα μόνον ἀλλὰ καὶ πρὸς τὴν τοῦ μετρίου γένεσιν. τούτου τε γὰρ ὄντος ἐκεῖνα ἔστι, κάκεινων οὐσῶν ἔστι καὶ τοῦτο, μὴ δὲ ὄντος ποτέρου τούτων οὐδέτερον αὐτῶν ἔσται ποτέ.

YS: That's right. But what comes after this?

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ST: Obviously we would divide the skill of measurement in the manner stated, cutting it into two, and designating one part of it as all those

skills that measure number, length, depth, breadth, and speed in relation to their opposites. While the other one measures them in relation to the measure, to what is appropriate, timely, necessary, and whatever else betakes itself away from the extremes towards the mean.

NE. ΣΩ. τοῦτο μὲν ὀρθῶς· ἀλλὰ τί δὴ τὸ μετὰ τοῦτο; ΞΕ. δῆλον ὅτι διαιροῖμεν ἂν τὴν μετρητικὴν, καθάπερ ἐρρήθη, ταύτη δίχα τέμνοντες, ἓν μὲν τιθέντες αὐτῆς μόριον συμπάσας τέχνας ὁπόσαι τὸν ἀριθμὸν καὶ μήκη καὶ βάθη καὶ πλάτη καὶ ταχυτήτας πρὸς τοῦναντίον μετροῦσιν, τὸ δὲ ἕτερον, ὁπόσαι πρὸς τὸ μέτριον καὶ τὸ πρέπον καὶ τὸν καιρὸν καὶ τὸ δέον καὶ πάνθ' ὁπόσα εἰς τὸ μέσον ἀπωκίσθη τῶν ἐσχάτων. NE. ΣΩ. καὶ μέγα γε ἐκάτερον τμήμα εἶπες, καὶ πολὺ διαφέρον ἀλλήλοιν. ΞΕ. ὃ γὰρ ἐνίστε, ὦ Σώκρατες, οἴομενοι δὴ τι σοφὸν

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YS: Yes. Each of the divisions you describe is significant, and very different from one another.

φράζειν πολλοὶ τῶν κομψῶν λέγουσιν, ὥς ἄρα μετρητικὴ περὶ πάντ' ἐστὶ τὰ γιγνόμενα, τοῦτ' αὐτὸ τὸ νῦν λεχθὲν ὃν τυγχάνει. μετρήσεως μὲν γὰρ δὴ τίνα τρόπον πάνθ' ὁπόσα ἔντεχνα μετείληφεν· διὰ δὲ τὸ μὴ κατ' εἶδη συνειθίσθαι σκοπεῖν διαιρουμένους ταῦτά τε τοσοῦτον διαφέροντα συμβάλλουσιν εὐθύς εἰς ταῦτὸν ὅμοια νομίσαντες, καὶ τοῦναντίον αὖ τοῦτου δρῶσιν ἕτερα οὐ κατὰ μέρη διαιροῦντες, δέον, ὅταν μὲν τὴν τῶν πολλῶν τις πρότερον αἰσθηταὶ κοινωνίαν, μὴ προαφίστασθαι πρὶν ἂν ἐν αὐτῇ τὰς διαφορὰς ἴδῃ πάσας ὁπόσαι περ ἐν εἶδεσι κεῖνται, τὰς δὲ αὖ παντοδαπὰς ἀνομοιότητας, ὅταν ἐν πλήθει οὐκ ὀφθῶσιν, μὴ δυνατόν εἶναι δυσωπούμενον παύεσθαι πρὶν ἂν σύμπαντα τὰ οἰκεῖα ἐντὸς μιᾶς ὁμοιότητος ἔρξας γένους τινὸς οὐσίᾳ περιβάληται. ταῦτα μὲν οὖν ἱκανῶς περὶ τε τούτων καὶ περὶ τῶν ἐλλείψεων καὶ ὑπερβολῶν εἰρήσθω· φυλάττωμεν δὲ μόνον ὅτι δύο γένη

ST: Yes, Socrates. Many refined thinkers, believing themselves to be stating something wise, declare that measurement is concerned with everything that comes into being, and this is just what we are saying. For, in a sense, everything that involves a skill partakes of

measurement. And yet, because people are unaccustomed to investigation by dividing on the basis of forms, they immediately combine these together as the same, despite their degree of difference, since they regard them as similar. And they also do the opposite of this, separating what is different, but not on the basis of its parts. What is necessary is that when someone first perceives what is common to many, he should not desist until he beholds therein all the differences that repose within their forms. On the other hand, when he beholds the variety of dissimilarities in multiplicities, he must be incapable of getting disconcerted and stopping until, having brought all the kindred into one particular class of likeness, he encompasses them in being.

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ST: Now, let these statements concerning these matters suffice, and also those concerning deficiencies and excesses. However, let's just note carefully that two kinds of measurement concerning these have been discovered, and let us remember what we say they are.

περὶ αὐτὰ ἐξηύρηται τῆς μετρητικῆς, καὶ ἃ φαμεν αὐτ' εἶναι μεμνώμεθα. NE. ΣΩ. μεμνησόμεθα. ΞΕ. μετὰ τοῦτον δὴ τὸν λόγον ἕτερον προσδεξώμεθα περὶ αὐτῶν τε τῶν ζητουμένων καὶ περὶ πάσης τῆς ἐν τοῖς τοιοῖσδε λόγοις διατριβῆς. NE. ΣΩ. τὸ ποῖον; ΞΕ. εἴ τις ἀνέροιτο ἡμᾶς τὴν περὶ γράμματα συνουσίαν τῶν μαθανόντων, ὁπόταν τις ὁτιοῦν ὄνομα ἐρωτηθῇ τίνων ἐστὶ γραμμάτων, πότερον αὐτῷ τότε φῶμεν γίνεσθαι τὴν

YS: We shall remember.

ST: Well, after this account we should entertain another consideration concerning the very things we are seeking, and concerning all conduct of discussions of this sort.

YS: What is it?

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ST: Suppose someone were to ask us about students learning their letters. Whenever one of them is asked what letters make up a

particular word, would we say that the query is presented to him on that occasion more for the sake of the word, the one he is presented with, or for the sake of his becoming more skilled in all words he comes across?

ζήτησιν ἑνὸς ἔνεκα μᾶλλον τοῦ προβληθέντος ἢ τοῦ περὶ πάντα τὰ προβαλλόμενα γραμματικωτέρῳ γίνεσθαι; NE. ΣΩ. δῆλον ὅτι τοῦ περὶ ἅπαντα. ΞΕ. τί δ' αὖ νῦν ἡμῖν ἢ περὶ τοῦ πολιτικοῦ ζήτησις; ἔνεκα αὐτοῦ τούτου προβέβληται μᾶλλον ἢ τοῦ περὶ πάντα διαλεκτικωτέροις γίνεσθαι; NE. ΣΩ. καὶ τοῦτο δῆλον ὅτι τοῦ περὶ πάντα. ΞΕ. ἦ που τὸν τῆς ὑφαντικῆς γε λόγον αὐτῆς ταύτης ἔνεκα θηρεύειν οὐδεὶς ἂν ἐθελήσειεν νοῦν ἔχων· ἀλλ' οἶμαι τοὺς πλείστους λέληθεν ὅτι τοῖς μὲν τῶν ὄντων ῥαδίως

YS: Obviously it is for the sake of becoming skilled in all of them.

ST: And what about our present enquiry concerning the statesman? Has it been posed more for the sake of this person himself or for the sake of becoming more skilled in dialectic concerning everything?

YS: In this case too, it is obviously for the sake of everything.

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ST: Yes. I presume that no one in his right mind would wish to pursue this account of weaving for the sake of the subject itself. But I think most people overlook the fact that readily comprehensible, perceptible likenesses are naturally present for some of the things that are, and it is not at all difficult to present these when one wishes to give an easy demonstration to someone who asks for an account thereof which is uncomplicated and non-verbal. However, in the case of the most significant and revered of the things that are, there is no image at all wrought in clear view before humanity, by pointing to which someone who wishes to satisfy the soul of an enquirer may do so in an adequate manner by fitting it to some aspect of our sense perceptions. Therefore, it is necessary to practise being able to give and to receive an account of each. For the things that are devoid of body, being the most beautiful and the most significant, are shown clearly by the

argument alone, and by nothing else, and all that we are now saying is said for the sake of those. But it is easier to practise anything on lesser matters rather than greater ones.

καταμαθεῖν αἰσθηταί τινες ὁμοιότητες πεφύκασιν, ἅς οὐδὲν χαλεπὸν δηλοῦν, ὅταν αὐτῶν τις βουλευθῇ τῷ λόγον αἰτοῦντι περὶ τοῦ μὴ μετὰ πραγμάτων ἀλλὰ χωρὶς λόγου ῥαδίως ἐνδείξασθαι τοῖς δ' αὖ μεγίστοις οὔσι καὶ τιμιωτάτοις οὐκ ἔστιν εἶδωλον οὐδὲν πρὸς τοὺς ἀνθρώπους εἰργασμένον ἐναργῶς, οὗ δειχθέντος τὴν τοῦ πυνθανομένου ψυχὴν ὁ βουλόμενος ἀποπληρῶσαι, πρὸς τῶν αἰσθήσεων τινα προσαρμόττων, ἱκανῶς πληρώσει. ΞΕ. διὸ δεῖ μελετᾶν λόγον ἐκάστου δυνατὸν εἶναι δοῦναι καὶ δέξασθαι τὰ γὰρ ἀσώματα, κάλλιστα ὄντα καὶ μέγιστα, λόγῳ μόνον ἄλλω δὲ οὐδενὶ σαφῶς δείκνυται, τούτων δὲ ἔνεκα πάντ' ἐστὶ τὰ νῦν λεγόμενα. ῥάων

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YS: You have expressed that perfectly.

δ' ἐν τοῖς ἐλάττωσιν ἡ μελέτη παντὸς πέρι μᾶλλον ἢ περὶ τὰ μείζω. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. κάλλιστ' εἶπες. ΞΕ. ὦν τοίνυν χάριν ἅπανθ' ἡμῖν ταῦτ' ἐρρήθη περὶ τούτων, μνησθῶμεν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. τίνων; ΞΕ. ταύτης τε οὐχ ἥκιστα αὐτῆς ἔνεκα τῆς δυσχερείας ἦν περὶ τὴν μακρολογίαν τὴν περὶ τὴν ὑφαντικὴν ἀπεδεξάμεθα δυσχερῶς, καὶ τὴν περὶ τὴν τοῦ παντὸς ἀνείλιξιν καὶ τὴν τοῦ σοφιστοῦ πέρι τῆς τοῦ μὴ ὄντος οὐσίας, ἐννοοῦντες ὡς ἔσχε μῆκος πλέον, καὶ ἐπὶ τούτοις δὴ πᾶσιν ἐπεπλήξαμεν

ST: Then let us recall the reasons why we have had so much to say about all this.

YS: What were they?

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ST: Not least was the aversion we felt over the lengthy account which dealt with weaving, and over the reverse-motion of the universe, and, in the case of the sophist, the being of non-being when we realised how very lengthy it was. And we rebuked ourselves over all of this, fearing that we might be stating something over-elaborate as well as lengthy. So we should declare that everything we have said so far was

on account of these concerns, so that nothing of this sort should happen to us again.

ἡμῖν αὐτοῖς, δέισαντες μὴ περίεργα ἅμα καὶ μακρὰ λέγοιμεν. ἴν' οὖν εἰς αὐθις μηδὲν πάσχωμεν τοιοῦτον, τούτων ἔνεκα πάντων τὰ πρόσθε νῶν εἰρησθαι φάθι. NE. ΣΩ. ταῦτ' ἔσται. λέγε ἐξῆς μόνον. ΞΕ. λέγω τοίνυν ὅτι χρὴ δὴ μεμνημένους ἐμὲ καὶ σὲ τῶν νῦν εἰρημένων τόν τε φόγον ἐκάστοτε καὶ ἔπαινον ποιῆσθαι βραχύτητος ἅμα καὶ μήκους ὧν ἂν ἀεὶ περὶ λέγωμεν, μὴ πρὸς ἄλληλα τὰ μήκη κρίνοντες ἀλλὰ κατὰ τὸ

YS: Be it so. Just say what comes next.

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ST: Well, I say that it is necessary for you and me, remembering what has just been said, to allocate censure and praise on each occasion for the brevity and, at the same time, the length involved in the expositions we so often deliver by judging their length not in relation to one another, but on the basis of the part of the skill of measuring that we said we should remember – namely, in relation to what is appropriate.

τῆς μετρητικῆς μέρος ὃ τότε ἔφαμεν δεῖν μεμνησθαι, πρὸς τὸ πρέπον. NE. ΣΩ. ὀρθῶς. ΞΕ. οὐ τοίνυν οὐδὲ πρὸς τοῦτο πάντα. οὔτε γὰρ πρὸς τὴν ἡδονὴν μήκους ἀρμόττοντος οὐδὲν προσδεησόμεθα, πλὴν εἰ πάρεργόν τι τό τε αὖ πρὸς τὴν τοῦ προβληθέντος ζήτησιν, ὥς ἂν ῥᾶστα καὶ τάχιστα εὖροιμεν, δεύτερον ἀλλ' οὐ πρῶτον ὁ λόγος ἀγαπᾷ παραγγέλλει, πολὺ δὲ μάλιστα καὶ πρῶτον τὴν μέθοδον αὐτὴν τιμᾷ τοῦ κατ' εἶδη δυνατὸν εἶναι διαιρεῖν,

YS: Rightly so.

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ST: Yes. But this is not applicable in all cases, for we shall not have need of length which is added on for the sake of pleasure, except as a secondary consideration. And again, in relation to the enquiry into the issue before us, the argument directs us to favour the easiest and quickest approach as something we should seek out as a second priority, not as a first. First and foremost, we should respect the

method itself, by which we are able to make divisions on the basis of forms. And, indeed, should a discussion prove inordinately lengthy, and yet place the hearer in a better position to make discoveries, we should take it seriously and be untroubled by its duration. And the same applies if it is very short. Furthermore, besides these considerations, someone who criticises gatherings of this sort, due to the length of the discussions, and finds the circular course of the arguments hard to accept, should not be allowed to turn and go on the spot, in all haste, having levelled his criticism solely on the basis of the length of what was said. No, he should also prove that we should accept that the people present would have been rendered more skilled in dialectic – and better at discovering the exposition of things that are – by an account, had the process been made shorter. As for the other criticisms and praises based on other criteria, we should not think about them, or even seem to hear such arguments at all.

καὶ δὴ καὶ λόγον, ἅντε παμμήκης λεχθεὶς τὸν ἀκούσαντα εὐρετικώτερον ἀπεργάζεται, τοῦτον σπουδάζειν καὶ τῷ μήκει μηδὲν ἀγανακτεῖν, ἄντ' αὖ βραχύτερος, ὡσαύτως· ἔτι δ' αὖ πρὸς τούτοις τὸν περὶ τὰς τοιάσδε συνουσίας ψέγοντα λόγων μήκη καὶ τὰς ἐν κύκλῳ περιόδους οὐκ ἀποδεχόμενον, ὅτι χρή τὸν τοιοῦτον μὴ πάνυ ταχὺ μηδ' εὐθὺς οὕτω μεθιέναι ψέξαντα

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ST: Anyway, that's enough on these issues, provided you agree with me on this. So we should go back to the statesman and apply to him the example of weaving as described before.

μόνον ὡς μακρὰ τὰ λεχθέντα, ἀλλὰ καὶ προσαποφαίνειν οἷεσθαι δεῖν ὡς βραχύτερα ἂν γεγόμενα τοὺς συνόντας ἀπηργάζετο διαλεκτικωτέρους καὶ τῆς τῶν ὄντων λόγῳ δηλώσεως εὐρετικωτέρους, τῶν δὲ ἄλλων καὶ πρὸς ἄλλ' ἅττα ψόγων καὶ ἐπαίνων μηδὲν φροντίζειν μηδὲ τὸ παράπαν ἀκούειν δοκεῖν τῶν τοιούτων λόγων. καὶ τούτων μὲν ἅλις, εἰ καὶ σοὶ ταύτη συνδοκεῖ· πρὸς δὲ δὴ τὸν πολιτικὸν

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YS: That is well expressed, and we should do as you say.

ἴωμεν πάλιν, τῆς προρρηθείσης ὑφαντικῆς αὐτῷ φέροντες τὸ παράδειγμα. NE. ΣΩ. καλῶς εἶπες, καὶ ποιῶμεν ἃ λέγεις. ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν ἀπὸ γε τῶν πολλῶν ὁ βασιλεὺς ὅσαι σύννομοι, μᾶλλον δὲ ἀπὸ πασῶν τῶν περὶ τὰς ἀγέλας διακεχώρισται λοιπαὶ δέ, φαμέν, αἱ κατὰ πόλιν αὐτήν τῶν τε συναιτίων καὶ τῶν αἰτίων, ἃς πρώτας ἀπ' ἀλλήλων διαιρετέον. NE. ΣΩ. ὀρθῶς. ΞΕ. οἴσθ' οὖν ὅτι χαλεπὸν αὐτὰς τεμεῖν δίχα; τὸ δ'

ST: Now, the king has at least been separated from the many skills that are kindred, or rather from all of those that are concerned with herds. What remains, we say, are the contributory causes, and the causes applicable to the city itself. And these we should first separate from one another.

YS: Correct.

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ST: Now, do you realise that it is difficult to cut these in two? The reason, I believe, will become evident anyway as we proceed.

αἴτιον, ὡς οἶμαι, προῖοῦσιν οὐχ ἥττον ἔσται καταφανές. NE. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν χρή δρᾶν οὕτως. ΞΕ. κατὰ μέλη τοίνυν αὐτὰς οἷον ἱερεῖον διαιρώμεθα, ἐπειδὴ δίχα ἀδυνατοῦμεν. δεῖ γὰρ εἰς τὸν ἐγγύτατα ὅτι μάλιστα τέμνειν ἀριθμὸν αἰεῖ. NE. ΣΩ. πῶς οὖν ποιῶμεν τὰ νῦν; ΞΕ. ὥσπερ ἔμπροσθεν, ὅπόσαι παρείχοντο ὄργανα περὶ τὴν ὑφαντικὴν, πάσας δὴπου τότε ἐτίθεμεν ὡς συναιτίους. NE. ΣΩ. ναί. ΞΕ. καὶ νῦν δὴ ταῦτόν μὲν τοῦτο, ἔτι δὲ μᾶλλον ἢ τόθ'

YS: In that case, we should do as you say.

ST: Then let's divide it at its limbs, like a sacrificial animal. And since we are unable to make a division into two, it is necessary always to cut it into a number that is as close to two as possible.

YS: But how should we do so in this case?

ST: Just as we did before, when we designated all the skills that provide tools related to weaving as contributory causes.

YS: Yes.

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ST: And now we should do the same thing, but more extensively than before. Indeed, whatever skills produce any significant or insignificant tools for the city should all be designated as contributory causes, for, without these, neither city nor statesmanship would ever come into existence. Yet, on the other hand, I presume we shall not designate any of these as belonging to the work of the skill of kingship.

ἡμῖν ποιητέον. ὅσαι γὰρ σμικρὸν ἢ μέγα τι δημιουργοῦσι κατὰ πόλιν ὄργανον, θετέον ἀπάσας ταύτας ὡς οὔσας συναιτίους. ἄνευ γὰρ τούτων οὐκ ἂν ποτε γένοιτο πόλις οὐδὲ πολιτική, τούτων δ' αὖ βασιλικῆς ἔργον τέχνης οὐδέν που θήσομεν. NE. ΣΩ. οὐ γάρ. ΞΕ. καὶ μὲν δὴ χαλεπὸν ἐπιχειροῦμεν δρᾶν ἀποχωρίζοντες τοῦτο ἀπὸ τῶν ἄλλων τὸ γένος· ὅτι γὰρ οὖν τῶν ὄντων ἔστιν ὡς ἐνός γέ τινος ὄργανον εἰπόντα δοκεῖν εἰρηκέναι

YS: No, indeed.

ST: And, indeed, we are undertaking a difficult task in separating this class from the others. For it is possible for someone to maintain that anything whatsoever is an instrument of something or other, and seem to be making a persuasive case. Nevertheless, we should mention a particular one of the city's possessions that is different.

YS: In what sense?

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ST: Insofar as it does not possess this ability to act as an instrument. For it is not constructed to act as a cause of some production, as is the case with an instrument, but constructed in order to preserve what has been produced.

τι πιθανόν. ὅμως δὲ ἕτερον αὖ τῶν ἐν πόλει κτημάτων εἴπωμεν τόδε. NE. ΣΩ. τὸ ποῖον; ΞΕ. ὡς οὐκ ἔστι ταύτην τὴν δύναμιν ἔχον. οὐ γὰρ ἐπὶ

γενέσεως αἰτία πῆγνυται, καθάπερ ὄργανον, ἀλλ' ἔνεκα τοῦ δημιουργηθέντος σωτηρίας. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. τὸ ποῖον; ΞΕ. τοῦτο ὃ δὴ ξηροῖς καὶ ὑγροῖς καὶ ἐμπύροις καὶ ἀπύροις παντοδαπὸν εἶδος ἐργασθὲν ἀγγεῖον ὃ δὴ μιᾷ κλήσει προσφθεγγόμεθα, καὶ μάλα γε συχνὸν εἶδος καὶ τῇ ζητουμένη

YS: What sort of thing is this?

ST: Well, this is a variegated object, wrought for dry goods, for liquids, for use on the fire and for general use. We call it by a single name, 'vessel', and this very commonplace object does not, in my view, belong at all to the knowledge we are looking for anyway.

YS: No, how could it?

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ST: Well, we should also take note of a third extensive object, different from these possessions of the city. It goes by land and by water, it wanders a lot and does not wander, it is worthy of reverence and unworthy of reverence. And yet it bears a single name, because all are intended for sitting upon, and always act as a seat for someone.

γε, ὡς οἶμαι, προσῆκον οὐδὲν ἀτεχνῶς ἐπιστήμη. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΞΕ. τούτων δὴ τρίτον ἕτερον εἶδος κτημάτων πάμπολυ κατοπτέον πεζὸν καὶ ἔνυδρον καὶ πολυπλανὲς καὶ ἀπλανὲς καὶ τίμιον καὶ ἄτιμον, ἐν δὲ ὄνομα ἔχον, διότι πᾶν ἔνεκά τινος ἐφέδρας ἐστί, θᾶκος αἰετίνι γιγνόμενον. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. τὸ ποῖον; ΞΕ. ὄχημα αὐτό που λέγομεν, οὐ πάνυ πολιτικῆς ἔργον, ἀλλὰ μᾶλλον πολὺ τεκτονικῆς καὶ κεραμικῆς καὶ χαλκοτυπικῆς. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. μανθάνω.

YS: What is it?

ST: I presume we call it a carriage, so it is not really the work of statesmanship, but much more of carpentry, pottery-making and bronze-working.

YS: I understand.

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ST: What about a fourth? Should we say that there is something different from those three, one that includes most of what we mentioned some time ago – all sorts of clothing, most armaments, walls, and all enclosures whether of earth or of stone, and myriads of others? Since all these are produced for defensive purposes, it would be most appropriate to refer to them as a whole as a barrier, and to regard this more correctly as belonging much more to the work of the builder's skill or to weaving, for the most part, rather than statesmanship.

ΞΕ. τί δὲ τέταρτον; ἄρ' ἕτερον εἶναι τούτων λεκτέον, ἐν ᾧ τὰ πλεῖστά ἐστι τῶν πάλαι ῥηθέντων, ἐσθῆς τε σύμπασα καὶ τῶν ὅπλων τὸ πολὺ καὶ τεῖχη πάντα θ' ὅσα γῆινα περιβλήματα καὶ λίθινα, καὶ μυρία ἕτερα; προβολῆς δὲ ἔνεκα συμπάντων αὐτῶν εἰργασμένων δικαιοτάτ' ἂν ὅλον προσαγορεύοιτο πρόβλημα, καὶ πολλῶ μᾶλλον τέχνης οἰκοδομικῆς ἔργον καὶ ὑφαντικῆς τὸ πλεῖστον νομίζοιτ' ἂν ὀρθότερον ἢ πολιτικῆς.
NE. ΣΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν.

YS: Yes, certainly.

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ST: And as a fifth, would we like to suggest adornment and painting and whatever imitations are effected through their use, and through music, which having been produced solely for our pleasure are quite rightly captured by a single name?

ΞΕ. πέμπτον δὲ ἄρ' ἂν ἐθέλοιμεν τὸ περὶ τὸν κόσμον καὶ γραφικὴν θεῖναι καὶ ὅσα ταύτῃ προσχρώμενα καὶ μουσικῇ μιμήματα τελεῖται, πρὸς τὰς ἡδονὰς μόνον ἡμῶν ἀπειργασμένα, δικαίως δ' ἂν ὀνόματι περιληφθέντα ἐνί; NE. ΣΩ. ποίω; ΞΕ. παίγνιον πού τι λέγεται. NE. ΣΩ. τί μῆν; ΞΕ. τοῦτο τοῖνυν τούτοις ἐν ὄνομα ἅπασι πρέψει προσαγορευθέν· οὐ γὰρ σπουδῆς οὐδὲν αὐτῶν χάριν, ἀλλὰ παιδιᾶς ἔνεκα πάντα δρᾶται.

YS: What is it?

ST: We do use the term 'plaything', I presume.

YS: Of course.

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ST: Well, it will be appropriate to assign this one name to them all, for none of them has any serious purpose. Rather, they are all done for the sake of amusement.

NE. ΣΩ. καὶ τοῦτο σχεδόν τι μανθάνω. ΞΕ. τὸ δὲ πᾶσιν τούτοις σώματα παρέχον, ἐξ ὧν καὶ ἐν οἷς δημιουργοῦσιν ὁπόσαι τῶν τεχνῶν νῦν εἴρηται, παντοδαπὸν εἶδος πολλῶν ἐτέρων τεχνῶν ἔκγονον ὄν, ἃρ' οὐχ ἔκτον θήσομεν; NE. ΣΩ. τὸ ποῖον δὴ λέγεις; ΞΕ. χρυσὸν τε καὶ ἄργυρον καὶ πάνθ' ὁπόσα μεταλλεύεται καὶ ὅσα δρυοτομικὴ καὶ κουρὰ σύμπασα τέμνουσα παρέχει τεκτονικῇ καὶ πλεκτικῇ καὶ ἔτι φλοιιστικῇ φυτῶν

YS: That too is something I understand fairly well.

ST: And that which provides all these with the materials from which, and in which, any of the skills mentioned just now do their work – a variegated sort that owes its origin to many different skills – shall we designate this as a sixth?

YS: What sort of thing are you referring to?

288e

ST: Gold and silver and anything whatsoever that is mined; and whatever all felling and lopping of trees provides to carpentry and basket-weaving, through the cutting process; and again, the stripping of bark from trees; and leather-working which strips the skins from the bodies of ensouled creatures, and any skills related thereto; and the ability to produce cork and papyrus and ropes. All these enable the manufacture of compounded forms from classes that are not compounded. Let's refer to it all as one, the primeval acquisition of humanity, uncompounded too, and in no way the work of kingly knowledge.

τε καὶ ἐμψύχων δέρματα σωμάτων περαιοῦσα σκυτοτομική, καὶ ὅσαι περὶ τὰ τοιαῦτά εἰσιν τέχναι, καὶ φελλῶν καὶ βύβλων καὶ δεσμῶν ἐργαστικάι παρέσχον δημιουργεῖν σύνθετα ἐκ μὴ συντιθεμένων εἶδη γενῶν. Ἐν δὲ αὐτὸ προσαγορεύομεν πᾶν τὸ πρωτογενὲς ἀνθρώποις

κτῆμα καὶ ἀσύνθετον καὶ βασιλικῆς ἐπιστήμης οὐδαμῶς ἔργον ὄν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. καλῶς. ΞΕ. τὴν δὴ τῆς τροφῆς κτήσιν, καὶ ὅσα εἰς τὸ σῶμα συγκαταμειγνύμενα ἑαυτῶν μέρεσι μέρη σώματος εἰς τὸ

Ys: Very well.

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ST: Then the acquisition of nutriment and whatever mixes into the body, and mixing parts of itself with parts of the body has some power to promote its health, should be called the seventh. And we should give the name 'nurture' to the totality, if we don't have anything better to suggest. And if we place it entirely under farming, hunting, gymnastic, medicine and cookery rather than statesmanship, we shall be allocating it more correctly.

θεραπεῦσαί τινα δύνανται εἰληχε, λεκτέον ἑβδομον ὀνομάσαντας αὐτὸ σύμπαν ἡμῶν εἶναι τροφόν, εἰ μή τι κάλλιον ἔχομεν ἄλλο θέσθαι γεωργικῇ δὲ καὶ θηρευτικῇ καὶ γυμναστικῇ καὶ ἰατρικῇ καὶ μαγειρικῇ πᾶν ὑποτιθέντες ὀρθότερον ἀποδώσομεν ἢ τῇ πολιτικῇ. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΞΕ. σχεδὸν τοίνυν ὅσα ἔχεται κτήσεως, πλὴν τῶν ἡμέρων ζώων, ἐν τούτοις ἑπτὰ οἶμαι γένεσιν εἰρησθαι. σκόπει δέ· ἦν γὰρ δικαιοτάτα μὲν ἂν τεθὲν κατ' ἀρχὰς τὸ

Ys: Of course.

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ST: Well, I think anything pertaining to acquisition, except that of tame animals, has been quite well described under these seven classes. Let's review them. Indeed, it would be most appropriate to place the primeval form at the beginning, after this 'instrument', 'vessel', 'carriage', 'barrier', 'plaything' and 'nourishment'. But if we have omitted anything it can be included in one of these, provided it is something insignificant that has been overlooked, such as the class made up of currency, seals and stamps of all sorts. For these in themselves do not constitute a significant common class. But if some are dragged into the category of adornments, others into that of instruments, they will, despite the force, be entirely concordant

therewith. Then everything concerned with the acquisition of tame animals, with the exception of slaves, turns out to have been encompassed by the herd-nurturing skill that we divided into parts earlier.

πρωτογενές εἶδος, μετὰ δὲ τοῦτο ὄργανον, ἀγγεῖον, ὄχημα, πρόβλημα, παίγνιον, θρέμμα. ἃ παραλείπομεν δέ, εἴ τι μὴ μέγα λέληθεν, εἷς τι τούτων δυνατόν ἀρμόττειν, οἷον ἢ τοῦ νομίσματος ἰδέα καὶ σφραγίδων καὶ παντὸς χαρακτῆρος. γένος τε γὰρ ἐν αὐτοῖς ταῦτα οὐδὲν ἔχει μέγα σύννομον, ἀλλὰ τὰ μὲν εἰς κόσμον, τὰ δὲ εἰς ὄργανα βίᾳ μὲν, ὅμως δὲ πάντως ἐλκόμενα συμφωνήσει. τὰ δὲ περὶ ζώων κτῆσιν τῶν ἡμέρων, πλὴν δούλων, ἢ

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YS: Entirely so.

πρότερον ἀγγελαιοτροφικὴ διαμερισθεῖσα πάντ' εἰληφυῖα ἀναφανεῖται. NE. ΣΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. τὸ δὲ δὴ δούλων καὶ πάντων ὑπηρετῶν λοιπόν, ἐν οἷς που καὶ μαντεύομαι τοὺς περὶ αὐτὸ τὸ πλέγμα ἀμφισβητοῦντας τῷ βασιλεῖ καταφανεῖς γενήσεσθαι, καθάπερ τοῖς ὑφάνταις τότε τοὺς περὶ τὸ νήθην τε καὶ ξαίνειν καὶ ὅσα ἄλλα εἵπομεν. οἱ δὲ ἄλλοι πάντες, ὥς συναίτιοι λεχθέντες, ἅμα τοῖς ἔργοις τοῖς νυνδὴ ῥηθεῖσιν ἀνήλγωνται καὶ ἀπεχωρίσθησαν

ST: What remains are all slaves and underlings, among whom, I somehow anticipate, those who dispute with the king over the woven web itself will become evident, just as earlier those concerned with spinning and carding, and all the others we mentioned, disputed with the weavers. But all the others, the contributory causes as we called them, have been disposed of along with the works we listed just now, and they have been separated off from the activity of kingship and statesmanship.

289d

YS: So they seem, anyway.

ἀπὸ βασιλικῆς τε καὶ πολιτικῆς πράξεως. NE. ΣΩ. εἰκόασι γοῦν. ΞΕ. ἴθι δὴ σκεψώμεθα τοὺς λοιποὺς προσελθόντες ἐγγύθεν, ἵνα αὐτοὺς

εἰδῶμεν βεβαιότερον. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν χρή. ΞΕ. τοὺς μὲν δὴ μεγίστους ὑπηρετάς, ὡς ἐνθένδε ἰδεῖν, τούναντίον ἔχοντας εὐρίσκομεν οἷς ὑπωπτεύσαμεν ἐπιτήδευμα καὶ πάθος. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. τίνας; ΞΕ. τοὺς ὠνητούς τε καὶ τῷ τρόπῳ τούτῳ κτητούς· οὕς

ST: Come on, let's consider those who remain by getting closer to them, so that we may recognise them with more certainty.

YS: That's what's needed.

ST: Then, from this perspective, we shall find the greatest servants possessing the opposite habit and character to those we anticipated.

289e

YS: Who are they?

ἀναμφισβητήτως δούλους ἔχομεν εἰπεῖν; ἥκιστα βασιλικῆς μεταποιουμένους τέχνης. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. πῶς δ' οὐ; ΞΕ. τί δέ; τῶν ἐλευθέρων ὅσοι τοῖς νυνδὴ ῥηθεῖσιν εἰς ὑπηρετικὴν ἐκόντες αὐτοὺς τάττουσι, τὰ τε γεωργίας καὶ τὰ τῶν ἄλλων τεχνῶν ἔργα διακομίζοντες ἐπ' ἀλλήλους καὶ ἀνισοῦντες, οἱ μὲν κατ' ἀγοράς, οἱ δὲ πόλιν ἐκ πόλεως ἀλλάττοντες κατὰ θάλατταν καὶ πεζῇ, νόμισμά τε πρὸς τὰ ἄλλα καὶ αὐτὸ πρὸς αὐτὸ διαμείβοντες, οὕς ἀργυραμοιβούς τε

ST: Those who are bought, and constitute acquisitions in this sense, whom we may indisputably refer to as slaves, and who have the least pretensions to the kingly skill.

YS: Of course.

ST: But what about those who are free, but willingly assign themselves in servitude to the people we just mentioned by conveying the works of agriculture and the other skills to one another and distributing them out, some resorting to the marketplace, others travelling from city to city by sea and by land, exchanging money for goods and money for money, to whom we have given the name of money-changers, merchants, ship owners and retailers? Surely they will not lay any claim to statesmanship?

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YS: Except, perhaps, insofar as it relates to trading.

καὶ ἐμπόρους καὶ ναυκλήρους καὶ καπήλους ἐπωνομάκαμεν, μῶν τῆς πολιτικῆς ἀμφισβητήσουσί τι; NE. ΣΩ. τάχ' ἂν ἴσως τῆς γε τῶν ἐμπορευτικῶν. ΞΕ. ἀλλ' οὐ μὴν οὕς γε ὀρῶμεν μισθωτοὺς καὶ θήτας πᾶσιν ἐτοιμότατα ὑπηρετοῦντας, μή ποτε βασιλικῆς μεταποιουμένους εὖρωμεν. NE. ΣΩ. πῶς γάρ; ΞΕ. τί δὲ ἄρα τοὺς τὰ τοιάδε διακονοῦντας ἡμῖν ἐκάστοτε; NE. ΣΩ. τὰ ποῖα εἶπες καὶ τίνας;

ST: But surely those whom we see so readily serving anyone at all, as hired labourers for payment, would never be found laying claim to kingship.

YS: No, how could they?

ST: But what about those who provide services of a different sort?

YS: What services do you mean, and to whom are you referring?

290b

ST: The people involved in communications, and those who become wise in written matters through their constant service, and some others who are well able to work out numerous other issues relating to public offices. What shall we call these people?

ΞΕ. ὣν τὸ κηρυκικὸν ἔθνος, ὅσοι τε περὶ γράμματα σοφοὶ γίνονται πολλάκις ὑπηρετήσαντες, καὶ πόλλ' ἄττα ἕτερα περὶ τὰς ἀρχὰς διαπονεῖσθαι τινες ἕτεροι πάνδεινοι, τί τούτους αὖ λέξομεν; NE. ΣΩ. ὅπερ εἶπες νῦν, ὑπηρέτας, ἀλλ' οὐκ αὐτοὺς ἐν ταῖς πόλεσιν ἄρχοντας. ΞΕ. ἀλλὰ οὐ μὴν οἶμαί γε ἐνύπνιον ἰδὼν εἶπον ταύτην πη φανήσεσθαι τοὺς διαφερόντως ἀμφισβητοῦντας τῆς πολιτικῆς. καίτοι σφόδρα γε ἄτοπον ἂν εἶναι δόξειε τὸ ζητεῖν

YS: Servants, as you explained just now. But they are not the people who rule in our cities.

ST: But I don't think, anyway, that I was in a dream when I said that those who assert the strongest claim to statesmanship would somehow

make their appearance in this. And yet, it does seem most unusual to look for them in some subdivision of servitude.

YS: Quite so.

290c

ST: Then let's get into closer contact with those who have not yet been scrutinised. There are people who possess a portion of some serviceable knowledge of prophecy. Indeed, they are somehow regarded as interpreting from the gods to humanity.

τούτους ἐν ὑπηρετικῇ μοίρᾳ τινί. NE. ΣΩ. κομιδῇ μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. ἔτι δὴ προσμείζωμεν ἐγγύτερον ἐπὶ τοὺς μήπω βεβασανισμένους. εἰσὶ δὲ οἵ τε περὶ μαντικὴν ἔχοντές τινος ἐπιστήμης διακόνου μόριον· ἐρμηνευταὶ γάρ που νομίζονται παρὰ θεῶν ἀνθρώποις. NE. ΣΩ. ναί. ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν καὶ τὸ τῶν ἱερέων αὐτὸ γένος, ὡς τὸ νόμιμόν φησι, παρὰ μὲν ἡμῶν δωρεὰς θεοῖς διὰ θυσιῶν ἐπιστήμόν

YS: Yes.

ST: And there is also the class of priests, which, according to tradition, is knowledgeable in bestowing gifts from us upon the gods through sacrifices that are acceptable to them, and also in requesting from them the acquisition of good things for us through prayers. But both of these are part of a servile skill.

290d

YS: So it appears anyway.

ἐστὶ κατὰ νοῦν ἐκείνοις δωρεῖσθαι, παρὰ δὲ ἐκείνων ἡμῖν εὐχαῖς κτῆσιν ἀγαθῶν αἰτήσασθαι· ταῦτα δὲ διακόνου τέχνης ἐστὶ που μόρια ἀμρότερα. NE. ΣΩ. φαίνεται γοῦν. ΞΕ. ἤδη τοίνυν μοι δοκοῦμεν οἷόν γε τινος ἵχνους ἐφ' ὃ πορευόμεθα προσάπτεσθαι. τὸ γὰρ δὴ τῶν ἱερέων σχῆμα καὶ τὸ τῶν μάντεων εὖ μάλα φρονήματος πληροῦται καὶ δόξαν σεμνὴν λαμβάνει διὰ τὸ μέγεθος τῶν ἐγχειρημάτων, ὥστε περὶ μὲν Αἴγυπτον οὐδ' ἔξεστι βασιλέα χωρὶς ἱερατικῆς ἄρχειν, ἀλλ' ἐὰν ἄρα καὶ τύχη πρότερον ἐξ ἄλλου γένους βιασάμενος, ὕστερον ἀναγκαῖον εἰς τοῦτο εἰστέλεισθαι αὐτὸν τὸ γένος· ἔτι δὲ καὶ τῶν Ἑλλήνων πολλαχοῦ

ταῖς μεγίσταις ἀρχαῖς τὰ μέγιστα τῶν περὶ τὰ τοιαῦτα θύματα εὗροι τις ἂν προσταττόμενα θύειν. καὶ δὴ καὶ παρ' ὑμῖν οὐχ ἥκιστα δῆλον ὃ λέγω· τῷ γὰρ λαχόντι βασιλεῖ φασιν τῇδε τὰ σεμνότατα καὶ μάλιστα πάτρια τῶν ἀρχαίων θυσιῶν ἀποδεδόσθαι. NE. ΣΩ. καὶ πάνυ γε.

ST: Well, at this stage we seem to me to have encountered a sort of footprint of the person we are pursuing. For the personage associated with priests and prophets is well stocked with exalted notions, and acquires a reputation for sanctity because of the importance of what he engages in, so that, in Egypt, the king is not permitted to rule without being a priest. And if even he attains the role in the first place by forcing his way in from some other class, it is still necessary for him to be initiated later on into the priestly class. And even among the Greeks, one would find that the performance of the most important sacrifices of this kind are assigned to the most important office holders. And, indeed, what I am saying is no less evident among yourselves here, for it is said that the performance of the most solemn and most traditional of the ancient sacrifices is allocated to the king,¹³ whom you choose by lot.

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YS: Entirely so.

ΞΕ. τούτους τε τοίνυν τοὺς κληρωτοὺς βασιλέας ἅμα καὶ ἱερέας, καὶ ὑπηρέτας αὐτῶν καὶ τινα ἕτερον ἀμπολυν ὄχλον σκεπτέον, ὃς ἄρτι κατάδηλος νῦν ἡμῖν γέγονεν ἀποχωρισθέντων τῶν ἔμπροσθεν. NE. ΣΩ. τίνας δ' αὐτοὺς καὶ λέγεις; ΞΕ. καὶ μάλα τινὰς ἀτόπους. NE. ΣΩ. τί δὴ; ΞΕ. πάμφυλόν τι γένος αὐτῶν, ὥς γε ἄρτι σκοπούμεν φαίνεται. πολλοὶ μὲν γὰρ λέουσι τῶν ἀνδρῶν εἷζας καὶ Κενταύροις

ST: Then we should investigate these kings chosen by lot, who are also priests, and their servants, and another extensive crowd of people who have become evident to us, now that the previous candidates have been set aside.

YS: What people are you referring to?

ST: Some very unusual people indeed.

YS: Why so?

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ST: They appear, as I now see it, to belong to an extremely varied class. For many of these men resemble lions, centaurs and other such creatures; very many more are like satyrs, and those weak creatures that adopt many guises, and they rapidly assume each other's characteristics and ability. And, indeed, Socrates, I think I have just appreciated who these men are.

καὶ τοιούτοισιν ἑτέροις, πάμπολλοι δὲ Σατύροις καὶ τοῖς ἀσθενέσι καὶ πολυτρόποις θηρίοις· ταχὺ δὲ μεταλλάττουσι τὰς τε ιδέας καὶ τὴν δύναμιν εἰς ἀλλήλους. καὶ μέντοι μοι νῦν, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἄρτι δοκῶ κατανενοηκέναι τοὺς ἄνδρας. NE. ΣΩ. λέγοις ἄν· ἔοικας γὰρ ἄτοπόν τι καθορᾶν. ΞΕ. ναί· τὸ γὰρ ἄτοπον ἐξ ἀγνοίας πᾶσι συμβαίνει. καὶ γὰρ δὴ καὶ νῦν αὐτὸς τοῦτ' ἔπαθον· ἐξαίφνης ἡμφεγνόησα

YS: Please tell us, for you seem to have discerned something unusual.

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ST: Yes, for in all cases the unusual is a consequence of ignorance. Indeed, I also experienced this myself just now. I was suddenly thrown into doubt when I beheld the chorus concerned with the affairs of our cities.

κατιδὼν τὸν περὶ τὰ τῶν πόλεων πράγματα χορόν. NE. ΣΩ. ποῖον; ΞΕ. τὸν πάντων τῶν σοφιστῶν μέγιστον γόητα καὶ ταύτης τῆς τέχνης ἐμπειρότατον· ὃν ἀπὸ τῶν ὄντως ὄντων πολιτικῶν καὶ βασιλικῶν καίπερ παγχάλεπον ὄντα ἀφαιρεῖν ἀφαιρετέον, εἰ μέλλομεν ἰδεῖν ἐναργῶς τὸ ζητούμενον. NE. ΣΩ. ἀλλὰ μὴν τοῦτό γε οὐκ ἀνετέον. ΞΕ. οὐκ οὐκ δὴ κατὰ γε τὴν ἐμήν. καί μοι φράζε τόδε. NE. ΣΩ. τὸ ποῖον;

YS: What did you see?

ST: The greatest beguiler among all the sophists and the person most experienced in this skill – someone who, despite the extreme difficulty

of doing so, must be separated from those who really are statesmen and kings, if we are going to catch clear sight of what we are looking for.

YS: Then we really must not relent in this.

ST: Certainly not. Not in my view, anyway. So tell me this.

YS: What?

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ST: Isn't monarchy, for us, one of the modes of civic rule?

ΞΕ. ἄρ' οὐ μοναρχία τῶν πολιτικῶν ἡμῖν ἀρχῶν ἐστὶ μία; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ναί.
 ΞΕ. καὶ μετὰ μοναρχίαν εἴποι τις ἂν οἶμαι τὴν ὑπὸ τῶν ὀλίγων
 δυναστείαν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. πῶς δ' οὐ; ΞΕ. τρίτον δὲ σχῆμα πολιτείας οὐχ ἡ τοῦ
 πλήθους ἀρχή, δημοκρατία τοῦνομα κληθεῖσα; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. καὶ πάνυ γε. ΞΕ.
 τρεῖς δ' οὔσαι μὲν οὐ πέντε τρόπον τινὰ γίνονται, δὴ ἑξ ἑαυτῶν ἄλλα
 πρὸς αὐταῖς ὀνόματα τίκτουσαι; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ποῖα δὴ;

YS: Yes.

ST: I think someone might propose that the exercise of power by a few people comes after monarchy.

YS: Of course.

ST: And isn't the third form of constitution the rule of the multitude, referred to by the name 'democracy'?

YS: Entirely so.

ST: And being three, don't they in some sense become five, engendering two other names from themselves in addition to their own?

YS: What are they?

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ST: Nowadays, people focus upon the degree of compulsion and willingness, poverty and wealth, law and lawlessness arising in these. And dividing each of them into two, they refer to monarchy by two

names on the basis that it constitutes two forms, the tyrannical and the kingly.

ΞΕ. πρὸς τὸ βίαιόν που καὶ ἐκούσιον ἀποσκοποῦντες νῦν καὶ πενίαν καὶ πλοῦτον καὶ νόμον καὶ ἀνομίαν ἐν αὐταῖς γιγνόμενα διπλὴν ἐκατέραν τοῖν δυοῖν διαιροῦντες μοναρχίαν μὲν προσαγορεύουσιν ὡς δύο παρεχομένην εἶδη δυοῖν ὀνόμασι, τυραννίδι, τὸ δὲ βασιλικῇ. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. τί μήν; ΞΕ. τὴν δὲ ὑπ' ὀλίγων γε ἐκάστοτε κρατηθεῖσαν πόλιν ἀριστοκρατίᾳ καὶ ὀλιγαρχίᾳ. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. καὶ πάννυ γε. ΞΕ. δημοκρατίας γε μήν, ἐάντ' οὖν βιαίως ἐάντε ἐκουσίως

YS: Of course.

ST: And whenever the city is under the power of the few, it is called aristocratic or oligarchic.

YS: Entirely so.

ST: And yet, in the case of democracy, whether the multitude rules over the possessors of wealth by force or with their consent, or whether they pay close attention to the laws or not, it is not the usual practice for anyone to change its name.

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YS: True.

τῶν τὰς οὐσίας ἔχόντων τὸ πλῆθος ἄρχῃ, καὶ ἐάντε τοὺς νόμους ἀκριβῶς φυλάττον ἐάντε μή, πάντως τοῦνομα οὐδεὶς αὐτῆς εἴωθε μεταλλάττειν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ἀληθῆ. ΞΕ. τί οὖν; οἴομεθά τινα τούτων τῶν πολιτειῶν ὀρθὴν εἶναι τούτοις τοῖς ὅροις ὀρισθεῖσαν, ἐνὶ καὶ ὀλίγοις καὶ πολλοῖς, καὶ πλούτῳ καὶ πενίᾳ, καὶ τῷ βιαίῳ καὶ ἐκουσίῳ, καὶ μετὰ γραμμάτων καὶ ἄνευ νόμων συμβαίνουσιν γίγνεσθαι; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. τί γὰρ δὴ καὶ κωλύει;

ST: What now? Do we think that any of these constitutions is the right one, when it is defined based on these distinctions between one, few and multitude, wealth and poverty, compulsion and willingness, and whether it happens to operate under written laws or without such laws?

YS: Is there any particular reason why not?

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ST: Well, consider it more clearly by following this argument.

ΞΕ. σκόπει δὴ σαφέστερον τῇδε ἐπόμενος. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. πῆ; ΞΕ. τῷ ῥηθέντι κατὰ πρῶτας πότερον ἐμμενοῦμεν ἢ διαφωνήσομεν; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. τῷ δὴ ποίῳ λέγεις; ΞΕ. τὴν βασιλικὴν ἀρχὴν τῶν ἐπιστημῶν εἶναί τινα ἔφαμεν, οἶμαι. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ναί. ΞΕ. καὶ τούτων γε οὐχ ἀπασῶν, ἀλλὰ κριτικὴν δήπου τινὰ καὶ ἐπιστατικὴν ἐκ τῶν ἄλλων προειλόμεθα. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ναί. ΞΕ. καὶ τῆς ἐπιστατικῆς τὴν μὲν ἐπ' ἀψύχοις ἔργοις,

YS: Which?

ST: Shall we stand by what we said at the outset or shall we dispute it?

YS: What are you referring to?

ST: We said, I believe, that kingly rule is one of the branches of knowledge.

YS: Yes.

ST: And it did not belong to all of them. Rather, we preferred one that was judged and one that was directive over the others.

YS: Yes.

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ST: And from the directive category we selected one that applied to inanimate products, and another that applied to living beings. And so, making divisions in this manner, we have been continually approaching this point where, without losing sight of knowledge, we are as yet unable to adequately describe precisely what the knowledge is.

τὴν δ' ἐπὶ ζώοις· καὶ κατὰ τοῦτον δὴ τὸν τρόπον μερίζοντες δεῦρ' αἰὲν προελθούμεν, ἐπιστήμης οὐκ ἐπιλανθάνομενοι, τὸ δ' ἥτις οὐχ ἱκανῶς πῶς δυνάμενοι διακριβώσασθαι. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. λέγεις ὁρθῶς. ΞΕ. τοῦτ' αὐτὸ τοίνυν ἄρ' ἐννοοῦμεν, ὅτι τὸν ὅρον οὐκ ὀλίγους οὐδὲ πολλούς, οὐδὲ τὸ ἐκούσιον οὐδὲ τὸ ἀκούσιον, οὐδὲ πενίαν οὐδὲ πλοῦτον γίγνεσθαι περὶ

αὐτῶν χρεών, ἀλλά τινα ἐπιστήμην, εἴπερ ἀκολουθήσομεν τοῖς πρόθεεν;

YS: What you are saying is correct.

ST: So, do we appreciate this particular point, that the definition of these constitutions involves neither few nor many, willingness nor unwillingness, neither poverty nor wealth? Rather, if we are to be guided by our previous discussion, it involves some type of knowledge.

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YS: But of course. It is impossible to conclude otherwise.

NE. ΣΩ. ἀλλὰ μὴν τοῦτό γε ἀδύνατον μὴ ποιεῖν. ΞΕ. ἐξ ἀνάγκης δὴ νῦν τοῦτο οὕτω σκεπτέον, ἐν τίνι ποτὲ τούτων ἐπιστήμη συμβαίνει γίγνεσθαι περὶ ἀνθρώπων ἀρχῆς, σχεδὸν τῆς χαλεπωτάτης καὶ μεγίστης κτήσασθαι. δεῖ γὰρ ἰδεῖν αὐτήν, ἵνα θεασώμεθα τίνας ἀφαιρετέον ἀπὸ τοῦ φρονίμου βασιλέως, οἱ προσποιῶνται μὲν εἶναι πολιτικοὶ καὶ πείθουσι πολλούς, εἰσὶ δὲ οὐδαμῶς. NE. ΣΩ. δεῖ γὰρ δὴ ποιεῖν τοῦτο, ὥς ὁ λόγος ἡμῖν προεῖρηκεν.

ST: Then, it is now necessary to consider this issue in this way. In which of these constitutions, if any, does it turn out that knowledge of the rule of humanity, perhaps the most important knowledge and the most difficult to acquire, arises? For we need to see this so that we may behold certain people who must be separated from the sagacious king, people who pretend to be statesmen and who persuade many others of this, but are not statesmen at all.

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YS: Yes, that's what must be done, since our argument has said so.

ΞΕ. μῶν οὖν δοκεῖ πλεῖστος γε ἐν πόλει ταύτην τὴν ἐπιστήμην δυνατόν εἶναι κτήσασθαι; NE. ΣΩ. καὶ πῶς; ΞΕ. ἀλλ' ἄρα ἐν χιλιάνδρῳ πόλει δυνατόν ἐκατόν τινας ἢ καὶ πεντήκοντα αὐτήν ἱκανῶς κτήσασθαι; NE. ΣΩ. ῥάσθη μεντὰν οὕτω γ' εἴη πασῶν τῶν τεχνῶν· ἴσμεν γὰρ ὅτι χιλίων ἀνδρῶν ἄκροι πεττευταὶ τοσοῦτοι πρὸς τοὺς ἐν τοῖς ἄλλοις Ἑλλήσιν

οὐκ ἂν γένοιτό ποτε, μή τι δὴ βασιλῆς γε. δεῖ γὰρ δὴ τὸν γε τὴν βασιλικὴν ἔχοντα ἐπιστήμην, ἂν τ' ἄρχῃ καὶ ἐὰν μή, κατὰ τὸν ἔμπροσθε

ST: Now, do you think that a large number of people in the city are able to acquire this knowledge?

YS: No, how could they?

ST: Well, in a city of a thousand men, could some hundred, or even fifty, acquire it in an adequate manner?

YS: On that basis anyway it would be the easiest skill of them all. Indeed, we know that among a thousand men you wouldn't even find that number of first-class draughts players, in relation to the other Greek cities, let alone kings. For based upon the previous argument, it is surely necessary for someone who possesses knowledge of kingship to be referred to as kingly anyway, whether he exercises rule or not.

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ST: You have remembered that very well. And following on from this, it is necessary, I believe, to look for right rule associated with one particular person, or two, or extremely few, whenever such rule arises.

λόγον ὅμως βασιλικὸν προσαγορεύεσθαι. ΞΕ. καλῶς ἀπεμνημόνευσας. ἐπόμενον δὲ οἶμαι τούτῳ τὴν μὲν ὀρθὴν ἀρχὴν περὶ ἓνα τινὰ καὶ δύο καὶ παντάπασιν ὀλίγους δεῖ ζητεῖν, ὅταν ὀρθὴ γίγνηται. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. τί μὴν; ΞΕ. τούτους δέ γε, ἐάντε ἐκόντων ἄντ' ἀκόντων ἄρχωσιν, ἐάντε κατὰ γράμματα ἐάντε ἄνευ γραμμάτων, καὶ ἐὰν πλουτοῦντες ἢ πενόμενοι, νομιστέον, ὥσπερ νῦν ἡγούμεθα, κατὰ τέχνην ἡντινοῦν ἀρχὴν ἄρχοντας. τοὺς ἱατροὺς δὲ οὐχ ἥκιστα νενομίκαμεν, ἐάντε ἐκόντας ἐάντε ἄκοντας ἡμᾶς ἰῶνται, τέμνοντες ἢ κἀόντες ἢ τινα ἄλλην ἀλγηδὸνα προσάπτοντες, καὶ ἐὰν κατὰ γράμματα ἢ χωρὶς γραμμάτων, καὶ ἐὰν πένητες ὄντες ἢ πλούσιοι, πάντως οὐδὲν ἥττον ἱατροὺς φαμεν, ὥσπερ ἂν ἐπιστατοῦντες τέχνῃ, καθαίροντες εἴτε ἄλλως ἰσχυαίνοντες εἴτε καὶ αὐξάνοντες, ἂν μόνον ἐπ' ἀγαθῷ τῷ τῶν σωμάτων, βελτίῳ ποιοῦντες ἐκ χειρόνων,

YS: Why, of course.

ST: Yes. But these people, whether they rule over consenting or unconsenting subjects, whether on the basis of written laws or without written laws, whether they themselves be wealthy or poor, must be regarded as exercising whatever rule they exercise on the basis of a skill according to our present view. And we do not regard physicians as less than physicians whether they cure us with our consent or without it, whether by cutting, burning or applying some other painful cure, whether they work from written guidelines or without them, whether they are poor or wealthy. In all these cases we declare that they are physicians nonetheless, as long as their directions are based upon a skill. This may involve purifying, or otherwise reducing, or even adding bulk to the body, but once these are directed to some good of our bodies, making them better when they were worse, the individual practitioners preserve the lives of the people they treat. On such a basis I believe, and on no other, shall we propose that this alone is the correct definition of the rule of medicine, and of any other rule whatsoever.

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YS: Exactly.

σώζωσιν οἱ θεραπεύοντες ἕκαστοι τὰ θεραπευόμενα· ταύτη θήσομεν, ὥς οἶμαι, καὶ οὐκ ἄλλη, τοῦτον ὅρον ὀρθὸν εἶναι μόνον ἰατρικῆς καὶ ἄλλης ἡστινοσοῦν ἀρχῆς. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. κομιδῇ μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. ἀναγκαῖον δὴ καὶ πολιτείων, ὥς ἔοικε, ταύτην ὀρθὴν διαφερόντως εἶναι καὶ μόνην πολιτείαν, ἐν ᾗ τις ἂν εὐρίσκοι τοὺς ἄρχοντας ἀληθῶς ἐπιστήμονας καὶ οὐ δοκοῦντας μόνον, ἐάντε κατὰ νόμους ἐάντε ἄνευ νόμων ἄρχωσι, καὶ ἐκόντων ἢ

ST: And it must also be the case with constitutions, or so it seems. The one that is pre-eminently correct and is, alone, a constitution is the one in which we would find that the rulers are truly knowledgeable and do not merely seem so, whether they rule based upon laws or in the absence of laws, with their subjects' consent or without it, and

whether they themselves be poor or wealthy. None of these should be taken into consideration as a correct criterion.

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YS: Very well.

ἀκόντων, καὶ πενόμενοι ἢ πλουτοῦντες, τούτων ὑπολογιστέον οὐδὲν οὐδαμῶς εἶναι κατ' οὐδεμίαν ὀρθότητα. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. καλῶς. ΞΕ. καὶ ἕαντε γε ἀποκτεινύντες τινὰς ἢ καὶ ἐκβάλλοντες καθαίρωσιν ἐπ' ἀγαθῷ τὴν πόλιν, εἴτε καὶ ἀποικίας οἷον σμήνη μελιττῶν ἐκπέμποντές ποι σμικροτέραν ποιῶσιν, ἢ τινὰς ἐπεισαγόμενοί ποθεν ἄλλους ἔξωθεν πολίτας ποιοῦντες αὐτὴν αὖξωσιν, ἕωσπερ ἂν ἐπιστήμη καὶ τῷ δικαίῳ προσχρῶμενοι σῶζοντες ἐκ χείρονος βελτίῳ ποιῶσι κατὰ δύναμιν,

ST: And whether they purify the city for its benefit by putting some people to death or casting them out, or even make it smaller by sending out colonies to somewhere like swarms of bees, or make it bigger by bringing others in from outside and granting them citizenship, as long as they have recourse to knowledge and to justice, preserve it from decline, and to the best of their ability make it better, we should declare that this constitution, in that situation and based upon such criteria, is the only correct one. Any others we mention should not be referred to as genuine, as they are not really constitutions. No, they are imitations of this one. Those that we call well-ordered have imitated it better, while the others have imitated it quite badly.

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YS: For the most part, stranger, that seems to have been a reasonable description. However, hearing it said that we should rule without laws presented a greater difficulty.

ταύτην τότε καὶ κατὰ τοὺς τοιούτους ὅρους ἡμῖν μόνην ὀρθὴν πολιτείαν εἶναι ῥητέον ὅσας δ' ἄλλας λέγομεν, οὐ γνησίας οὐδ' ὄντως οὐσας λεκτέον, ἀλλὰ μεμιμημένας ταύτην, ἃς μὲν ὡς εὐνόμους λέγομεν, ἐπὶ τὰ καλλίω, τὰς δὲ ἄλλας ἐπὶ τὰ αἰσχίονα μεμιμῆσθαι. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. τὰ μὲν ἄλλα, ὧ ξένη, μετρίως ἔοικεν εἰρηῆσθαι· τὸ δὲ καὶ ἄνευ νόμων

δεῖν ἄρχειν χαλεπώτερον ἀκούειν ἐρρήθη. ΞΕ. μικρόν γε ἔφθης με ἐρόμενος, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἔμελλον

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ST: You are a little ahead of me with your question, Socrates, for I was about to question you as to whether you would accept all this or had misgivings over some of what had been said. But it is now evident already that you will want us to discuss this issue of the rightness of exercising rule without laws.

γάρ σε διερωτήσῃ ταῦτα πότερον ἀποδέχῃ πάντα, ἢ τι καὶ δυσχεραίνεις τῶν λεχθέντων· νῦν δ' ἤδη φανερόν ὅτι τοῦτο βουλευσόμεθα τὸ περὶ τῆς τῶν ἄνευ νόμων ἀρχόντων ὀρθότητος διελθεῖν ἡμᾶς. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΞΕ. τρόπον τινὰ μέντοι δῆλον ὅτι τῆς βασιλικῆς ἐστὶν ἡ νομοθετικὴ τὸ δ' ἄριστον οὐ τοὺς νόμους ἐστὶν ἰσχύειν ἀλλ' ἄνδρα τὸν μετὰ φρονήσεως βασιλικόν. οἷσθ' ὅπη; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. πῇ δὴ λέγεις; ΞΕ. ὅτι νόμος οὐκ ἂν ποτε δύναιτο τὸ τε ἄριστον καὶ

YS: It is inevitable.

ST: Now, in a sense it is obvious that law-making belongs to kingship, yet the best course is not for the laws to prevail but for a man who is kingly and possesses wisdom to prevail. Do you know why that is?

YS: Please tell me. Why?

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ST: Because a law would never be able to encompass what is best and most just for everyone at the same time in precise terms, and then institute what is best. For the dissimilarities between people and their activities, and the fact that nothing in human affairs ever really comes to rest, prevents any skill whatsoever, in any situation, from proclaiming anything simple that is applicable under all circumstances and for all time. Presumably we are agreed about that?

τὸ δικαιοτάτον ἀκριβῶς πᾶσιν ἅμα περιλαβὼν τὸ βέλτιστον ἐπιτάττειν· αἱ γὰρ ἀνομοιότητες τῶν τε ἀνθρώπων καὶ τῶν πράξεων καὶ τὸ μηδέποτε μηδὲν ὡς ἔπος εἰπεῖν ἡσυχίαν ἄγειν τῶν ἀνθρωπίνων οὐδὲν

ἔωσιν ἀπλοῦν ἐν οὐδενὶ περὶ ἀπάντων καὶ ἐπὶ πάντα τὸν χρόνον ἀποφαίνεσθαι τέχνην οὐδ' ἡντινοῦν. ταῦτα δὴ συγχωροῦμέν που; NE. ΣΩ. τί μήν; ΞΕ. τὸν δέ γε νόμον ὁρῶμεν σχεδὸν ἐπ' αὐτὸ τοῦτο

Ys: Of course.

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ST: And yet we see the law striving to do just this, much like a stubborn, unlearned person, who allows no one to do anything at variance with his instruction, or to ask any question, even if something new and better occurs to someone at variance with the pronouncement he has instituted.

συντείνοντα, ὥσπερ τινὰ ἄνθρωπον αὐθάδη καὶ ἀμαθῆ καὶ μηδένα μηδὲν ἔωντα ποιεῖν παρὰ τὴν ἑαυτοῦ τάξιν, μηδ' ἐπερωτᾶν μηδένα, μηδ' ἂν τι νέον ἄρα τῷ συμβαίνει βέλτιον παρὰ τὸν λόγον ὃν αὐτὸς ἐπέταξεν. NE. ΣΩ. ἀληθῆ ποιεῖ γὰρ ἀτεχνῶς καθάπερ εἵρηκας νῦν ὁ νόμος ἡμῖν ἐκάστοις. ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν ἀδύνατον εὖ ἔχειν πρὸς τὰ μηδέποτε ἀπλᾶ τὸ διὰ παντὸς γιγνόμενον ἀπλοῦν; NE. ΣΩ. κινδυνεύει. ΞΕ. διὰ τί δὴ ποτ' οὖν ἀναγκαῖον νομοθετεῖν, ἐπειδήπερ

Ys: This is true. Indeed, the law actually behaves toward each and every one of us in the very manner you describe.

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ST: Isn't it impossible for something that is entirely simple to be adequately applied to situations that are never simple?

οὐκ ὀρθότατον ὁ νόμος; ἀνευρετέον τούτου τὴν αἰτίαν. NE. ΣΩ. τί μήν; ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν καὶ παρ' ὑμῖν εἰσὶ τινες οἷαι καὶ ἐν ἄλλαις πόλεσιν ἀθρόων ἀνθρώπων ἀσκήσεις, εἴτε πρὸς δρόμον εἴτε πρὸς ἄλλο τι, φιλονικίας ἕνεκα; NE. ΣΩ. καὶ πάνυ γε πολλά. ΞΕ. φέρε νῦν ἀναλάβωμεν πάλιν μνήμη τὰς τῶν τέχνης γυμναζόντων ἐπιτάξεις ἐν ταῖς τοιαύταις ἀρχαῖς. NE. ΣΩ. τὸ ποῖον; ΞΕ. ὅτι λεπτοurgerεῖν οὐκ ἐγχωρεῖν ἡγοῦνται καθ' ἕνα ἕκαστον, τῷ σώματι τὸ προσῆκον ἐκάστῳ προστάττοντες,

Ys: Quite likely.

ST: Then why ever is it necessary to make laws, when the law is never perfectly right? We must find out the reason for this.

YS: Of course.

ST: Don't you also have here, as they do in other cities, courses of instruction for groups of people, relating to the running track or something else, motivated by a desire to win?

YS: Very much so. There are a lot of them.

ST: Come now, let's once again recollect the instructions of the skilled trainers when they are in such positions of authority.

YS: What sort of instructions?

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ST: They don't believe it is possible to go into detail about each individual case, and prescribe what is appropriate to each particular body. Rather, they think it necessary to issue a rough guideline that is beneficial to bodies in general, and applies in most cases.

ἀλλὰ παχύτερον οἶονται δεῖν ὥς ἐπὶ τὸ πολὺ καὶ ἐπὶ πολλοὺς τὴν τοῦ λυσιτελοῦντος τοῖς σώμασι ποιεῖσθαι τάξιν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. καλῶς. ΞΕ. διὸ δὴ γε καὶ ἴσους πόνους νῦν διδόντες ἀθρώοις ἅμα μὲν ἐξορμῶσιν, ἅμα δὲ καὶ καταπαύουσι δρόμου καὶ πάλης καὶ πάντων τῶν κατὰ τὰ σώματα πόνων. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ἔστι ταῦτα. ΞΕ. καὶ τὸν νομοθέτην τοίνυν ἠγώμεθα, τὸν ταῖσιν ἀγέλαις ἐπιστατήσοντα τοῦ δικαίου πέρι καὶ τῶν πρὸς ἀλλήλους

YS: Good.

ST: Accordingly, they usually assign equal physical exertion to entire crowds, urging them all on at the same time and stopping them all at the same time, whether they are running or wrestling or undertaking any other physical exertions.

YS: That's what they do.

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ST: Then we should also presume that the lawmaker who directs this herd of ours in matters of justice, and their dealings with one another,

when giving orders to entire crowds of people, will never really be capable of giving every single person precisely what is appropriate.

συμβολαίων, μή ποθ' ἱκανὸν γενήσεσθαι πᾶσιν ἀθρώοις προστάττοντα ἀκριβῶς ἐνὶ ἐκάστω τὸ προσῆκον ἀποδιδόναι. NE. ΣΩ. τὸ γοῦν εἰκός. ΞΕ. ἀλλὰ τὸ τοῖς πολλοῖς γε οἶμαι καὶ ὥς ἐπὶ τὸ πολὺ καὶ πῶς οὕτωςι παχυτέρως ἐκάστοις τὸν νόμον θήσει, καὶ ἐν γράμμασιν ἀποδιδούς καὶ ἐν ἀγραμμάτοις, πατρίοις δὲ ἔθεσι νομοθετῶν. NE. ΣΩ. ὀρθῶς. ΞΕ. ὀρθῶς μέντοι. πῶς γὰρ ἂν τις ἱκανὸς γένοιτ' ἂν

YS: That sounds reasonable, anyway.

ST: Rather he will, I believe, set down a law for everyone anyway, and it will somehow, for the most part, be roughly appropriate to each individual. These he will issue in writing and in unwritten form, legislating by means of ancestral traditions.

YS: Correct.

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ST: Correct indeed, Socrates. For how could anyone ever arrange to sit beside each person, constantly, throughout their life, and instruct them precisely as to what is appropriate for them? In fact, if he were capable of doing this, it is hardly likely, in my view, that anyone who had actually acquired the knowledge of kingship would ever create obstacles for himself by writing down these laws we have referred to.

ποτε, ὃ Σώκρατες, ὥστε διὰ βίου αἰὶ παρακαθήμενος ἐκάστω δι' ἀκριβείας προστάττειν τὸ προσῆκον; ἐπεὶ τοῦτ' ἂν δυνατὸς ὢν, ὥς οἶμαι, τῶν τὴν βασιλικὴν ὁρῶντων ὄντως ἐπιστήμην εἰληφότων σχολῇ ποτ' ἂν ἑαυτῷ θεῖτ' ἐμποδίσματα γράφων τοὺς λεχθέντας τούτους νόμους. NE. ΣΩ. ἐκ τῶν νῦν γοῦν, ὃ ξένη, εἰρημένων. ΞΕ. μᾶλλον δέ γε, ὃ βέλτιστε, ἐκ τῶν μελλόντων ρηθήσεσθαι. NE. ΣΩ. τίνων δὲ; ΞΕ. τῶν τοιῶνδε. εἶπωμεν γὰρ δὴ πρὸς γε ἡμᾶς αὐτοὺς

YS: Yes, stranger, on the basis of what we are now saying, anyway.

ST: And even more so, best of men, on the basis of what we are about to say.

YS: On what basis is that?

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ST: On some such basis as this. Let's take the example of a physician, or even a gymnastic trainer, who intends to be abroad and away from those he is looking after for a considerable time, or so he believes. If he thought that the sick people, or those undergoing training, would not remember his instructions, he would want to write down some reminders for them. Is this so?

ιατρὸν μέλλοντα ἢ καὶ τινα γυμναστικὸν ἀποδημεῖν καὶ ἀπέσεσθαι τῶν θεραπευομένων συχνόν, ὥς οἴοιτο, χρόνον, μὴ μνημονεύσειν οἰηθέντα τὰ προσταχθέντα τοὺς γυμναζομένους ἢ τοὺς κάμνοντας, ὑπομνήματα γράφειν ἂν ἐθέλειν αὐτοῖς, ἢ πῶς; NE. ΣΩ. οὕτως. ΞΕ. τί δ' εἰ παρὰ δόξαν ἐλάττω χρόνον ἀποδημήσας ἔλθοι πάλιν; ἄρ' οὐκ ἂν παρ' ἐκεῖνα τὰ γράμματα τολμήσειεν ἄλλ' ὑποθέσθαι, συμβαινόντων ἄλλων βελτιόνων τοῖς κάμνουσι

S: Quite so.

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ST: And what if he were to come back again, having been abroad for less time than expected? Would he lack the courage to propose alternatives to those written instructions if others turned out to be better for the sick people, because winds or something else from Zeus had somehow arisen unexpectedly in an unusual manner? Would he be stubborn and think that we should not step outside the ancient edicts once they have been set down – either by proposing alternatives himself or by the patient daring to act contrary to the written directions – these being the principles of medicine and health, and whatever is done differently is unhealthy and is not based upon those skills? Or would everything of this sort, at least when it occurs in the case of knowledge and true skill in all subjects, render such ordinances completely and utterly ridiculous?

διὰ πνεύματα ἢ τι καὶ ἄλλο παρὰ τὴν ἐλπίδα τῶν ἐκ Διὸς ἐτέρως πως τῶν εἰωθότων γενόμενα, καρτερῶν δ' ἂν ἡγοῖτο δεῖν μὴ ἐκβαίνειν

τάρχαϊά ποτε νομοθετηθέντα μήτε αὐτὸν προστάττοντα ἄλλα μήτε τὸν κάμνοντα ἕτερα τολμῶντα παρὰ τὰ γραφέντα δρᾶν, ὥς ταῦτα ὄντα ἱατρικὰ καὶ ὑγιεινά, τὰ δὲ ἑτέρως γιγνόμενα νοσώδη τε καὶ οὐκ ἔντεχνα· ἢ πᾶν τὸ τοιοῦτον ἔν γε ἐπιστήμῃ συμβαῖνον καὶ

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YS: Entirely so.

ἀληθεῖ τέχνῃ περὶ ἅπαντα παντάπασι γέλως ἂν ὁ μέγιστος γίγνοιτο τῶν τοιούτων νομοθετημάτων; NE. ΣΩ. παντάπασι μὲν οὔν. ΞΕ. τῷ δὲ τὰ δίκαια δὴ καὶ ἄδικοι καὶ καλὰ καὶ αἰσχροὶ καὶ ἀγαθὰ καὶ κακὰ γράψαντι καὶ ἄγραφα νομοθετήσαντι ταῖς τῶν ἀνθρώπων ἀγέλαις, ὅπόσαι κατὰ πόλιν ἐν ἐκάσταις νομεύονται κατὰ τοὺς τῶν γραψάντων νόμους, ἂν ὁ μετὰ τέχνης γράψας ἢ τις ἕτερος ὅμοιος ἀφίκηται, μὴ ἐξέστω δὴ

ST: Consider the case of the person who has written laws, or framed unwritten laws, concerning just and unjust behaviour, noble and base practices, good and bad actions, intended for herds of human beings, who are herded in their particular cities based upon the laws of these writers. Is it really not permissible for different instructions, at variance with these, to be issued by the person who has the relevant skill and has written them down, or someone else like him who arrives on the scene? Or would this prohibition, in truth, appear every bit as ridiculous as the previous one?

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YS: Of course it would.

παρὰ ταῦτα ἕτερα προστάττειν; ἢ καὶ τοῦτο τὸ ἀπόρρημα οὐδὲν ἦττον ἂν ἐκείνου τῇ ἀληθείᾳ γελοῖον φαίνοιτο; NE. ΣΩ. τί μὴν; ΞΕ. οἷσθ' οὔν ἐπὶ τῷ τοιούτῳ λόγον τὸν παρὰ τῶν πολλῶν λεγόμενον; NE. ΣΩ. οὐκ ἐννοῶ νῦν γ' οὕτως. ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν εὐπρεπής. φασὶ γὰρ δὴ δεῖν, εἴ τις γιγνώσκει παρὰ τοὺς τῶν ἔμπροσθεν βελτίους νόμους, νομοθετεῖν τὴν ἑαυτοῦ πόλιν ἕκαστον πείσαντα, ἄλλως δὲ μή. NE. ΣΩ. τί οὔν; οὐκ ὀρθῶς;

ST: Now, do you know the argument that most people present in such a circumstance?

YS: Nothing relevant comes to mind at the moment.

ST: Well, it sounds plausible enough. For they declare that if someone realises that there are laws at variance with those of former generations, but better, he may institute his laws once he has persuaded his own city in each case, but not otherwise.

YS: What about that? Is it not the right way to proceed?

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ST: Perhaps, but what if someone were to enforce the better course without using persuasion? Tell me what the name of that enforcement will be. But no, not yet. Answer in relation to the previous example first.

ΞΕ. ἴσως. ἂν δ' οὖν μὴ πείθων τις βιάζεται τὸ βέλτιον, ἀπόκριναι, τί τοῦνομα τῆς βίας ἔσται; μὴ μέντοι πω, περὶ δὲ τῶν ἔμπροσθεν πρότερον. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ποῖον δὴ λέγεις; ΞΕ. ἂν τις ἄρα μὴ πείθων τὸν ἰατρευόμενον, ἔχων δὲ ὀρθῶς τὴν τέχνην, παρὰ τὰ γεγραμμένα τὸ βέλτιον ἀναγκάζῃ δρᾶν παῖδα ἢ τινα ἄνδρα ἢ καὶ γυναῖκα, τί τοῦνομα τῆς βίας ἔσται ταύτης; ἄρ' οὐ πᾶν μᾶλλον ἢ τὸ παρὰ τὴν τέχνην λεγόμενον ἀμάρτημα τὸ νοσῶδες; καὶ πάντα ὀρθῶς

YS: What are you referring to?

ST: Suppose some physician, in proper possession of the relevant skill but without persuading the patient, were to compel a man, or even a woman or child, to do what is better in contravention of the written precepts. What will be the name of this kind of force? Won't it be far removed from the error we described as 'contrary to the relevant skill' and unhealthy? And the person who suffered such force may justifiably say anything at all about what happened, but may never say that he has suffered unskilled and unhealthy treatment at the hands of the physicians who forced him.

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YS: What you say is perfectly true.

εἰπεῖν ἔστι πρότερον τῷ βιασθέντι περὶ τὸ τοιοῦτον πλὴν ὅτι νοσώδη καὶ ἄτεχνα πέπονθεν ὑπὸ τῶν βιασαμένων ἰατρῶν; NE. ΣΩ. ἀληθέστατα λέγεις. ΞΕ. τί δὲ ἡμῖν δὴ τὸ παρὰ τὴν πολιτικὴν τέχνην ἀμάρτημα λεγόμενόν ἐστιν; ἄρ' οὐ τὸ αἰσχρὸν καὶ τὸ κακὸν καὶ ἄδικον; NE. ΣΩ. παντάπασί γε. ΞΕ. τῶν δὴ βιασθέντων παρὰ τὰ γεγραμμένα καὶ πάτρια δρᾶν ἕτερα δικαιότερα καὶ ἀμείνω καὶ καλλίω τῶν ἔμπροσθεν,

ST: What, then, is the error that we refer to as being at variance with the skill of statesmanship? Isn't it baseness, evil and injustice?

YS: Entirely so.

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ST: Well, what about those who have been forced, contrary to written edicts and traditions, to perform other actions, more just, better and more noble than those prescribed of old? What, for his part, could a critic of such behaviour say about such use of force, if he is to avoid becoming utterly laughable? He may say anything at all, as the occasion demands, provided he never says that those who were forced to act in that way suffered baseness or evil or injustice at the hands of those who forced them.

φέρει, τὸν τῶν τοιούτων αὖ ψόγον περὶ τῆς τοιαύτης βίας, ἄρ', εἰ μέλλει μὴ καταγελαστότατος εἶναι πάντων, πάντ' αὐτῷ μᾶλλον λεκτέον ἐκάστοτε πλὴν ὡς αἰσχρὰ καὶ ἄδικα καὶ κακὰ πεπόνθασιν οἱ βιασθέντες ὑπὸ τῶν βιασαμένων; NE. ΣΩ. ἀληθέστατα λέγεις. ΞΕ. ἀλλ' ἄρα ἐὰν μὲν πλούσιος ὁ βιασάμενος ᾖ, δίκαια, ἂν δ' ἄρα πένης, ἄδικα τὰ βιασθέντα ἐστίν; ἢ καὶ πείσας καὶ μὴ πείσας τις, πλούσιος ἢ πένης, ἢ κατὰ γράμματα ἢ

YS: Very true.

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ST: But are the enforcements just if the person who exerts the force is wealthy, and are they unjust if he is poor? Or if the person, rich or poor, achieves something beneficial, either through persuasion or without persuasion, in conformity with the written laws or at variance with them, the truest definition of proper management of the

city in this respect must surely be this: the one that a wise and good man will employ to manage the affairs of his subjects. Just as a helmsman, being constantly vigilant for the welfare of the ship and its sailors, preserves his fellow sailors not by setting down written edicts, but by presenting his skill as law, so too, based upon the same approach as this, a constitution may become a proper one on account of those who are able to rule in this way, since through their skill they provide a force that is more powerful than the laws. And those who rule intelligently, no matter what they do, avoid error as long as they are vigilant of one major principle: that they always dispense perfect justice based upon reason and skill to the people of the city, and are able, as far as possible, to preserve them and make them better people than they were.

παρὰ γράμματα, δρᾷ μὴ σύμφορα ἢ σύμφορα, τοῦτον δεῖ καὶ περὶ ταῦτα τὸν ὅρον εἶναι τὸν γε ἀληθινώτατον ὀρθῆς πόλεως διοικήσεως, ὃν ὁ σοφὸς καὶ ἀγαθὸς ἀνὴρ διοικήσει τὸ τῶν ἀρχομένων; ΞΕ. ὥσπερ ὁ κυβερνήτης τὸ τῆς νεὼς καὶ ναυτῶν ἀεὶ συμφέρον παραφυλάττων, οὐ γράμματα τιθεὶς ἀλλὰ τὴν τέχνην νόμον παρεχόμενος, σώζει τοὺς συνναύτας, οὕτω καὶ κατὰ τὸν αὐτὸν τρόπον τοῦτον παρὰ τῶν οὕτως ἄρχειν δυναμένων ὀρθὴ γίγνοιτ' ἂν πολιτεία, τὴν τῆς τέχνης ῥώμην τῶν νόμων παρεχομένων κρείττω; καὶ πάντα ποιοῦσι τοῖς ἔμφορσιν ἄρχουσιν οὐκ ἔστιν ἀμάρτημα, μέχρι περ ἂν

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Ys: It is impossible to oppose what you have just said.

ἐν μέγα φυλάττωσι, τὸ μετὰ νοῦ καὶ τέχνης δικαιοτάτον ἀεὶ διανέμοντες τοῖς ἐν τῇ πόλει σώζειν τε αὐτοὺς οἰοί τε ὥσιν καὶ ἀμείνους ἐκ χειρόνων ἀποτελεῖν κατὰ τὸ δυνατόν; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. οὐκ ἔστ' ἀντειπεῖν παρά γε ἃ νῦν εἴρηται. ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν πρὸς ἐκεῖνα οὐδὲ ἀντιρρητέον. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. τὰ ποῖα εἶπες; ΞΕ. ὥς οὐκ ἂν ποτε πλῆθος οὐδ' ὠντινωνοῦν τὴν τοιαύτην λαβὸν ἐπιστήμην οἷόν τ' ἂν γένοιτο μετὰ νοῦ διοικεῖν

ST: Nor indeed should anyone contradict those other statements of ours.

YS: What are you referring to?

ST: That no large number of people of any sort would ever be able to acquire this kind of knowledge, and manage the city on the basis of reason. Rather it is in relation to something small, few, even the one, that we must seek for that single proper constitution, and we must designate the others as imitations thereof, and just as we stated a little earlier some imitate it quite well, others quite badly.

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YS: How am I to understand what you have said? In fact, I didn't really understand your earlier statement about imitations either.

πόλιν, ἀλλὰ περὶ σμικρόν τι καὶ ὀλίγον καὶ τὸ ἓν ἐστὶ ζητητέον τὴν μίαν ἐκείνην πολιτείαν τὴν ὀρθήν, τὰς δ' ἄλλας μιμήματα θετέον, ὥσπερ καὶ ὀλίγον πρότερον ἐρρήθη, τὰς μὲν ἐπὶ τὰ καλλίονα, τὰς δ' ἐπὶ τὰ αἰσχίω μιμουμένας ταύτην. NE. ΣΩ. πῶς τί τοῦτ' εἴρηκας; οὐδὲ γὰρ ἄρτι δῆθεν κατέμαθον τὸ περὶ τῶν μιμημάτων. ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν οὐ φαῦλόν γε, ἂν κινήσας τις τοῦτον τὸν λόγον αὐτοῦ καταβάλῃ καὶ μὴ διελθὼν ἐνδείξῃται τὸ νῦν

ST: And, indeed, it would be no trivial matter if someone, having initiated this line of argument, were then to set it aside, and not even develop it to demonstrate the error that is arising about this issue at the moment.

YS: What sort of error?

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ST: We need to look for the kind of thing that is not particularly familiar or easy to see, and we should endeavour to lay hold of it nevertheless. Come on, then. Consider this constitution we have described, the only correct one. You know that the other constitutions must have recourse to the written laws of this one, and be preserved in

this way by acting in a manner that is praised nowadays, even though it is not entirely correct to do so.

γινόμενον ἀμάρτημα περὶ αὐτό. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ποῖον δὴ; ΞΕ. τοιόνδε τι δεῖ γε ζητεῖν, οὐ πάνυ σύνηθες οὐδὲ ῥάδιον ἰδεῖν· ὅμως μὴν πειρώμεθα λαβεῖν αὐτό. φέρε γάρ· ὀρθῆς ἡμῖν μόνης οὔσης ταύτης τῆς πολιτείας ἦν εἰρήκαμεν, οἷσθ' ὅτι τὰς ἄλλας δεῖ τοῖς ταύτης συγγράμμασι χρωμένας οὕτω σφύζεσθαι, δρώσας τὸ νῦν ἐπαινούμενον, καίπερ οὐκ ὀρθότατον ὄν; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. τὸ ποῖον;

YS: What is it that is not entirely correct?

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ST: The notion that no one in the city should dare to do anything at variance with the laws, and whoever dares to do so should be punished by death and all sorts of extreme penalties. And yet this is entirely proper and appropriate as a second preference, whenever there is a departure from the first, the one we have described just now. So let's explain the manner in which this so-called second-best system has come into being, shall we?

ΞΕ. τὸ παρὰ τοὺς νόμους μηδὲν μηδένα τολμᾶν ποιεῖν τῶν ἐν τῇ πόλει, τὸν τολμῶντα δὲ θανάτῳ ζημιοῦσθαι καὶ πᾶσι τοῖς ἐσχάτοις. καὶ τοῦτ' ἔστιν ὀρθότατα καὶ κάλλιστ' ἔχον ὡς δεύτερον, ἐπειδὴν τὸ πρῶτόν τις μεταθῇ τὸ νυνδὴ ῥηθέν· ὧ δὲ τρόπῳ γεγονός ἐστι τοῦτο ὃ δὴ δεύτερον ἐφήσαμεν, διαπερανώμεθα. ἦ γάρ; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. εἰς δὴ τὰς εἰκόνας ἐπανίωμεν πάλιν, αἷς ἀναγκαῖον ἀπεικάζειν αἰεὶ τοὺς βασιλικοὺς ἄρχοντας. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ποίας; ΞΕ. τὸν γενναῖον κυβερνήτην καὶ τὸν ἐτέρων πολλῶν ἀντάξιον ἱατρόν. κατίδωμεν γὰρ δὴ τι σχῆμα ἐν τούτοις αὐτοῖς πλασάμενοι. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ποῖόν τι;

YS: Yes, certainly.

ST: Then let's revert once more to the images, to which it has frequently been necessary to compare the kingly rulers.

YS: What were they?

ST: The noble helmsman, and the physician who is worth as much as a thousand others. Yes, let's see if we can construct some outline based upon the people themselves.

YS: Of what sort?

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ST: As follows. Suppose we were all to form the notion that we are suffering outrageous treatment at the hands of these people, for they both, in like manner, preserve any of us whom they wish to preserve, and mistreat any whom they wish to mistreat. They do this by cutting us, burning us, and imposing charges to be paid to them, like a tax, out of which they spend a little or even nothing upon the patient, while they and their members make use of the rest. And what's more, they finally take money from relations, or some enemies of the patient, as payment, and then kill him. The helmsmen, for their part, perform countless other outrages of the same sort. They form conspiracies and abandon us on sea voyages, cause shipwrecks on the oceans and cast us into the sea, and perpetrate other misdeeds.

ΞΕ. τοιόνδε οἶον εἰ πάντες περὶ αὐτῶν διανοηθεῖμεν ὅτι δεινότατα ὑπ' αὐτῶν πάσχομεν. ὃν μὲν γὰρ ἂν ἐθελήσωσιν ἡμῶν τούτων ἑκάτεροι σῶζειν, ὁμοίως δὲ σῶζουσιν, ὃν δ' ἂν λωβᾶσθαι βουλευθῶσιν, λωβῶνται τέμνοντες καὶ κάοντες καὶ προστάττοντες ἀναλώματα φέρειν παρ' ἑαυτοὺς οἶον φόρους, ὧν σμικρὰ μὲν εἰς τὸν κάμνοντα καὶ οὐδὲν ἀναλίσκουσιν, τοῖς δ' ἄλλοις αὐτοί τε καὶ οἱ οἰκέται χρωῶνται· καὶ

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ST: Now, suppose, bearing these afflictions in mind, we were to decide upon a resolution in this regard, no longer to entrust autocratic rule to either of these two professions, neither over slaves nor over free men, a resolution to convene an assembly of ourselves, either of the entire populace or of the wealthy people alone, and to permit private citizens and the various professions to contribute an opinion on seafaring, and on disease, and on how we should employ drugs and medical instruments in relation to the treatment of the sick, and

indeed about the ships themselves, and the nautical equipment we should use on those ships in the face of dangers affecting the voyage itself, from wind and sea or also from encounters with pirates, or even perhaps in a sea battle that has to be fought in longboats against other vessels of that kind, a resolution according to which the opinions of the majority on these matters, whether the advisers be physicians, helmsmen or private citizens, once written down on wooden or stone tablets, or established as unwritten traditional practices, are to be the basis for navigating ships and for treating the sick, now and forever, for all time.

δὴ καὶ τελευτῶντες ἢ παρὰ συγγενῶν ἢ παρὰ τινῶν ἐχθρῶν τοῦ κάμνοντος χρήματα μισθὸν λαμβάνοντες ἀποκτεινύασιν. οἳ τ' αὖ κυβερνῆται μυρία ἕτερα τοιαῦτα ἐργάζονται, καταλείποντές τε ἕκ τινος ἐπιβουλῆς ἐν ταῖς ἀναγωγαῖς ἐρήμους, καὶ σφάλματα ποιοῦντες ἐν τοῖς πελάγεσιν ἐκβάλλουσιν εἰς τὴν θάλατταν, καὶ ἕτερα κακουργοῦσιν. εἰ δὴ ταῦτα διανοηθέντες βουλευσαίμεθα περὶ αὐτῶν βουλὴν τινα, τούτων τῶν τεχνῶν μηκέτι ἐπιτρέπειν ἄρχειν αὐτοκράτορι μηδετέρα μὴ' οὖν δούλων μὴ' ἐλευθέρων, συλλέξει δ' ἐκκλησίαν ἡμῶν αὐτῶν, ἢ σύμπαντα τὸν δῆμον ἢ τοὺς πλουσίους μόνον, ἐξεῖναι δὲ καὶ ἰδιωτῶν καὶ τῶν ἄλλων δημιουργῶν περὶ τε πλοῦ καὶ περὶ νόσων γνῶμην συμβαλέσθαι καθ' ὅτι χρή τοῖς φαρμάκοις ἡμᾶς καὶ τοῖς ἱατρικοῖς ὀργάνοις πρὸς τοὺς κάμνοντας χρῆσθαι, καὶ δὴ καὶ τοῖς πλοίοις τε αὐτοῖς καὶ τοῖς ναυτικοῖς ὀργάνοις εἰς τὴν τῶν πλοίων χρεῖαν καὶ περὶ τοὺς κινδύνους τοὺς τε πρὸς αὐτὸν τὸν πλοῦν ἀνέμων καὶ θαλάττης πέρι καὶ πρὸς τὰς τοῖς λησταῖς ἐντεύξεις, καὶ ἐὰν ναυμαχεῖν ἄρα δέη που μακροῖς πλοίοις πρὸς ἕτερα τοιαῦτα· τὰ δὲ τῷ πλήθει δόξαντα περὶ τούτων, εἴτε τινῶν ἱατρῶν καὶ κυβερνητῶν εἴτ' ἄλλων ἰδιωτῶν συμβουλευόντων, γράψαντας

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YS: You have described some very odd notions.

ἐν κύρβεσί τισι καὶ στήλαις, τὰ δὲ καὶ ἄγραφα πάτρια θεμένους ἔθῃ, κατὰ ταῦτα ἤδη πάντα τὸν ἔπειτα χρόνον ναυτίλλεσθαι καὶ τὰς τῶν

καμνόντων θεραπείας ποιῆσθαι. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. κομιδῇ γε εἴρηκας ἄτοπα. ΞΕ. κατ' ἐνιαυτὸν δέ γε ἄρχοντας καθίστασθαι τοῦ πλήθους, εἴτε ἐκ τῶν πλουσίων εἴτε ἐκ τοῦ δήμου παντός, ὃς ἂν κληρούμενος λαγχάνῃ τοὺς δὲ καταστάντας ἄρχοντας ἄρχειν κατὰ τὰ γράμματα κυβερνῶντας τὰς ναῦς καὶ τοὺς κάμνοντας ἰωμένους. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ταῦτ' ἔτι χαλεπώτερα. ΞΕ. θεῶ δὴ καὶ τὸ μετὰ ταῦτα ἐπόμενον. ἐπειδὴν γὰρ δὴ τῶν ἀρχόντων ἐκάστοις ὁ ἐνιαυτὸς ἐξέλθῃ, δεήσει δικαστήρια καθίσαντας ἀνδρῶν, ἢ τῶν πλουσίων ἐκ προκρίσεως ἢ

ST: Yes. And rulers of the people are to be appointed annually, drawn either from the wealthy classes or from the general population. And the rulers, once appointed, should rule according to the written edicts in steering the ships and healing the sick.

YS: This is even more difficult to accept.

299a

ST: Then consider what happens after this. For in each case, once the annual term of the rulers has passed, it is necessary to set up a court consisting of men either preselected from the wealthy classes or chosen by lot from the general population. The outgoing rulers must be brought before these people for scrutiny of their conduct, and anyone who wishes may accuse them of not navigating the ships, during their year in office, in accord with the written edicts or in accord with the ancient practices of our ancestors. And the same goes for those who were treating the sick. And the court must decide what penalty or fine should be imposed upon those who are voted down.

σύμπαντος αὖ τοῦ δήμου τοὺς λαχόντας, εἰς τούτους εἰσάγειν τοὺς ἄρξαντας καὶ εὐθύνειν, κατηγορεῖν δὲ τὸν βουλόμενον ὡς οὐ κατὰ τὰ γράμματα τὸν ἐνιαυτὸν ἐκυβέρνησε τὰς ναῦς οὐδὲ κατὰ τὰ παλαιὰ τῶν προγόνων ἔθῃ ταῦτα δὲ ταῦτα καὶ περὶ τῶν τοὺς κάμνοντας ἰωμένων ὧν δ' ἂν καταψηφισθῇ τιμᾶν ὅτι χρή παθεῖν αὐτῶν τινὰς ἢ ἀποτίνειν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ὃ γ' ἐθέλων καὶ ἐκὼν ἐν τοῖς τοιούτοις

299b

YS: Surely anyone who desires to rule, and is willing to do so under such circumstances, would fully deserve to suffer any penalty at all or be fined any amount whatsoever.

ἄρχειν δικαιοτάτ' ἂν ὀτιοῦν πάσχοι καὶ ἀποτίνοι. ΞΕ. καὶ τοίνυν ἔτι δεῖσαι θέσθαι νόμον ἐπὶ πᾶσι τούτοις, ἂν τις κυβερνητικὴν καὶ τὸ ναυτικὸν ἢ τὸ ὑγιεινὸν καὶ ἱατρικῆς ἀλήθειαν περὶ πνεύματά τε καὶ θερμὰ καὶ ψυχρὰ ζητῶν φαίνεται παρὰ τὰ γράμματα καὶ σοφιζόμενος ὀτιοῦν περὶ τὰ τοιαῦτα, πρῶτον μὲν μήτε ἱατρικὸν αὐτὸν μήτε κυβερνητικὸν ὀνομάζειν ἀλλὰ μετεωρολόγον, ἀδολέσχην τινὰ σοφιστήν, εἴθ' ὥς διαφθείροντα ἄλλους νεωτέρους καὶ ἀναπείθοντα ἐπιτίθεσθαι κυβερνητικῇ καὶ ἱατρικῇ μὴ κατὰ νόμους, ἀλλ' αὐτοκράτορας ἄρχειν τῶν πλοίων καὶ τῶν νοσοῦντων, γραψάμενον εἰσάγειν τὸν βουλόμενον οἷς ἕξεσιν εἰς δὴ τι δικαστήριον· ἂν δὲ παρὰ τοὺς νόμους καὶ τὰ γεγραμμένα δόξῃ πείθειν εἴτε νέους εἴτε πρεσβύτεας, κολάζειν τοῖς ἐσχάτοις. οὐδὲν γὰρ δεῖν τῶν νόμων εἶναι σοφώτερον· οὐδένα γὰρ ἄγνοεῖν τό τε ἱατρικὸν καὶ τὸ ὑγιεινὸν οὐδὲ τὸ κυβερνητικὸν καὶ ναυτικόν· ἐξεῖναι γὰρ τῷ βουλομένῳ μανθάνειν

ST: And what's more, it will be necessary to institute a law, applicable to everything of this sort, according to which anyone who is found to be investigating helmsmanship, navigation, health, and the truth of medical science in relation to the breaths, or heat and cold, in a manner contrary to the written edicts, and is becoming in any way wise on such matters, must in the first place be referred to neither as a physician nor as a helmsman, but as a star-gazer or a babbling sophist. Secondly, anyone who is permitted to do so may drag him into some courtroom, charged with corrupting younger people and persuading them to practise helmsmanship and medicine without regard to law, and ruling over ships and sick people in an autocratic manner. And if he is presumed to have persuaded anyone, young or old, to act contrary to the laws that have been written, he must be punished with the most extreme penalties, for none should be wiser than the laws. Nor indeed need anyone be ignorant of medicine and health, or helmsmanship and navigation, for anyone who wishes is permitted to

learn the written enactments and the traditional practices that are in place.

299d

ST: Well, what if the requirements that we are describing were to apply in the case of these two branches of knowledge, Socrates, and also to generalship, to all forms of hunting whatsoever, and to painting or any part at all of the imitative arts, and to carpentry or to manufacturing as a whole regardless of the kind, or even to agriculture and to the entire skill that is concerned with plants? Or we might also imagine it applying to some kind of horse-keeping that proceeds upon written edicts, to the entire business of herd-minding, to prophecy and every aspect encompassed by service, to draughts-playing, or to the entire science of number, whether pure or as applied to flat surfaces, solids or moving objects. What precisely would the outcome be if all of these were conducted in such a manner as to operate on the basis of written edicts, and not on the basis of the relevant skill?

γεγραμμένα καὶ πάτρια ἔθη κείμενα. ταῦτα δὴ περὶ τε ταύτας τὰς ἐπιστήμας εἰ γίγνοιτο οὕτως ὥς λέγομεν, ὦ Σώκρατες, καὶ στρατηγικῆς καὶ συμπάσης ἡστινοσοῦν θηρευτικῆς καὶ γραφικῆς ἢ συμπάσης μέρος ὅτιοῦν μιμητικῆς καὶ τεκτονικῆς καὶ συνόλης ὅποιασοῦν σκευουργίας ἢ καὶ γεωργίας καὶ τῆς περὶ τὰ φυτὰ συνόλης τέχνης, ἢ καὶ τινα ἵπποφορβίαν αὖ κατὰ συγγράμματα θεασαίμεθα γιγνομένην ἢ σύμπασαν ἀγελαιοκομικὴν ἢ μαντικὴν ἢ πᾶν ὅτι μέρος διακονικὴ

299e

YS: It is obvious that all of the skills would completely cease to exist for us, and could never come back into existence again because of this law prohibiting the conduct of investigation, so that life, which is difficult even now, would at that stage not be worth living at all.

περιείληφεν, ἢ πεττεῖαν ἢ σύμπασαν ἀριθμητικὴν ψιλὴν εἴτε ἐπίπεδον εἴτ' ἐν βάθεσιν εἴτ' ἐν τάχεσιν οὐσάν που, — περὶ ἅπαντα ταῦτα οὕτω πραττόμενα τί ποτ' ἂν φανείη, κατὰ συγγράμματα γιγνόμενα καὶ μὴ κατὰ τέχνην; NE. ΣΩ. δῆλον ὅτι πᾶσαί τε αἱ τέχναι παντελῶς ἂν

ἀπόλοιτο ἡμῖν, καὶ οὐδ' εἰς αὐθις γένοιτ' ἄν ποτε διὰ τὸν ἀποκωλύοντα τοῦτον ζητεῖν νόμον· ὥστε ὁ βίος, ὦν καὶ νῦν χαλεπός, εἰς τὸν χρόνον ἐκείνον ἀβίωτος γίγνοιτ' ἄν τὸ παράπαν.

300a

ST: What about this? If we were to insist that each of the activities we mentioned be conducted according to the written edicts, and that someone be elected or chosen by lot to oversee those edicts, and yet this person, disregarding the edicts either for the sake of profit or to do some private favour, were to undertake a different course of action contrary thereto, devoid of understanding, wouldn't this evil be even greater than the previous evil?

ΞΕ. τί δὲ τόδε; εἰ κατὰ συγγράμματα μὲν ἀναγκάζοιμεν ἕκαστον γίνεσθαι τῶν εἰρημένων καὶ τοῖς συγγράμμασιν ἡμῶν ἐπιστατεῖν τὸν χειροτονηθέντα ἢ λαχόντα ἐκ τύχης, οὗτος δὲ μηδὲν φροντίζων τῶν γραμμάτων ἢ κέρδους ἕνεκέν τινος ἢ χάριτος ἰδίας παρὰ ταῦτ' ἐπιχειροῖ δρᾶν ἕτερα, μηδὲν γιγνώσκων, ἄρα οὐ τοῦ κακοῦ τοῦ πρόσθεν μειζον ἂν ἔτι τοῦτο γίγνοιτο κακόν; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ἀληθέστατά γε.

YS: That's very true, anyway.

300b

ST: Indeed in my view, the laws rest upon considerable experience, and in each case certain advisers have given their counsel in a pleasing manner and have persuaded the populace to adopt them, so anyone who dares to act contrary to these would be perpetrating an even more grievous error, and would be subverting all human action to an even greater extent than any adherence to written laws.

ΞΕ. παρὰ γὰρ οἶμαι τοὺς νόμους τοὺς ἐκ πείρας πολλῆς κειμένους καὶ τινων συμβούλων ἕκαστα χαριέντως συμβουλευσάντων καὶ πεισάντων θέσθαι τὸ πλῆθος, ὁ παρὰ ταῦτα τολμῶν δρᾶν, ἀμαρτήματος ἀμάρτημα πολλαπλάσιον ἀπεργαζόμενος, ἀνατρέποι πᾶσαν ἂν πράξιν ἔτι μειζόνως τῶν συγγραμμάτων. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. πῶς δ' οὐ μέλλει;

YS: Yes, that is inevitable.

ST: Accordingly, the second-best course for those who enact laws and written edicts on any matter at all is to allow no single person or any group ever to do anything whatsoever that is contrary to those laws.

YS: Rightly so.

300c

ST: Wouldn't these be imitations of the truth, in each case, as received from those who know, and written down insofar as this can be done?

ΞΕ. διὰ ταῦτα δὴ τοῖς περὶ οὐτοῦν νόμους καὶ συγγράμματα τιθεμένοις δεύτερος πλοῦς τὸ παρὰ ταῦτα μήτε ἕνα μήτε πλῆθος μηδὲν μηδέποτε ἔαν δρᾶν μηδ' ὅτιοῦν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ὀρθῶς. ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν μιμήματα μὲν ἂν ἐκάστων ταῦτα εἴη τῆς ἀληθείας, τὰ παρὰ τῶν εἰδόντων εἰς δύναμιν εἶναι γεγραμμένα; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. πῶς δ' οὐ; ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν τὸν γε εἰδότα ἔφαμεν, τὸν ὄντως πολιτικόν, εἰ μεμνήμεθα, ποιήσῃ τῇ τέχνῃ πολλὰ εἰς τὴν αὐτοῦ πρᾶξιν τῶν γραμμάτων οὐδὲν φροντίζοντα, ὅποταν ἄλλ' αὐτῷ

YS: It must be so.

ST: And, indeed, we said, if you remember, that the one who knows, the person who is actually a statesman, will use his skill to perform a great variety of actions relevant to his own activity, disregarding the written edicts whenever an alternative seems better to him, even if it is contrary to his own written directions to other people who are not present.

YS: Indeed, we said so.

300d

ST: Now wouldn't anyone at all, one person or any group of people, who is faced with established laws, and undertakes some different course of action contrary to those laws because such a course is better, be doing to the best of their ability the same thing that a true statesman does?

βελτίῳ δόξῃ παρὰ τὰ γεγραμμένα ὑφ' αὐτοῦ καὶ ἐπεσταλμένα ἀποῦσιν τισιν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ἔφαμεν γάρ. ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν ἀνὴρ ὅστις οὐκ εἶς ἢ πλῆθος ὅτιοῦν, οἷς ἂν νόμοι κείμενοι τυγχάνωσι, παρὰ ταῦτα ὅτι ἂν

ἐπιχειρήσωσι ποιεῖν ὡς βέλτιον ἕτερον ὄν, ταῦτόν δρῶσι κατὰ δύναμιν ὅπερ ὁ ἀληθινὸς ἐκεῖνος; NE. ΣΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. ἄρ' οὖν εἰ μὲν ἀνεπιστήμονες ὄντες τὸ τοιοῦτον δρῶεν, μιμεῖσθαι μὲν ἂν ἐπιχειροῖεν τὸ ἀληθές, μιμοῖντ' ἂν

YS: Yes, certainly.

ST: Now, if they were to do this sort of thing without being knowledgeable, they would endeavour to imitate the truth, but would imitate it extremely badly. Alternatively, if they possessed the relevant skill, this is no longer an imitation, but that itself, the very truest.

YS: Entirely so, I suppose.

300e

ST: And, indeed, from our earlier discussion anyway, there is an agreement between us that no large group of people is capable of acquiring any sort of skill whatsoever.

μέντοι παγκάκως· εἰ δ' ἔντεχνοι, τοῦτο οὐκ ἔστιν ἔτι μίμημα ἀλλ' αὐτὸ τὸ ἀληθέστατον ἐκεῖνο; NE. ΣΩ. πάντως που. ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν ἔμπροσθ' γε ὠμολογημένον ἡμῖν κεῖται μηδὲν πλῆθος μηδ' ἡντινοῦν δυνατόν εἶναι λαβεῖν τέχνην. NE. ΣΩ. κεῖται γὰρ οὖν. ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν εἰ μὲν ἔστι βασιλική τις τέχνη, τὸ τῶν πλουσίων πλῆθος καὶ ὁ σύμπας δῆμος οὐκ ἂν ποτε λάβοι τὴν πολιτικὴν ταύτην ἐπιστήμην. NE. ΣΩ. πῶς γὰρ ἄν; ΞΕ. δεῖ δὴ τὰς τοιαύτας γε ὡς ἔοικε πολιτείας, εἰ μέλλουσι

YS: That agreement still stands.

ST: Therefore, if there is a kingly skill, wealthy people in general, and the entire populace, could not ever acquire this knowledge of statesmanship.

YS: No, how could they?

301a

ST: Then it seems that if such constitutions as these intend, as best they can, to be good imitations of that constitution ruled by a single person possessed of skill, they should never enact anything contrary to

the written edicts and traditional practices, once their own laws are in place.

καλῶς τὴν ἀληθινὴν ἐκείνην τὴν τοῦ ἐνὸς μετὰ τέχνης ἄρχοντος πολιτείαν εἰς δύναμιν μιμήσεσθαι, μηδέποτε κειμένων αὐτοῖς τῶν νόμων μηδὲν ποιεῖν παρὰ τὰ γεγραμμένα καὶ πάτρια ἔθη. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. κάλλιστ' εἴρηκας. ΞΕ. ὅταν ἄρα οἱ πλούσιοι ταύτην μιμῶνται, τότε ἀριστοκρατίαν καλοῦμεν τὴν τοιαύτην πολιτείαν· ὁπόταν δὲ τῶν νόμων μὴ φροντίζωσιν, ὀλιγαρχίαν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. κινδυνεύει. ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν ὁπόταν αὐθις εἰς ἄρχη κατὰ νόμους, μιμούμενος

YS: What you have said is excellent.

ST: So, whenever the wealthy people imitate this, we then call a constitution of this sort an aristocracy; and when they pay no heed to the laws, we call it an oligarchy.

YS: Quite likely.

301b

ST: Yes, and whenever a single person, on the basis of the laws, imitates the one who knows, we call him a king, making no distinction by name between the one who exercises sole rule on the basis of the laws by means of knowledge, and the one who does so by means of opinion.

τὸν ἐπιστήμονα, βασιλέα καλοῦμεν, οὐ διορίζοντες ὀνόματι τὸν μετ' ἐπιστήμης ἢ δόξης κατὰ νόμους μοναρχοῦντα. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. κινδυνεύομεν. ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν κἂν τις ἄρα ἐπιστήμων ὄντως ὦν εἰς ἄρχη, πάντως τό γε ὄνομα ταῦτ' ὀνομαζέσθαι καὶ οὐδὲν ἕτερον προσρηθήσεται· δι' ἃ δὴ τὰ πέντε ὀνόματα τῶν νῦν λεγομένων πολιτειῶν ἐν μόνον γέγονεν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ἔοικε γοῦν. ΞΕ. τί δ' ὅταν μήτε κατὰ νόμους μήτε κατὰ ἔθη πράττῃ

YS: That's what we are likely to do.

ST: Therefore, if a single person who really is knowledgeable happens to rule, he will unequivocally be given the same name, king, and no other. Consequently, the five names of what are now called constitutions become just one.

YS: So it seems, anyway.

301c

ST: And what about a situation in which a single person rules in accord neither with the laws nor the traditions, and pretends to be a person who knows by arguing that it is really necessary to act contrary to the written edicts and do what is best, and some passion and ignorance dominate this particular imitation? Mustn't we surely refer to any such person in that situation as a tyrant?

τις εἷς ἄρχων, προσποιῇται δὲ ὥσπερ ὁ ἐπιστήμων ὡς ἄρα παρὰ τὰ γεγραμμένα τό γε βέλτιστον ποιητέον, ἧ δέ τις ἐπιθυμία καὶ ἄγνοια τούτου τοῦ μιμήματος ἡγουμένη, μὴν οὐ τότε τὸν τοιοῦτον ἕκαστον τύραννον κλητέον; NE. ΣΩ. τί μήν; ΞΕ. οὕτω δὴ τύραννός τε γέγονε, φαμέν, καὶ βασιλεὺς καὶ ὀλιγαρχία καὶ ἀριστοκρατία καὶ δημοκρατία, δυσχερανάντων τῶν ἀνθρώπων τὸν ἕνα ἐκείνον μόναρχον, καὶ ἀπιστησάντων μηδένα τῆς τοιαύτης ἀρχῆς ἄξιον ἂν γενέσθαι ποτέ,

YS: Of course.

301d

ST: So we are saying that a tyrant arises in this way, a king too, as well as an oligarchy, an aristocracy, and a democracy: from the disgust of humanity with that one sole ruler, and their disbelief that anyone worthy of such rule could ever arise, someone who would be willing and able to rule with knowledge and excellence, dispensing just and sacred ordinances properly to everyone, rather than maltreating, murdering and inflicting evil upon whomsoever he wants, whenever he wants. But if a person such as we are describing were to arise, he would be loved and would dwell there as the benevolent helmsman of what is, strictly speaking, the only correct constitution.

ὥστε ἐθέλειν καὶ δυνατόν εἶναι μετ' ἀρετῆς καὶ ἐπιστήμης ἄρχοντα τὰ δίκαια καὶ ὅσια διανέμειν ὀρθῶς πᾶσιν, λωβᾶσθαι δὲ καὶ ἀποκτείνονται καὶ κακοῦν ὃν ἂν βουλευθῇ ἐκάστοτε ἡμῶν· ἐπεὶ γενόμενόν γ' ἂν οἶον λέγομεν ἀγαπᾶσθαι τε ἂν καὶ οἰκεῖν διακυβερνῶντα εὐδαιμόνως ὀρθῆν

ἀκριβῶς μόνον πολιτείαν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. πῶς δ' οὐ; ΞΕ. νῦν δέ γε ὁπότε οὐκ ἔστι γιγνόμενος, ὥς δὴ

YS: Of course.

301e

ST: But nowadays, when, as we say, a king does not arise in our cities in the way that a single queen bee springs up in a hive of bees – immediately distinct both in body and in soul – we need to gather together and write down our ordinances in pursuit, it seems, of the traces of the truest constitution.

φαμεν, ἐν ταῖς πόλεσι βασιλεὺς οἷος ἐν σμήνεσιν ἐμφύεται, τό τε σῶμα εὐθὺς καὶ τὴν ψυχὴν διαφέρων εἰς, δεῖ δὴ συνελθόντας συγγράμματα γράφειν, ὥς ἔοικεν, μεταθέοντας τὰ τῆς ἀληθεστάτης πολιτείας ἔχνη. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. κινδυνεύει. ΞΕ. θαυμάζομεν δῆτα, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἐν ταῖς τοιαύταις πολιτείαις ὅσα συμβαίνει γίγνεσθαι κακὰ καὶ ὅσα συμβήσεται, τοιαύτης τῆς κρηπίδος ὑποκειμένης αὐταῖς, τῆς κατὰ γράμματα καὶ ἔθῃ μὴ μετὰ ἐπιστήμης πραττούσης τὰς

YS: Quite likely.

302a

ST: So, Socrates, need we wonder at the extent of the evil that arises and will continue to arise in such constitutions when they are based upon such a foundation as this – the performance of actions in accord with written edicts and customs not accompanied by knowledge – when it is obvious to everyone that any other skill conducted in this way would ruin its very own productions? Or should we wonder instead at something else, at how naturally strong a city is? Of course, our cities have now been suffering under such behaviour for countless ages, and yet some in particular are stable and are not overthrown. However, on occasion, many of them flounder like ships and perish, or have perished or shall yet perish, because of the depravity of the helmsmen and the sailors, who have attained a huge level of ignorance in relation to matters of the utmost importance, who are not knowledgeable about matters of statesmanship in any respect, but

think that of all branches of knowledge, they have acquired this skill with the utmost clarity in every respect.

πράξεις, ἥ ἑτέρα προσχρωμένη παντὶ κατάδηλος ὡς πάντ' ἂν διολέσειε τὰ ταύτη γιγνόμενα; ἢ ἐκεῖνο ἡμῖν θαυμαστέον μᾶλλον, ὡς ἰσχυρόν τι πόλις ἐστὶ φύσει; πάσχουσαι γὰρ δὴ τοιαῦτα αἱ πόλεις νῦν χρόνον ἀπέραντον, ὅμως ἔνιαι τινες αὐτῶν μόνιμοί τέ εἰσι καὶ οὐκ ἀνατρέπονται· πολλὰ μὲν ἐνίοτε καὶ καθάπερ πλοῖα καταδυόμενα διόλλυνται καὶ διολώλασι καὶ ἔτι διολοῦνται διὰ τὴν τῶν κυβερνητῶν καὶ ναυτῶν μοχθηρίαν τῶν περὶ τὰ μέγιστα μεγίστην ἄγνοιαν εἰληφότων, οἱ περὶ τὰ πολιτικά κατ' οὐδὲν γινώσκοντες ἡγοῦνται κατὰ πάντα σαφέστατα πασῶν ἐπιστημῶν ταύτην εἰληφέναι. NE. ΣΩ. ἀληθέστατα. ΞΕ. τίς οὖν δὴ τῶν οὐκ ὀρθῶν πολιτειῶν τούτων ἥκιστα χαλεπὴ συζῆν, πασῶν χαλεπῶν οὐσῶν, καὶ τίς βαρυτάτη; δεῖ τι κατιδεῖν ἡμᾶς, καίπερ πρὸς γε τὸ νῦν προτεθὲν ἡμῖν πάρεργον λεγόμενον; οὐ μὴν ἄλλ' εἷς γε τὸ ὅλον ἴσως ἅπανθ' ἔνεκα τοῦ τοιοῦτου πάντες δρῶμεν χάριν. NE. ΣΩ. δεῖ πῶς δ' οὐ;

302c

YS: Very true.

ΞΕ. τὴν αὐτὴν τοίνυν φάθι τριῶν οὐσῶν χαλεπὴν διαφερόντως γίγνεσθαι καὶ ῥάστην. NE. ΣΩ. πῶς φής; ΞΕ. οὐκ ἄλλως, πλὴν μοναρχίαν φημὶ καὶ ὀλίγων ἀρχὴν καὶ πολλῶν, εἶναι τρεῖς ταύτας ἡμῖν λεγομένας τοῦ νῦν ἐπικεχυμένου λόγου κατ' ἀρχάς. NE. ΣΩ. ἦσαν γὰρ οὗν. ΞΕ. ταύτας τοίνυν δίχα τέμνοντες μίαν ἐκάστην ἕξ ποιῶμεν, τὴν ὀρθὴν χωρὶς ἀποκρίναντες τούτων ἐβδόμην. NE. ΣΩ. πῶς;

ST: Now then, which of these improper constitutions is the least difficult to live under, accepting that all of them are difficult, and which is the most oppressive? Is this something we should look at even though it is a secondary consideration compared to what is now before us? And yet, on the whole it is likely that everything we do is motivated by such a consideration.

YS: We should do as you say, of course.

ST: Then we should declare that of those three constitutions, the same one is both exceptionally difficult and easy at the same time.

YS: How do you mean?

302d

ST: I am just saying that monarchy, rule of the few, and rule of the many, were the three constitutions we mentioned at the beginning of the current influx of discussion.

ΞΕ. ἐκ μὲν τῆς μοναρχίας βασιλικὴν καὶ τυραννικὴν, ἐκ δ' αὖ τῶν μὴ πολλῶν τὴν τε εὐώνυμον ἔφαμεν εἶναι ἀριστοκρατίαν καὶ ὀλιγαρχίαν· ἐκ δ' αὖ τῶν πολλῶν τότε μὲν ἀπλὴν ἐπονομάζοντες ἐτίθεμεν δημοκρατίαν, νῦν δ' αὖ καὶ ταύτην ἡμῖν θετέον ἐστὶ διπλὴν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. πῶς δὴ; καὶ τίνοι διαιροῦντες ταύτην; ΞΕ. οὐδὲν διαφέροντι τῶν ἄλλων, οὐδ' εἰ τοῦνομα ἤδη

YS: They were, indeed.

ST: Then cutting each one of these in two we would produce six, keeping the correct one separate from these as a seventh.

YS: How?

ST: From monarchy we get the kingly and the tyrannical subdivisions. Then, in turn, from rule not involving many we get aristocracy, which we said has a good reputation, and also oligarchy. And furthermore, in the case of the rule of many, we proposed at the time simply to call it democracy, but now we must also propose a twofold aspect for this.

YS: In what way? And dividing it on what basis?

302e

ST: No differently from the others. Even if its name is already single, there is nevertheless rule according to law and rule contrary to law, both under this constitution and under the others.

διπλοῦν ἐστὶ ταύτης· ἀλλὰ τό γε κατὰ νόμους ἄρχειν καὶ παρανόμως ἐστὶ καὶ ταύτη καὶ ταῖς ἄλλαις. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ἔστι γὰρ οὖν. ΞΕ. τότε μὲν τοίνυν τὴν ὀρθὴν ζητοῦσι τοῦτο τὸ τμήμα οὐκ ἦν χρήσιμον, ὥς ἐν τοῖς

πρόσθεν ἀπεδείξαμεν· ἐπειδὴ δὲ ἐξείλομεν ἐκείνην, τὰς δ' ἄλλας ἔθεμεν ἀναγκαίως, ἐν ταύταις δὴ τὸ παράνομον καὶ ἔννομον ἐκάστην διχοτομεῖ τούτων. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ἔοικεν τούτου νῦν ῥηθέντος τοῦ λόγου. ΞΕ. μοναρχία τοῖνυν ζευχθεῖσα μὲν ἐν γράμμασιν ἀγαθοῖς, οὓς νόμους λέγομεν, ἀρίστη πασῶν τῶν ἔξ' ἄνομος δὲ χαλεπὴ καὶ βαρυτάτη συνοικῆσαι.

YS: There is, indeed.

ST: Now, when we were searching for the right constitution, this division was not useful, as we demonstrated in our previous discussion. However, once we have set that constitution aside, and have proposed that the others are necessary, then the criteria of ruling contrary to law or lawfully, divide each of these constitutions in two.

YS: So it seems, now that you have presented this argument.

ST: Well then, monarchy, when yoked to good written ordinances which we call laws, is the best of the six. But when it is lawless, it is the most oppressive and difficult constitution to live under.

YS: Quite likely.

303a

ST: Then again, just as few are intermediate between one and many, so the rule of the 'not many' should be regarded accordingly as intermediate in both respects. The rule of the many, for its part, is weak in every respect, and in comparison with the others is capable neither of great good nor of great evil, because public offices therein are distributed in minute subdivisions to many people. Therefore, when all of the constitutions are lawful, this proves to be the worst of them; and when they are all at variance with the law, it is the best; and when all of them lack restraint, the life in a democracy wins out; but when they are orderly, this is the last one you should live in. But life in the first is by far the best, with the exception of the seventh, for we must separate that one from all of the other constitutions, as we would separate a god from human beings.

NE. ΣΩ. κινδυνεύει. ΞΕ. τὴν δέ γε τῶν μὴ πολλῶν, ὥσπερ ἑνὸς καὶ πλήθους τὸ ὀλίγον μέσον, οὕτως ἡγησώμεθα μέσσην ἐπ' ἀμφοτέρᾳ τὴν δ' αὖ τοῦ πλήθους κατὰ πάντα ἀσθενῆ καὶ μηδὲν μήτε ἀγαθὸν μήτε κακὸν μέγα δυναμένην ὡς πρὸς τὰς ἄλλας διὰ τὸ τὰς ἀρχὰς ἐν ταύτῃ διανενομήσθαι κατὰ σμικρὰ εἰς πολλούς. διὸ γέγονε πασῶν μὲν νομίμων τῶν πολιτειῶν οὐσῶν τούτων χειρίστη, παρανόμων δὲ οὐσῶν συμπασῶν βελτίστη.

303b

YS: It appears that these conclusions follow, and that's how matters stand. So we should do exactly as you say.

καὶ ἀκολάστων μὲν πασῶν οὐσῶν ἐν δημοκρατίᾳ νικᾷ ζῆν, κοσμίω δ' οὐσῶν ἥκιστα ἐν ταύτῃ βιωτέον, ἐν τῇ πρώτῃ δὲ πολὺ πρῶτόν τε καὶ ἄριστον, πλὴν τῆς ἐβδόμης· πασῶν γὰρ ἐκείνην γε ἐκκριτέον, οἷον θεὸν ἐξ ἀνθρώπων, ἐκ τῶν ἄλλων πολιτειῶν. NE. ΣΩ. φαίνεται ταῦθ' οὕτω συμβαίνειν τε καὶ γίνεσθαι, καὶ ποιητέον ἥπερ λέγεις. ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν δὴ καὶ τοὺς κοινωνοὺς τούτων τῶν πολιτειῶν

303c

ST: In that case, we should set aside those who have a common involvement in all these constitutions, except the one based on knowledge, as not being statesmen but seditious influences presiding over vast images. Indeed, they are such themselves, and being the greatest imitators and beguilers, they prove to be the greatest sophists of all the sophists.

πασῶν πλὴν τῆς ἐπιστήμονος ἀφαιρετέον ὡς οὐκ ὄντας πολιτικούς ἀλλὰ στασιαστικούς, καὶ εἰδώλων μεγίστων προστάτας ὄντας καὶ αὐτοὺς εἶναι τοιοῦτους, μεγίστους δὲ ὄντας μιμητὰς καὶ γόητας μεγίστους γίνεσθαι τῶν σοφιστῶν σοφιστάς. NE. ΣΩ. κινδυνεύει τοῦτο εἰς τοὺς πολιτικούς λεγομένους περιστράφθαι τὸ ῥῆμα ὀρθότατα. ΞΕ. εἶεν· τοῦτο μὲν ἀτεχνῶς ἡμῖν ὥσπερ δῖαμα, καθάπερ ἐρρήθη νυνδὴ Κενταυρικὸν ὀρᾶσθαι καὶ Σατυρικόν τινα

YS: It seems that this epithet is being turned quite rightly against the so-called statesmen.

303d

ST: So be it. This has really been like a play for us. Some troop of centaurs and satyrs was coming into view, as we said earlier, and had to be separated from the skill of statesmanship. And it has now been separated in this extremely difficult manner.

θίασον, ὃν δὴ χωριστεόν ἀπὸ πολιτικῆς εἴη τέχνης· νῦν δ' οὕτω πάνυ μόγις ἐχωρίσθη. NE. ΣΩ. φαίνεται. ΞΕ. τούτου δέ γ' ἕτερον ἔτι χαλεπώτερον λείπεται τῷ συγγενές τε ὁμοῦ τ' εἶναι μᾶλλον τῷ βασιλικῷ γένει καὶ δυσκαταμαθητότερον· καί μοι φαινόμεθα τοῖς τὸν χρυσὸν καθαίρουσι πάθος ὅμοιον πεπονθέναι. NE. ΣΩ. πῶς; ΞΕ. Γῆν που καὶ λίθους καὶ πόλλ' ἄττα ἕτερα ἀποκρίνουσι καὶ ἐκεῖνοι πρῶτον οἱ δημιουργοί μετὰ δὲ ταῦτα

YS: So it appears.

ST: But there is something remaining that presents an even greater difficulty than this, since it is more akin to the kingly class, and also harder to understand. Indeed, we appear to me to be in a similar predicament to those who refine gold.

YS: How so?

303e

ST: Presumably those craftsmen firstly separate out the earth and stones and numerous other substances, and after this, valuable admixtures akin to gold remain – copper and silver, and, on occasion, adamant – which are separable only by fire. Once these have been separated with difficulty, by repeated proving and smelting, we are allowed to behold what we call unadulterated gold alone, just by itself.

λείπεται συμμεμειγμένα τὰ συγγενῇ τοῦ χρυσοῦ τίμια καὶ πυρὶ μόνον ἀφαιρετά, χαλκὸς καὶ ἄργυρος, ἔστι δ' ὅτε καὶ ἀδάμας, ἃ μετὰ βασάνων ταῖς ἐψήσεσι μόγις ἀφαιρεθέντα τὸν λεγόμενον ἀκήρατον χρυσὸν εἶασεν ἡμᾶς ἰδεῖν αὐτὸν μόνον ἐφ' ἑαυτοῦ. NE. ΣΩ. λέγεται γὰρ οὖν δὴ ταῦτα οὕτω γίγνεσθαι. ΞΕ. κατὰ τὸν αὐτὸν τοίνυν λόγον ἔοικε καὶ νῦν ἡμῖν τὰ μὲν ἕτερα καὶ ὅποσα ἀλλότρια καὶ τὰ μὴ φίλα πολιτικῆς

ἐπιστήμης ἀποκεχωρίσθαι, λείπεσθαι δὲ τὰ τίμια καὶ συγγενῇ. τούτων δ' ἐστὶ που στρατηγία καὶ δικαστική καὶ ὅση

YS: Yes indeed. That is how these processes are said to operate.

304a

ST: Well, according to the same account, it seems we too have separated off the others who are alien to, and lacking affinity with, the knowledge of statesmanship, leaving behind the valuable and the kindred. These presumably include generalship, legal affairs, and any rhetoric that cooperates with kingship, persuades people of what is just, and takes a share in steering the affairs of our cities. So, in what way may someone easily separate these off, and display that object of our search, naked and alone, just by itself?

βασιλικῇ κοινωνοῦσα ῥητορεία πείθουσα τὸ δίκαιον συνδιακυβερνᾷ τὰς ἐν ταῖς πόλεσι πράξεις· ἃ δὴ τίνι τρόπῳ ῥᾷστά τις ἀπομερίζων δείξει γυμνὸν καὶ μόνον ἐκεῖνον καθ' αὐτὸν τὸν ζητούμενον ὑφ' ἡμῶν; NE. ΣΩ. δῆλον ὅτι τοῦτό πη δρᾶν πειρατέον. ΞΕ. πείρας μὲν τοίνυν ἔνεκα φανερὸς ἔσται· διὰ δὲ μουσικῆς αὐτὸν ἐγχειρητέον δηλῶσαι. καὶ μοι λέγε. NE. ΣΩ. τὸ ποῖον;

YS: This is obviously what we should somehow try to do.

ST: Then, if it's only a matter of trying, he will be made evident, and we should attempt to reveal him by recourse to music. Tell me something.

YS: What is it?

304b

ST: There is presumably some process of learning music, and a knowledge of manual skills in general?

ΞΕ. μουσικῆς ἔστι πού τις ἡμῖν μάθησις, καὶ ὅλως τῶν περὶ χειροτεχνίας ἐπιστημῶν; NE. ΣΩ. ἔστιν. ΞΕ. τί δέ; τὸ δ' αὖ τούτων ἡγνινοῦν εἴτε δεῖ μαθάνειν ἡμᾶς εἴτε μή, πότερα φήσομεν ἐπιστήμην αὖ καὶ ταύτην εἶναι τινα περὶ αὐτὰ ταῦτα, ἢ πῶς; NE. ΣΩ. οὕτως, εἶναι

φήσομεν. ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν ἑτέραν ὁμολογήσομεν ἐκείνων εἶναι ταύτην; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ναί. ΞΕ. πότερα δὲ αὐτῶν οὐδεμίαν ἄρχειν δεῖν ἄλλην ἄλλης,

YS: There is.

ST: What about the further issue of whether it is necessary for us to learn any of these subjects or not? Shall we say that this, for its part, is also knowledge concerning the subjects themselves? What should we say?

YS: Just that. We should say that it is.

ST: Won't we agree that this form of knowledge is different from the previous ones?

YS: Yes.

304c

ST: And should none of these rule any of the others, or should the others rule this one, or should this one manage and rule all of the others?

ἢ ἐκείνας ταύτης, ἢ ταύτην δεῖν ἐπιτροπεύουσιν ἄρχειν συμπασῶν τῶν ἄλλων; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ταύτην ἐκείνων. ΞΕ. τὴν εἰ δεῖ μανθάνειν ἢ μὴ τῆς μανθανομένης καὶ διδασκούσης ἄρα σύ γε ἀποφαίνειν δεῖν ἡμῖν ἄρχειν; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. σφόδρα γε. ΞΕ. καὶ τὴν εἰ δεῖ πείθειν ἄρα ἢ μὴ τῆς δυναμένης πείθειν; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. πῶς δ' οὐ; ΞΕ. εἶεν· τίς τὸ πειστικὸν οὖν ἀποδώσομεν ἐπιστήμῃ

YS: This one should rule them.

ST: So, are you of the view anyway that, according to us, the knowledge that decides whether we should learn certain subjects or not must rule over whatever knowledge is learned and taught?

YS: Very much so.

ST: And should the knowledge of whether it is necessary to persuade or not, rule over the knowledge of the ability to persuade?

YS: Of course.

304d

ST: So be it. Now, to what form of knowledge shall we assign the ability to persuade crowds and groups by telling them stories, rather than by teaching them?

πλήθους τε καὶ ὄχλου διὰ μυθολογίας ἀλλὰ μὴ διὰ διδαχῆς; NE. ΣΩ. φανερόν οἶμαι καὶ τοῦτο ῥητορικῇ δοτέον ὄν. ΞΕ. τὸ δ' εἴτε διὰ πειθοῦς εἴτε καὶ διὰ τινος βίας δεῖ πράττειν πρὸς τινὰς ὅτιοῦν ἢ καὶ τὸ παράπαν ἡσυχίαν ἔχειν, τοῦτ' αὖ ποῖα προσθήσομεν ἐπιστήμη; NE. ΣΩ. τῇ τῆς πειστικῆς ἀρχούσῃ καὶ λεκτικῇ. ΞΕ. εἴη δ' ἂν οὐκ ἄλλη τις, ὡς οἶμαι, πλὴν ἢ τοῦ πολιτικοῦ δύναμις. NE. ΣΩ. κάλλιστ' εἴρηκας. ΞΕ. καὶ τοῦτο μὲν ἔοικε ταχὺ κεχωρίσθαι πολιτικῆς τὸ

YS: I think that this too is obvious. It should be assigned to rhetoric.

ST: And the issue of whether we should perform any action whatsoever towards anyone, by means of persuasion or by some use of force, or even leave them entirely undisturbed – with which form of knowledge shall we associate this?

YS: With the knowledge that rules over the knowledge of persuasion and speech.

ST: And that in my view would be nothing other than the power of the statesman.

YS: Well said.

304e

ST: Then it seems we have quickly separated this rhetoric from statesmanship, as being a different form, subservient to it.

ῥητορικόν, ὡς ἕτερον εἶδος ὄν, ὑπηρετοῦν μὴν ταύτῃ. NE. ΣΩ. ναί. ΞΕ. τί δὲ περὶ τῆς τοιαύδ' αὖ δυνάμεως διανοητέον; NE. ΣΩ. ποίας; ΞΕ. τῆς ὡς πολεμητέον ἐκάστοις οἷς ἂν προελώμεθα πολεμεῖν, εἴτε αὐτὴν ἄτεχνον εἴτε ἔντεχνον ἐροῦμεν; NE. ΣΩ. καὶ πῶς ἂν ἄτεχνον διανοηθεῖμεν, ἢν γε ἡ στρατηγικὴ καὶ πᾶσα ἡ πολεμικὴ πράξις πράττει; ΞΕ. τὴν δὲ εἴτε πολεμητέον εἴτε διὰ φιλίας ἀπαλλακτέον οἷαν τε καὶ ἐπιστήμονα

διαβουλεύασθαι, ταύτης ἑτέραν ὑπολάβωμεν ἢ τὴν αὐτὴν ταύτη; NE. ΣΩ. τοῖς πρόσθεν ἀναγκαῖον ἐπομένοισιν ἑτέραν.

YS: Yes.

ST: And what view should we hold, in turn, in relation to a power of the following kind?

YS: What kind?

ST: The power over how we should wage war against those whom we have chosen to fight. Does this involve a skill, or is it devoid of skill?

YS: But how could we regard it as devoid of skill, when it is a power exercised by generalship, and military science in its entirety?

ST: And the power that is able to deliberate knowledgeably on whether we should wage war or withdraw in friendship, should we understand this as different from that, or the same as that?

YS: To anyone following the previous discussion, it must be different.

305a

ST: In that case, shall we declare that it rules over the other one, if in fact we are going to understand it in a manner similar to the previous examples?

ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν ἄρχουσιν ταύτης αὐτὴν ἀποφανόμεθα, εἴπερ τοῖς ἔμπροσθέν γε ὑποληψόμεθα ὁμοίως; NE. ΣΩ. φημί. ΞΕ. τίς οὖν ποτε καὶ ἐπιχειρήσομεν οὕτω δεινῆς καὶ μεγάλης τέχνης συμπάσης τῆς πολεμικῆς δεσπότιν ἀποφαίνεσθαι πλὴν γε δὴ τὴν ὄντως οὔσαν βασιλικήν; NE. ΣΩ. οὐδεμίαν ἄλλην. ΞΕ. οὐκ ἄρα πολιτικὴν θήσομεν, ὑπηρετικὴν γε οὔσαν, τὴν τῶν στρατηγῶν ἐπιστήμην. NE. ΣΩ. οὐκ εἰκός.

YS: I agree.

ST: Now, what exactly shall we undertake to put forward in like manner as mistress of a great and fearsome skill, the art of war in its entirety, unless it really is the skill of kingship?

YS: None other.

ST: So, we shall not propose that the knowledge belonging to the generals is statesmanship since it is subservient.

YS: Not likely.

305b

ST: Come on, then. Let's look at the power possessed by those judges who make their judgements correctly.

ΞΕ. ἴθι δὴ, καὶ τὴν τῶν δικαστῶν τῶν ὀρθῶς δικαζόντων θεασώμεθα δύναμιν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. ἄρ' οὖν ἐπὶ πλεον τι δύναται τοῦ περὶ τὰ συμβόλαια πάνθ' ὅποσα κείται νόμιμα παρὰ νομοθέτου βασιλέως παραλαβοῦσα, κρίνειν εἰς ἐκεῖνα σκοποῦσα τά τε δίκαια ταχθέντ' εἶναι καὶ ἄδικα, τὴν αὐτῆς ἰδίαν ἀρετὴν παρεχομένη τοῦ μήθ' ὑπὸ τινων δώρων μήθ' ὑπὸ φόβων μήτε οἴκτων μήθ'

YS: Very well.

ST: Now, is this power able to do anything more than take the lawfully established ordinances that it receives from the lawmaker-king, and make judgements on the basis of these by considering which arrangements are just and which are unjust, bringing to bear its own particular excellence by which it would not be prepared to decide upon any issue between people in a manner contrary to the ordinances of the lawmaker, having been corrupted by some bribes, by fear or by lamentations, or any kind of enmity or friendship?

305c

YS: No, you have pretty well explained how far the function of this particular power extends.

ὑπὸ τινος ἄλλης ἔχθρας μὴδὲ φιλίας ἡττηθεῖσα παρὰ τὴν τοῦ νομοθέτου τάξιν ἐθέλειν ἂν τὰλλήλων ἐγκλήματα διαιρεῖν; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. οὐκ, ἀλλὰ σχεδὸν ὅσον εἴρηκας ταύτης ἐστὶ τῆς δυνάμεως ἔργον. ΞΕ. καὶ τὴν τῶν δικαστῶν ἄρα ῥώμην ἀνευρίσκομεν οὐ βασιλικὴν οὖσαν ἀλλὰ νόμων φύλακα καὶ ὑπηρετὴν ἐκείνης. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ἔοικέν γε. ΞΕ. τότε

δή κατανοητέον ἰδόντι συναπάσας τὰς ἐπιστήμας αἱ εἴρηνται, ὅτι πολιτική γε αὐτῶν οὐδεμία ἀνεφάνη.

ST: In which case we discover that the power possessed by the judges too is not kingship. Rather it is the guardian of the law and hand-maiden of kingship.

YS: So it seems, anyway.

ST: So, we should recognise, on reviewing all of the kinds of knowledge we have mentioned, that not one of them turns out to be statesmanship. Indeed, kingship, as it really is, should not perform actions itself, but should rule over those who are able to perform actions, recognising the starting point and impetus of the most important matters in the city, with a view also to what is timely and what is not, while others carry out his instructions.

305d

YS: Rightly so.

τὴν γὰρ ὄντως οὕσαν βασιλικὴν οὐκ αὐτὴν δεῖ πράττειν ἀλλ' ἄρχειν τῶν δυναμένων πράττειν, γιγνώσκουσιν τὴν ἀρχὴν τε καὶ ὁρμὴν τῶν μεγίστων ἐν ταῖς πόλεσιν ἐγκαίριας τε πέρι καὶ ἀκαιρίας, τὰς δ' ἄλλας τὰ προσταχθέντα δρᾶν. NE. ΣΩ. ὀρθῶς. ΞΕ. διὰ ταῦτα ἄρα ἅς μὲν ἄρτι διεληλύθαμεν, οὗτ' ἀλλήλων οὐθ' αὐτῶν ἄρχουσαι, περὶ δέ τινα ἰδίαν αὐτῆς οὕσα ἐκάστη πρᾶξιν, κατὰ τὴν ἰδιότητα τῶν πράξεων τοῦνομα δικαίως εἴληφεν ἴδιον.

ST: So, for these reasons, the skills we have just described rule neither over themselves nor one another, but each is concerned with some particular activity of its own, and has acquired a specific name that is appropriate to the particular nature of the activity.

305e

YS: Yes, that's what they seem to do.

NE. ΣΩ. εἴξασι γοῦν. ΞΕ. τὴν δὲ πασῶν τε τούτων ἄρχουσιν καὶ τῶν νόμων καὶ συμπάντων τῶν κατὰ πόλιν ἐπιμελουμένην καὶ πάντα συνυφαίνουσιν ὁρθότατα, τοῦ κοινοῦ τῇ κλήσει περιλαβόντες τὴν

δύναμιν αὐτῆς, προσαγορεύοιμεν δικαιοτάτ' ἄν, ὡς ἔοικε, πολιτικὴν. NE. ΣΩ. παντάπασι μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν δὴ καὶ κατὰ τὸ τῆς ὑφαντικῆς παράδειγμα βουλοίμεθ' ἄν ἐπεξελθεῖν αὐτὴν νῦν, ὅτε καὶ πάντα τὰ γένη τὰ κατὰ πόλιν δῆλα ἡμῖν γέγονε; NE. ΣΩ. καὶ σφόδρα γε.

ST: But the knowledge that rules over all of these, superintends the laws and all the affairs of the city, and weaves everything together perfectly, has a power that is comprehended in the name belonging to the common factor, and, it seems, may quite properly be referred to as statesmanship.

YS: Entirely so.

ST: Well, wouldn't we also like to take this further, based upon the example of weaving, now that all the classes relevant to the city have become evident to us?

YS: Yes, very much so.

306a

ST: Then it seems we should state what kind of process the kingly intertwining is, the manner in which it does the intertwining, and the sort of fabric it presents us with.

ΞΕ. τὴν δὴ βασιλικὴν συμπλοκὴν, ὡς ἔοικε, λεκτέον ποία τέ ἐστι καὶ τίνι τρόπῳ συμπλέκουσα ποῖον ἡμῖν ὕφασμα ἀποδίδωσιν. NE. ΣΩ. δῆλον. ΞΕ. ἥ χαλεπὸν ἐνδείξασθαι πρᾶγμα ἀναγκαῖον ἄρα γέγονεν, ὡς φαίνεται. NE. ΣΩ. πάντως γε μὴν ῥητέον. ΞΕ. τὸ γὰρ ἀρετῆς μέρος ἀρετῆς εἶδει διάφορον εἶναι τινα τρόπον τοῖς περὶ λόγους ἀμφισβητητικοῖς καὶ μάλ' εὐεπίθετον πρὸς τὰς τῶν πολλῶν δόξας. NE. ΣΩ. οὐκ ἔμαθον. ΞΕ. ἀλλ' ὧδε πάλιν. ἀνδρείαν γὰρ οἶμαί σε ἡγεῖσθαι

YS: Obviously.

ST: In that case, it has apparently become necessary to give an exposition of a difficult matter.

YS: There's no other option anyway. It should be delivered.

ST: Indeed, the assertion that a part of excellence is, in a sense, contrary in form to excellence in general is very easily assailed by those who are skilled in verbal disputation by an appeal to the opinions of the majority.

YS: I do not understand.

306b

ST: Then I'll restate it as follows, for I presume you regard courage, for us, to be one part of excellence.

μέρος ἓν ἀρετῆς ἡμῖν εἶναι. NE. ΣΩ. πάνυ γε. ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν σωφροσύνην γε ἀνδρείας μὲν ἕτερον, ἓν δ' οὖν καὶ τοῦτο μόνιον ἧς κάκεῖνο. NE. ΣΩ. ναί. ΞΕ. τούτων δὴ περί θυμαστόν τινα λόγον ἀποφαίνεσθαι τολμητέον. NE. ΣΩ. ποῖον; ΞΕ. ὥς ἐστὸν κατὰ δὴ τινα τρόπον εὖ μάλα πρὸς ἀλλήλας ἔχθραν καὶ στάσιν ἐναντίαν ἔχοντε ἐν πολλοῖς τῶν ὄντων. NE. ΣΩ. πῶς λέγεις; ΞΕ. οὐκ εἰωθότα λόγον οὐδαμῶς· πάντα γὰρ οὖν δὴ

YS: Entirely so.

ST: Yes. And self-control is different from courage, but this too is one part of that which courage is part of.

YS: Yes.

ST: Then we must dare to pronounce a wondrous doctrine in relation to these.

YS: Of what sort?

ST: That these two, in a certain sense, are very much enemies of one another, and they hold opposing positions in many actual situations.

YS: How do you mean?

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ST: The doctrine is not at all familiar, since in fact all the parts of excellence are usually said to be friendly towards one another in some sense.

ἀλλήλοις τά γε τῆς ἀρετῆς μόρια λέγεταιί που φίλια. NE. ΣΩ. ναί. ΞΕ. σκοπῶμεν δὴ προσσχόντες τὸν νοῦν εὖ μάλα πότερον οὕτως ἀπλοῦν ἐστὶ τοῦτο, ἢ παντὸς μᾶλλον αὐτῶν ἔχει διαφορὰν τοῖς συγγενέσιν ἔς τι; NE. ΣΩ. ναί, λέγοις ἂν πῇ σκεπτέον. ΞΕ. ἐν τοῖς σύμπασι χρή ζητεῖν ὅσα καλὰ μὲν λέγομεν, εἰς δύο δὲ αὐτὰ τίθεμεν ἐναντία ἀλλήλων εἴδη. NE. ΣΩ. λέγ' ἔτι σαφέστερον. ΞΕ. ὁξύτητα καὶ τάχος, εἴτε κατὰ σώματα εἴτ' ἐν

YS: Yes.

ST: Should we then apply our minds diligently and consider whether this is simply the way it is, or is it more the case that some of these are in opposition to their own kindred in some respect?

YS: Yes, you should explain how we should consider this issue.

ST: It is necessary to investigate all of those circumstances in which we refer to things as good, but nevertheless assign them to two forms opposite to one another.

YS: Explain this more clearly.

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ST: Take acuity and speed, whether of body or soul, or in the delivery of a speech. Have you yourself ever praised any of these qualities themselves, either directly or in whatever images of them are provided by musical or pictorial imitation? Or have you ever been present to hear someone else praising them?

ψυχᾷς εἴτε κατὰ φωνῆς φοράν, εἴτε αὐτῶν τούτων εἴτε ἐν εἰδώλοις ὄντων, ὅποσα μουσικὴ μιμουμένη καὶ ἔτι γραφικὴ μιμήματα παρέχεται, τούτων τινὸς ἐπαινέτης εἴτε αὐτὸς πώποτε γέγονας εἴτε ἄλλου παρὼν ἐπαινοῦντος ἦσθησαι; NE. ΣΩ. τί μήν; ΞΕ. ἢ καὶ μνήμην ἔχεις ὄντινα τρόπον αὐτὸ δρῶσιν ἐν ἐκάστοις τούτων; NE. ΣΩ. οὐδαμῶς. ΞΕ. ἄρ' οὐν δυνατός αὐτὸ ἂν γενοίμην, ὥσπερ καὶ διανοοῦμαι, διὰ λόγων ἐνδείξασθαί σοι;

YS: Of course.

ST: And can you recall the manner in which they did so in each of these cases?

YS: Not at all.

ST: Now, I wonder if I'll be capable of using words to present to you exactly what is in my mind.

YS: But why not?

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ST: You seem to think that this sort of issue is easy. But we really should consider it in those cases in which the skills are opposed. For of course, on many occasions, when we are pleased by the speed, intensity or acuity of numerous actions, be they mental or physical or even vocal, we speak in praise of this by using a single designation, the word 'courage'.

NE. ΣΩ. τί δ' οὐ; ΞΕ. ῥάδιον ἔοικας ἡγεῖσθαι τὸ τοιοῦτον· σκοπώμεθα δ' οὖν αὐτὸ ἐν τοῖς ὑπεναντίοις γένεσι. τῶν γὰρ δὴ πράξεων ἐν πολλαῖς καὶ πολλάκις ἐκάστοτε τάχος καὶ σφοδρότητα καὶ δξύτητα διανοήσεώς τε καὶ σώματος, ἔτι δὲ καὶ φωνῆς, ὅταν ἀγασθῶμεν, λέγομεν αὐτὸ ἐπαινοῦντες μιᾷ χρώμενοι προσρήσει τῇ τῆς ἀνδρείας. NE. ΣΩ. πῶς; ΞΕ. ὁξὺ καὶ ἀνδρεῖον πρῶτόν ποῦ φαμεν, καὶ ταχύ καὶ ἀνδρικόν, καὶ σφοδρὸν ὡσαύτως· καὶ πάντως ἐπιφέροντες τοῦνομα ὃ λέγω κοινὸν πάσαις ταῖς φύσεσι ταύταις ἐπαινοῦμεν αὐτάς. NE. ΣΩ. ναί.

YS: How so?

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ST: I am presuming in the first place that we say 'acute and courageous', and we also say 'quick and courageous', and the same goes for 'intense'. And in applying the name that I am uttering in common to all of these natures, we are praising them.

ΞΕ. τί δέ; τὸ τῆς ἡρεμαίας αὖ γενέσεως εἶδος ἄρ' οὐ πολλάκις ἐπηνέκαμεν ἐν πολλαῖς τῶν πράξεων; NE. ΣΩ. καὶ σφόδρα γε. ΞΕ. μὴ οὖν οὐ τἀναντία λέγοντες ἢ περὶ ἐκείνων τοῦτο φθεγγόμεθα; NE. ΣΩ. πῶς; ΞΕ. ὡς ἡσυχαιᾶ ποῦ φαμεν ἐκάστοτε καὶ σωφρονικά, περὶ τε

διάνοιαν πραττόμενα ἀγασθέντες καὶ κατὰ τὰς πράξεις αὐτὴν βραδέα καὶ μαλακά, καὶ ἔτι περὶ φωνᾶς γιγνόμενα λεῖα καὶ βαρέα, καὶ πᾶσαν ῥυθμικὴν κίνησιν καὶ ὅλην

YS: Yes.

ST: Yes. But haven't we, on many occasions, also praised the form of gentleness that occurs in many activities?

YS: Yes, very much so.

ST: Of course, what we say about this is the opposite of what we say about those other qualities.

YS: In what way?

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ST: In the sense that in these cases we say 'calm' and 'sound-minded' when admiring activities in the mental realm; then again, 'slow' and 'gentle' when it relates to physical actions; and to 'smooth' and 'deep' in relation to the working of the voice and to all rhythmical motion and any music that makes opportune use of slowness. To all these activities we do not apply the term 'courage', but 'orderliness'.

μοῦσαν ἐν καιρῷ βραδυτῆτι προσχρωμένην, οὐ τὸ τῆς ἀνδρείας ἀλλὰ τὸ τῆς κοσμιότητος ὄνομα ἐπιφέρομεν αὐτοῖς σύμπασιν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ἀληθέστατα. ΞΕ. καὶ μὴν ὁπόταν αὐτὴ γε ἀμφοτέρω γίγνηται ταῦθ' ἡμῖν ἄκαιρα, μεταβάλλοντες ἑκάτερα αὐτῶν ψέγομεν ἐπὶ τὰναντία πάλιν ἀπονέμοντες τοῖς ὀνόμασιν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. πῶς; ΞΕ. ὁξύτερα μὲν αὐτὰ γιγνόμενα τοῦ καιροῦ καὶ θάττω καὶ σκληρότερα φαινόμενα καὶ ὑβριστικά καὶ μανικά λέγοντες,

YS: Very true.

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ST: And yet, on the other hand, whenever in our view they both occur inopportunately, we turn around and censure each of them, assigning them to their opposites by the names we use.

τὰ δὲ βαρύτερα καὶ βραδύτερα καὶ μαλακώτερα δειλὰ καὶ βλακικὰ· καὶ σχεδὸν ὡς τὸ πολὺ ταῦτά τε καὶ τὴν σὺφρονα φύσιν καὶ τὴν ἀνδρείαν τὴν τῶν ἐναντίων, οἷον πολεμίαν διαλαχούσας στάσιν ἰδέας, οὐτ' ἀλλήλαις μειγνυμένας ἐφευρίσκομεν ἐν ταῖς περὶ τὰ τοιαῦτα πράξεσιν, ἔτι τε τοὺς ἐν ταῖς ψυχαῖς αὐτὰς ἴσχοντας διαφερομένους ἀλλήλοις ὁψόμεθα ἐὰν μεταδιώκωμεν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ποῦ δὴ λέγεις; ΞΕ. ἐν πᾶσί τε δὴ τούτοις οἷς νῦν εἵπομεν, ὡς εἰκός

YS: In what way?

ST: By saying that those that occur with more acuity than is opportune, or appear too rapid or harsh are violent and manic, while those that are heavier, slower and more gentle are cowardly or sluggish. And we shall find generally, for the most part, that these qualities, along with the sound-minded nature and the courage associated with the opposite qualities, acting as if enmity was their fate, do not mix with one another in activities concerned with such issues. And if we pursue the enquiry further, we shall observe that those who hold them within their souls are at variance with one another too.

307d

YS: Where do you propose that we observe this?

τε ἐν ἑτέροις πολλοῖς. κατὰ γὰρ οἶμαι τὴν αὐτῶν ἑκατέροις συγγένειαν τὰ μὲν ἐπαινοῦντες ὡς οἰκεῖα σφέτερα, τὰ δὲ τῶν διαφόρων ψέγοντες ὡς ἀλλότρια, πολλὴν εἰς ἑχθραν ἀλλήλοις καὶ πολλῶν πέρι καθίστανται. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. κινδυνεύουσιν. ΞΕ. παιδιὰ τοίνυν αὕτη γέ τις ἢ διαφορὰ τούτων ἐστὶ τῶν εἰδῶν· περὶ δὲ τὰ μέγιστα νόσος συμβαίνει πασῶν ἐχθίστη γίγνεσθαι ταῖς πόλεσιν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. περὶ δὴ ποῖα φής;

ST: In all the cases we mentioned just now, and probably in many others besides. For on the basis of their own kinship with one set of qualities or the other, I think that they praise one as their own kindred, and censure those belonging to their adversaries as alien, and they adopt highly inimical stances towards one another on numerous issues.

YS: Very likely.

ST: Now, at this stage, the adversity between these forms is mere childishness. However, when it relates to matters of the utmost importance, it turns out to be the most virulent disease of all those that afflict our cities.

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YS: What sort of important matters are you referring to?

ΞΕ. περὶ ὅλην, ὥς γε εἰκός, τὴν τοῦ ζῆν παρασκευήν. οἱ μὲν γὰρ δὴ διαφερόντως ὄντες κόσμιοι τὸν ἥσυχον αἰεὶ βίον ἔτοιμοι ζῆν, αὐτοὶ καθ' αὐτοὺς μόνοι τὰ σφέτερα αὐτῶν πράττοντες, οἴκοι τε αὖ πρὸς ἅπαντας οὕτως ὁμιλοῦντες, καὶ πρὸς τὰς ἔξωθεν πόλεις ὡσαύτως ἔτοιμοι πάντα ὄντες τρόπον τινὰ ἄγειν εἰρήνην· καὶ διὰ τὸν ἔρωτα δὴ τοῦτον ἀκαιρότερον ὄντα ἢ χρή, ὅταν ἂ βούλονται πράττωσιν, ἔλαθον αὐτοὶ τε ἀπολέμως ἴσχοντες καὶ τοὺς νέους ὡσαύτως διατιθέντες, ὄντες τε αἰεὶ τῶν ἐπιτιθεμένων, ἐξ ὧν οὐκ ἐν πολλοῖς ἔτεσιν αὐτοὶ καὶ παῖδες καὶ σύμπασα ἡ

ST: This is likely to involve the entire planning for living. For of course, those who are especially orderly are always ready to live the quiet life alone, just by themselves, occupying themselves with their own activities. What's more, they interact in this manner with everyone in their home city, and likewise towards foreign cities, being ready to maintain some manner of peace by any means. And because this love of theirs is most inopportune, whenever they behave as they wish to behave, they overlook the fact that they themselves, by maintaining an unmilitary stance, also influence the young towards a similar disposition. Consequently, they are continually beset by adversaries, and it is not long before they themselves, their children and their entire city become slaves rather than a free people, often without them being aware of it.

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YS: What you are describing is harsh, and a terrible predicament indeed.

πόλις ἀντ' ἐλευθέρων πολλάκις ἔλαθον αὐτοὺς γενόμενοι δοῦλοι. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. χαλεπὸν εἶπες καὶ δεινὸν πάθος. ΞΕ. τί δ' οἱ πρὸς τὴν ἀνδρείαν μᾶλλον ῥέποντες; ἄρ' οὐκ ἐπὶ πόλεμον αἰεὶ τινὰ τὰς αὐτῶν συντείνοντες πόλεις διὰ τὴν τοῦ τοιούτου βίου σφοδροτέραν τοῦ δέοντος ἐπιθυμίαν εἰς ἔχθραν πολλοῖς καὶ δυνατοῖς καταστάντες ἢ ἀμπαν διώλεσαν ἢ δούλας αὖ καὶ ὑποχειρίους τοῖς ἐχθροῖς ὑπέθεσαν τὰς αὐτῶν πατρίδας;

ST: But what about those who are more inclined towards courage? Aren't they constantly drawing their own cities into some war or other because of their excessively strong desire for such a life? And once they have made many powerful enemies, they either utterly destroy their own native land or reduce its people to slaves and underlings of their enemies.

308b

YS: Yes, that happens too.

ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ἔστι καὶ ταῦτα. ΞΕ. πῶς οὖν μὴ φῶμεν ἐν τούτοις ἀμφοτέρα ταῦτα τὰ γένη πολλὴν πρὸς ἄλληλα αἰεὶ καὶ τὴν μεγίστην ἴσχειν ἔχθραν καὶ στάσιν; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. οὐδαμῶς ὥς οὐ φήσομεν. ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν ὅπερ ἐπεσκοποῦμεν κατ' ἀρχὰς ἀνηυρήκαμεν, ὅτι μόρια ἀρετῆς οὐ σμικρὰ ἀλλήλοις διαφέρουσιν φύσει καὶ δὴ καὶ τοὺς ἰσχυόντας δρᾶτον τὸ αὐτὸ τοῦτο; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. κινδυνεύετον. ΞΕ. τόδε τοῖνυν αὖ λάβωμεν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. τὸ ποῖον;

ST: So how could we deny that in such situations these types always maintain a great deal, indeed a huge amount, of enmity and rivalry towards one another?

YS: There is no way at all we can deny it.

ST: In that case, haven't we found what we were looking for initially – that parts of excellence, of no minor significance, are naturally at variance with one another? And, what's more, they make those who possess them behave exactly as they do?

YS: So it seems.

ST: Then there is another issue we should take up.

YS: Of what kind?

308c

ST: Does any knowledge concerned with putting things together willingly assemble even the most trivial of its own productions from inferior and serviceable materials combined? Or is it that any knowledge in any situation discards the inferior as best it can, retains what is suitable and serviceable, and, from these, be they similar or dissimilar, constructs a single power and form by bringing them all together into a unity?

ΞΕ. εἴ τίς που τῶν συνθετικῶν ἐπιστημῶν πρᾶγμα ὅτιοῦν τῶν αὐτῆς ἔργων, κἂν εἰ τὸ φαυλότατον, ἔκοῦσα ἐκ μοχθηρῶν καὶ χρηστῶν τινων συνίστησιν, ἢ πᾶσα ἐπιστήμη πανταχοῦ τὰ μὲν μοχθηρὰ εἰς δύναμιν ἀποβάλλει, τὰ δὲ ἐπιτήδεια καὶ τὰ χρηστὰ ἔλαβεν, ἐκ τούτων δὲ καὶ ὁμοίων καὶ ἀνομοίων ὄντων, πάντα εἰς ἓν αὐτὰ συνάγουσα, μίαν τινὰ δύναμιν καὶ ἰδέαν δημιουργεῖ. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. τί μὴν;

YS: Of course.

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ST: Then neither will this statesmanship of ours, being natural and true, ever willingly assemble any city from serviceable people and bad people. Rather, it is quite obvious that it will test them first in play, and after that test it will go on to entrust them to those who are capable of educating them, and serving statesmanship in this respect, while for its own part it provides direction and superintendence, just as weaving pays close attention, and directs and superintends the carders – and those who furnish it with whatever it needs for its web – by indicating to each of them the sort of tasks it thinks it is appropriate for them to complete in relation to its own intertwining.

ΞΕ. οὐδ' ἄρα ἡ κατὰ φύσιν ἀληθῶς οὔσα ἡμῖν πολιτικὴ μή ποτε ἐκ χρηστῶν καὶ κακῶν ἀνθρώπων ἔκοῦσα εἶναι συστήσεται πόλιν τινά, ἀλλ' εὐδηλον ὅτι παιδιᾷ πρῶτον βασανιεῖ, μετὰ δὲ τὴν βάσανον αὖ τοῖς δυναμένοις παιδεύειν καὶ ὑπηρετεῖν πρὸς τοῦτ' αὐτὸ παραδώσει, προστάττουσα καὶ ἐπιστατοῦσα αὐτή, καθάπερ ὕφαντικὴ τοῖς τε

ξαίνουσι καὶ τοῖς τᾶλλα προπαρασκευάζουσιν ὅσα πρὸς τὴν πλέξιν αὐτῆς συμπαρακολουθοῦσα προστάττει καὶ ἐπιστατεῖ, τοιαῦτα

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YS: Entirely so.

ἐκάστοις ἐνδεικνῦσα τὰ ἔργα ἀποτελεῖν οἷα ἂν ἐπιτήδεια ἡγῆται πρὸς τὴν αὐτῆς εἶναι συμπλοκὴν. NE. ΣΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. ταῦτόν δὴ μοι τοῦθ' ἡ βασιλικὴ φαίνεται πᾶσι τοῖς κατὰ νόμον παιδευταῖς καὶ τροφεῦσιν, τὴν τῆς ἐπιστατικῆς αὐτῇ δύναμιν ἔχουσα, οὐκ ἐπιτρέψειν ἀσκεῖν ὅτι μὴ τις πρὸς τὴν αὐτῆς σύγκρασιν ἀπεργαζόμενος ἡθὸς τι πρέπον ἀποτελεῖ, ταῦτα δὲ μόνον παρακελεύεσθαι παιδεύειν· καὶ τοὺς μὲν μὴ δυναμένους κοινωνεῖν ἡθους ἀνδρείου καὶ σώφρονος ὅσα τε ἄλλα ἐστὶ τείνοντα πρὸς ἀρετὴν, ἀλλ' εἰς

ST: It appears to me that kingship does exactly the same thing. Retaining for itself the power of superintendence, it will not permit the lawful educators and nurturers to engage in any practice that does not bring about some characteristic that is appropriate to the overall blend, and it exhorts them to educate on this basis alone. But those who are unable to share in courage and sound-mindedness, and any other characteristics that are conducive to excellence, but are thrust away by the force of an evil nature into godlessness, violence and injustice, these it casts out through execution, exile, or punishing them with significant loss of status.

309a

YS: Something of this sort is said to happen anyway.

ἀθεότητα καὶ ὕβριν καὶ ἀδικίαν ὑπὸ κακῆς βίᾳ φύσεως ἀπωθουμένους, θανάτοις τε ἐκβάλλει καὶ φυγαῖς καὶ ταῖς μεγίσταις κολάζουσα ἀτιμίαις. NE. ΣΩ. λέγεται γοῦν πως οὕτως. ΞΕ. τοὺς δὲ ἐν ἀμαθίᾳ τε αὖ καὶ ταπεινότητι πολλῇ κυλινδουμένους εἰς τὸ δουλικὸν ὑποξέγγυσσι γένος. NE. ΣΩ. ὀρθότατα. ΞΕ. τοὺς λοιποὺς τοίνυν, ὅσων αἱ φύσεις ἐπὶ τὸ γενναῖον

ST: While those who wallow in ignorance and extreme baseness it subjects to the yoke of slavery.

YS: Quite right.

309b

ST: As for the others then, there are some whose natures are amenable to attaining nobility, if they obtain education and will accept being mixed with one another on the basis of a skill. Of these, it regards the ones who are more inclined towards courage as akin to warp threads due to their hard character, while those inclined to orderliness make use of a rich, soft, and, according to this image, a woof-like thread. These two natures, with their opposite inclinations, it attempts to bind and weave together in some such manner, as follows.

ἱκαναὶ παιδείας τυγχάνουσαι καθίστασθαι καὶ δέξασθαι μετὰ τέχνης σύμμειζιν πρὸς ἀλλήλας, τούτων τὰς μὲν ἐπὶ τὴν ἀνδρείαν μᾶλλον συντεινούσας, οἷον στημονοφυεὲς νομίσας αὐτῶν εἶναι τὸ στερεὸν ἦθος, τὰς δὲ ἐπὶ τὸ κόσμιον πίνοντες τε καὶ μαλακῶ καὶ κατὰ τὴν εἰκόνα κροκῶδει διανήματι προσχρωμέναι, ἐναντία δὲ τεινούσας ἀλλήλαις, πειρᾶται τοιόνδε τινὰ τρόπον συνδεῖν καὶ συμπλέκειν. NE. ΣΩ. ποῖον δὴ;

YS: How is it done?

309c

ST: First, based upon kinship, it joins together the ever-begotten part of their soul by a divine bond, and then after the divine, it joins the mortal part of them with human bonds.

ΞΕ. πρῶτον μὲν κατὰ τὸ συγγενὲς τὸ ἀειγενὲς ὃν τῆς ψυχῆς αὐτῶν μέρος θεῖω συναρμοσαμένη δεσμῶ, μετὰ δὲ τὸ θεῖον τὸ ζωογενὲς αὐτῶν αὐθις ἀνθρωπίνοις. NE. ΣΩ. πῶς τοῦτ' εἶπες αὖ; ΞΕ. τὴν τῶν καλῶν καὶ δικαίων πέρι καὶ ἀγαθῶν καὶ τῶν τούτοις ἐναντίων ὄντως οὐσαν ἀληθῆ δόξαν μετὰ βεβαιώσεως, ὅποταν ἐν ταῖς ψυχαῖς ἐγγίγνηται, θεῖαν φημί ἐν δαιμονίῳ γίνεσθαι γένει. NE. ΣΩ. πρέπει γοῦν οὕτω.

YS: Again, what do you mean by this?

ST: Whenever opinion that is really true – concerning whatever is noble, just and good, and their opposites – arises in souls, accompanied

by steadfastness, I say this is divine, and it arises in a class that is almost divine.

YS: It is quite appropriate to say so.

309d

ST: Now, are we aware that it belongs to the statesman and the good lawgiver alone, by means of the kingly Muse, to be able to engender this particular opinion in those who have acquired education in the right way, the people we described just now?

ΞΕ. τὸν δὴ πολιτικὸν καὶ τὸν ἀγαθὸν νομοθέτην ἄρ' ἴσμεν ὅτι προσήκει μόνον δυνατὸν εἶναι τῇ τῆς βασιλικῆς μούσῃ τοῦτο αὐτὸ ἐμποιεῖν τοῖς ὀρθῶς μεταλαβοῦσι παιδείας, οὓς ἐλέγομεν νυνδὴ; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. τὸ γοῦν εἰκός. ΞΕ. ὃς δ' ἂν δρᾷν γε, ὃ Σώκρατες, ἀδυνατῇ τὸ τοιοῦτον, μηδέποτε τοῖς νῦν ζητούμενοις ὀνόμασιν αὐτὸν προσαγορεύωμεν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. ὀρθότατα. ΞΕ. τί οὖν; ἀνδρεία ψυχὴ λαμβανομένη τῆς τοιαύτης

YS: That sounds reasonable.

ST: Anyway, Socrates, we would never use the names we are now investigating to refer to anyone who was unable to perform this function.

YS: No.

ST: Well now, won't a courageous soul be made gentle once it has grasped this sort of truth, and, consequently, have more communion with whatever is just, if it so wishes? But if it has no share in this, won't it be more inclined towards a wild nature?

309e

YS: That is inevitable.

ἀληθείας ἄρ' οὐχ ἡμεροῦται καὶ τῶν δικαίων μάλιστα οὕτω κοινωνεῖν ἂν ἐθέλησειεν, μὴ μεταλαβοῦσα δὲ ἀποκλινεῖ μάλλον πρὸς θηριώδη τινὰ φύσιν; ΝΕ. ΣΩ. πῶς δ' οὐ; ΞΕ. τί δὲ τὸ τῆς κοσμίας φύσεως; ἄρ' οὐ τούτων μὲν μεταλαβὼν τῶν δοξῶν ὄντως σῶφρον καὶ φρόνιμον, ὥς γε ἐν πολιτείᾳ, γίγνεται, μὴ κοινωνήσαν δὲ ὧν λέγομεν ἐπονείδιστόν τινα

εὐηθείας δικαιοτάτα λαμβάνει φήμην; NE. ΣΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΞΕ. οὐκοῦν συμπλοκὴν καὶ δεσμὸν τοῦτον τοῖς μὲν κακοῖς πρὸς σφᾶς αὐτοὺς καὶ τοῖς ἀγαθοῖς πρὸς τοὺς κακοὺς μηδέποτε μόνιμον φῶμεν γίνεσθαι, μηδέ τινα ἐπιστήμην αὐτῷ σπουδῇ πρὸς τοὺς τοιούτους ἂν χρῆσθαι ποτε; NE. ΣΩ. πῶς γάρ;

ST: But what about the orderly nature? If it shares in these opinions, doesn't it become genuinely self-restrained and wise, by the standard of civic life anyway? But if it does not share in the opinions we are describing, doesn't it quite rightly acquire a reprehensible reputation for folly?

YS: Entirely so.

ST: In that case, shouldn't we declare that this intertwining and binding will never become stable in bad people bound to their own kind, nor in good people bound to bad people, nor would any knowledge ever seriously use it in such cases?

YS: Of course.

310a

ST: And yet, in those characters born with innate nobility from the very outset, whose upbringing accords with their nature, in these alone it is implanted by the laws, and this indeed is a remedy skilfully applied to them. And just as we said, this bonding together is more divine since it unites parts of excellence that are dissimilar by nature and tend in opposite directions.

ΞΕ. τοῖς δ' εὐγενέσι γενομένοις τε ἐξ ἀρχῆς ἦθεσι θρεφθεῖσί τε κατὰ φύσιν μόνοις διὰ νόμων ἐμφύεσθαι, καὶ ἐπὶ τούτοις δὴ τοῦτ' εἶναι τέχνη φάρμακον, καὶ καθάπερ εἴπομεν τοῦτον θειότερον εἶναι τὸν σύνδεσμον ἀρετῆς μερῶν φύσεως ἀνομοίων καὶ ἐπὶ τὰ ἐναντία φερομένων. NE. ΣΩ. ἀληθέστατα. ΞΕ. τοὺς μὲν λοιπούς, ὄντας ἀνθρωπίνους δεσμούς, ὑπάρχοντος τούτου τοῦ θείου σχεδὸν οὐδὲν χαλεπὸν οὔτε ἐννοεῖν οὔτε ἐννοήσαντα ἀποτελεῖν.

YS: Very true.

ST: The remaining bonds are, of course, human, and once this divine bond is in place, it is not particularly difficult either to devise the others, or to implement them once devised.

310b

YS: How would you do so? And what are they?

NE. ΣΩ. πῶς δῆ, καὶ τίνας; ΞΕ. τοὺς τῶν ἐπιγαμιῶν καὶ παίδων κοινωνήσεων καὶ τῶν περὶ τὰς ἰδίας ἐκδόσεις καὶ γάμους. οἱ γὰρ πολλοὶ τὰ περὶ ταῦτα οὐκ ὀρθῶς συνδοῦνται πρὸς τὴν τῶν παίδων γέννησιν. NE. ΣΩ. τί δῆ; ΞΕ. τὰ μὲν πλούτου καὶ δυνάμεων ἐν τοῖς τοιούτοις διώγματα τί καὶ τις ἄν ὥς ἄξια λόγου σπουδάξοι μεμφόμενος; NE. ΣΩ. οὐδέν. ΞΕ. μᾶλλον δέ γε δίκαιον τῶν περὶ τὰ γένη ποιουμένων

ST: I mean bonds forged between communities through intermarriage and the community of their children, and those associated with private property exchange and marriage. Indeed, with respect to the procreation of children, most people make such arrangements in an incorrect manner.

YS: How is that?

ST: By the pursuit of wealth and power through such arrangements. But why would anyone seriously regard the censure of this as a worthy discussion topic?

YS: There is no reason.

310c

ST: No. It would be more correct to discuss those who pay attention to the families when making such arrangements, in case they do so in an inappropriate manner.

ἐπιμέλειαν τούτων πέρι λέγειν, εἴ τι μὴ κατὰ τρόπον πράττουσιν. NE. ΣΩ. εἰκὸς γὰρ οὖν. ΞΕ. πράττουσι μὲν δὴ οὐδ' ἐξ ἑνὸς ὀρθοῦ λόγου, τὴν ἐν τῷ παραχρήμα διώκοντες ῥαστώνην καὶ τῷ τοὺς μὲν προσομοίους αὐτοῖς ἀσπάζεσθαι, τοὺς δ' ἀνομοίους μὴ στέργειν, πλεῖστον τῇ δυσχερείᾳ μέρος ἀπονέμοντες. NE. ΣΩ. πῶς; ΞΕ. οἱ μὲν που κόσμιοι τὸ

σφέτερον αὐτῶν ἦθος ζητοῦσι, καὶ κατὰ δύναμιν γαμοῦσί τε παρὰ τούτων καὶ τὰς

YS: Yes, that's reasonable anyway.

ST: In fact, they do not act based upon a single correct principle, for they pursue the easiest option available, embrace those who are much like themselves, and have no affection for those who are dissimilar. They assign the utmost significance to their feeling of displeasure.

YS: In what way?

310d

ST: The orderly people seek out their own characteristic, and as best they can they marry those types and bestow their own offspring upon such people again when giving them in marriage. And the courageous type do the very same, by pursuing their own nature, when both of these types should be really doing the exact opposite.

ἐκδιδομένας παρ' αὐτῶν εἰς τούτους ἐκπέμπουσι πάλιν· ὥς δ' αὐτως τὸ περὶ τὴν ἀνδρείαν γένος δρᾷ, τὴν αὐτοῦ μεταδιῶκον φύσιν, δέον ποιεῖν ἀμφοτέρα τὰ γένη τούτων τοῦναντίον ἅπαν. NE. ΣΩ. πῶς, καὶ διὰ τί; ΞΕ. διότι πέφυκεν ἀνδρεία τε ἐν πολλαῖς γενέσεσιν ἄμεικτος γεννωμένη σώφρονι φύσει κατὰ μὲν ἀρχὰς ἀκμάζειν ῥώμῃ, τελευτῶσα δὲ ἐξανθεῖν παντάπασι μανίαις. NE. ΣΩ. εἰκός. ΞΕ. ἡ δὲ αἰδοῦς γε αὖ λίαν πλήρης ψυχὴ καὶ ἀκέραστος

YS: In what way, and why?

ST: Because it is natural that courage, propagated for many generations without being mixed with a sound-minded nature, flourishes powerfully at first, but in the end bursts forth in utter madness.

YS: That is likely.

310e

ST: In contrast, the soul that is too full of moderation, bred over many generations without admixture of daring courage, grows unseasonably

dull and ends up totally maimed.

τόλμης ἀνδρείας, ἐπὶ δὲ γενεὰς πολλὰς οὕτω γεννηθεῖσα, νωθεστέρα φύεσθαι τοῦ καιροῦ καὶ ἀποτελευτῶσα δὴ παντάπασιν ἀναπηροῦσθαι. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. καὶ τοῦτ' εἰκὸς οὕτω συμβαίνειν. ΞΕ. τούτους δὴ τοὺς δεσμοὺς ἔλεγον ὅτι χαλεπὸν οὐδὲν συνδεῖν ὑπάρξαντος τοῦ περὶ τὰ καλὰ κάγαθὰ μίαν ἔχειν ἀμφοτέρω τὰ γένη δόξαν. τοῦτο γὰρ ἐν καὶ ὅλον ἐστὶ βασιλικῆς συνυφάνσεως ἔργον, μηδέποτε ἔαν ἀφίστασθαι σώφρονα ἀπὸ τῶν ἀνδρείων ἦθη, συγκερκίζοντα δὲ ὁμοδοξίαις καὶ τιμαῖς καὶ ἀτιμίαις καὶ δόξαις καὶ ὁμηριῶν ἐκδόσεις εἰς ἀλλήλους, λεῖον καὶ τὸ λεγόμενον εὐήτριον

YS: Yes. That is the likely outcome.

ST: Now, I said that these bonds were not difficult to forge once a single opinion about what is noble and good, held by both classes, was in place. For this is the sole function of the kingly weaving process as a whole: never to allow the sound-minded characters to stand apart from the courageous, but to weave them together through unanimity, by granting privileges or withdrawing them, through reputation and the mutual exchange of sureties. He should then assemble them into what we call a well-woven fabric, and always entrust the public offices in our cities, in common, to these two.

311a

YS: In what way?

ὑφασμα συνάγοντα ἐξ αὐτῶν, τὰς ἐν ταῖς πόλεσιν ἀρχὰς ἀεὶ κοινῇ τούτοις ἐπιτρέπειν. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. πῶς; ΞΕ. οὐ μὲν ἂν ἐνὸς ἄρχοντος χρεῖα συμβαίῃη, τὸν ταῦτα ἀμφοτέρω ἔχοντα αἰρούμενον ἐπιστάτην· οὐ δ' ἂν πλειόνων, τούτων μέρος ἑκατέρων συμμειγνύντα. τὰ μὲν γὰρ σωφρόνων ἀρχόντων ἦθη σφόδρα μὲν εὐλαβῇ καὶ δίκαια καὶ σωτήρια, δριμύτητος δὲ καὶ τινος ἱταμότητος ὀξεῖας καὶ πρακτικῆς ἐνδεῖται. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. δοκεῖ γοῦν δὴ καὶ τάδε.

ST: When a single official happens to be required, it chooses someone possessing both to take charge, and when a greater number is needed,

it combines together a portion of each of the two types. For when the sound-minded characters rule, they are extremely cautious, just and safe, and yet they lack a certain sharp, practical vigour.

YS: Yes. That's what seems to happen anyway.

311b

ST: But the courageous types, by contrast, although inferior to the other types when it comes to justice and caution, still possess exceptional vigour in practical situations. However, it is impossible for all the affairs of our cities, public as well as private, to proceed well without both these qualities being available to them.

ΞΕ. τὰ δ' ἀνδρεῖά γε αὖ πρὸς μὲν τὸ δίκαιον καὶ εὐλαβὲς ἐκείνων ἐπιδεέστερα, τὸ δὲ ἐν ταῖς πράξεσι ἰταμὸν διαφερόντως ἴσχει. πάντα δὲ καλῶς γίγνεσθαι τὰ περὶ τὰς πόλεις ἰδίᾳ καὶ δημοσίᾳ τούτοις μὴ παραγενομένοις ἀμφοῖν ἀδύνατον. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΞΕ. τοῦτο δὴ τέλος ὑφάσματος εὐθυπλοκίᾳ συμπλακὲν γίγνεσθαι φῶμεν πολιτικῆς πράξεως τὸ τῶν ἀνδρείων καὶ σωφρόνων ἀνθρώπων ἦθος, ὁπότεν ὁμονοίᾳ καὶ φιλίᾳ κοινὸν

YS: No, how could they?

311c

ST: And we may say that this disposition of the courageous and of the sound-minded people, once woven together in an even texture, constitutes the finished fabric of the activity of statesmanship whereby the skill of kingship, having brought these together through like-mindedness and friendship into a common life, and having completed the most magnificent and excellent of all fabrics, embraces all the other people in our cities, slaves and free, by clothing them in this woven web, and rules and superintends thereafter, omitting nothing that renders the city as happy as it belongs to any city to be.

συναγαγοῦσα αὐτῶν τὸν βίον ἢ βασιλικὴ τέχνη, πάντων μεγαλοπρεπέστατον ὑφασμάτων καὶ ἄριστον ἀποτελέσασα ὥστ' εἶναι κοινόν τοὺς τ' ἄλλους ἐν ταῖς πόλεσι πάντας δούλους καὶ ἐλευθέρους ἀμπίσχουσα, συνέχῃ τούτῳ τῷ πλέγματι, καὶ καθ' ὅσον εὐδαίμονι

προσῆκει γίγνεσθαι πόλει τούτου μηδαμῇ μηδὲν ἐλλείπουσα ἄρχη τε καὶ ἐπιστατῇ. ΝΕ. ΣΩ. κάλλιστα αὖ τὸν βασιλικὸν ἀπετέλεσας ἄνδρα ἡμῖν, ὃ ξένε, καὶ τὸν πολιτικόν.

S: Now, stranger, you have also completed for us a most beautiful account of the kingly man, the statesman.

Notes

¹ Theodorus was from Cyrene, a city in north Africa not far from Siwah, which was home to an oracle to the Egyptian god Ammon (Amun).

² The conversation between Socrates and Theaetetus took place the previous day, and is depicted in Plato's dialogue, *Theaetetus*. The conversation between Theaetetus and the stranger took place earlier on this same day, and is depicted in Plato's dialogue, *Sophist*.

³ This refers to the sophist, the subject of the previous conversation today. Plato, *Sophist* 221c ff.

⁴ Lydia and Phrygia were two ancient kingdoms in western Anatolia.

⁵ This refers to the ponds belonging to the King of Persia.

⁶ Plato, *Theaetetus* 147c ff.

⁷ The argument operates by constructing squares and measuring their diagonals.

⁸ The creature in question is the pig. The pig does not have a split hoof.

⁹ A pun on the word for 'last' in this sentence confirms that the animal referred to above is indeed the pig.

¹⁰ This is a reference to the swineherd.

¹¹ Plato, *Sophist* 227b.

¹² Euripides, *Orestes* 986 ff.

¹³ This is probably a reference to an Athenian official called the King Archon who presided over legal issues concerned with religious matters. He was also responsible for certain sacrifices and ceremonies.